

ADVENTURER

PREMIUM PROFILE



16 Personalities

What's in This Profile?

This profile is designed to cover all the main aspects of the Adventurer personality as it affects different areas of their life, including Adventurers' key strengths and weaknesses, relationships, academic path, career and professional development, as well as their communication and social skills, parenting tips and advice, and much, much more. It combines personality type theory with practical, real-world advice from others who share the Adventurer personality type.

As Aristotle said millennia ago, "The hardest victory is the victory over self" – and, to this end, personality types have been considered and studied throughout human history. The information in these pages provides profound personal insight that can help with handling day-to-day situations in more healthy, balanced ways. Consider this profile a plan for success.

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Who Is “The Adventurer?”



This e-book explores how Adventurers’ traits influence their personalities – and their lives. As we’ll explain, these traits produce a unique set of tendencies and behaviors that shape Adventurers’ personal growth, relationships, and academic and professional development. So, let’s embark on a quick overview of the Adventurer personality type, and venture into the topics we’ll explore more deeply in later chapters.

Personal Growth

Sensuous and passionate, Adventurers have a definite flair for aesthetics, and they thrive on novelty, beauty, and physical pleasure. Like other members of the Explorer group, people with this personality type live in the moment, creating a sense of possibility and adventure whenever possible. They seize new opportunities – and when none are available, they cook up their own. More spontaneous and action-oriented than most of their fellow Introverts, Adventurers love to break out and have a good time. That said, they don’t spend every waking moment out in the world.

Instead, they occasionally retreat and take some alone time to reconnect with themselves.

These free spirits resist rules, routines, guidelines, and imposed structures. Alas, this pursuit of independence and enjoyment can lead Adventurers to ignore important practical matters and neglect to plan for the future. They might not save for retirement, build up emergency funds, or even open their mail. Ironically, this unbalanced failure to take responsibility often robs Adventurers of the freedom they so crave.

Adventurers can still indulge their spontaneity (which can be among their most beneficial traits) as long as they stay on top of practical necessities by establishing just enough structure in their lives to maintain their personal and financial wellbeing. With such structure in place, Adventurers can satisfy their lust for life – setting trends, embracing new opportunities, and exploring the beauties and pleasures of the world.

Relationships

Although they're Introverts, Adventurers often come across as charismatic and well-connected. Perceptive and emotionally attuned, they bring their whole presence to interactions with other people, and this quality enables them to pick the best compliment for a particular person. As a result, Adventurers rarely have difficulty connecting with others, whether new friends or potential partners. Even when these types are unpredictable or reckless, their charm easily disarms those around them.

In romantic relationships, Adventurers are caring, affectionate, and vivacious. They distinguish themselves as good listeners, and always know just how to make their partners feel cared for and special. In return, they crave consistent support and acceptance. Adventurers protect their innermost emotional core, and unless they

fully trust their partners’ love and loyalty, they won’t open up and show their true feelings.

A common misconception about Adventurers is that they’re endlessly easygoing. Beneath their relaxed exteriors, they’re exquisitely sensitive to other people’s feelings. They’re inclined to seek harmony in all situations and have no difficulty sensing a change others’ emotional states. Due to this sensitivity, Adventurers can have unbalanced, extreme reactions to criticism or even perceived criticism – a trait that can manifest itself with their partners, friends, family, or colleagues. In unbalanced romantic relationships, Adventurers expect unconditional approval from their partners, even when they’re acting rashly or unreasonably.

Adventurers can rebalance these relationships by knowing when they need to pull back and indulge their Introverted sides. By withdrawing from social interaction, they can connect with their thoughts and feelings instead of other people’s opinions. Given their usual spontaneity and enthusiasm, Adventurers’ periodic desire for “alone time” may surprise their friends and acquaintances. This contributes to the air of unpredictability and mystery that usually surrounds people with this personality type.

Academic and Professional Development

Most Adventurers find it challenging to follow highly structured processes, and so they may fare poorly in traditional academic environments. Because people with this personality type are resistant to rules and hierarchies, others might not recognize their unique talents and gifts at an early age. As a result, some Adventurers may grow up with misgivings about their intelligence – or even their worth.

By adolescence, however, most Adventurers develop a refined aesthetic sense, excelling in endeavors related to art, design, and style. In addition, their spontaneity enables them to thrive in changeable, unpredictable circumstances, an ability that becomes more valuable once they progress beyond the structured world of early schooling. Given the right environment, Adventurers’ creativity and willingness to experiment can help them thrive in such fields as the visual arts, craftsmanship, music, film, and theater.

Independent and goal-oriented, Adventurers aren’t afraid to blaze unconventional or even risky paths in pursuit of success. This liberates them from social expectations and constraints, for better or for worse. However, Adventurers may take this liberation a step too far, becoming egocentric or even conniving in an unbalanced, single-minded effort to get what they want. They may act unilaterally, abandoning their usual concern for others’ feelings and wellbeing.

Adventurers can rebalance such behavior by capitalizing on their spontaneity and ambition in more responsible ways, weighing potential risks against potential benefits. Open-minded and considerate, they may question their reasoning from time to time, and they can assess feedback from others without becoming emotionally charged. When possible, they can also seek out academic and professional settings that take advantage of their strengths. If allowed sufficient freedom, flexibility, and novelty, Adventurers are capable of remarkable creativity and significant accomplishments.

On That Note...

In this section, we’ve explored what sets apart people with the Adventurer personality type. That said, a brief introduction can’t do justice to the full scope of

Adventurers’ strengths and gifts, let alone how they can counterbalance their weaknesses. In the following chapters, we’ll investigate these areas further, highlighting unexpected insights as well as suggestions and resources for improvement. Understanding one’s personality type is incredibly valuable, and we hope the following information proves useful.

Theory Overview

Five Personality Aspects

Introverted (I) vs. Extraverted (E)

People have long noted that some among them are more outgoing and comfortable interacting with their surroundings, and others are more at ease remaining in quiet solitude with their thoughts. You can see the two types in almost any home, office, or classroom. In our first scale, we focus on the difference between Introversion and Extraversion, which we call the Energy scale.

The Energy scale describes how we see and approach the outside world, including people, objects, and activities within it. There are significant links between this scale and things like willingness to volunteer, boredom, thrill seeking, motivation, and romantic assertiveness, to name just a few. The links may not prove one causes the other. However, it does hint at a relationship.

Introverted People: Attuned Inwards

More Internal: Introverts ground themselves more easily in solitude and derive energy from their own thoughts.

More Selective: Introverts are careful when choosing the people with whom they spend time and prefer a quieter environment when they have a choice.

Slow to Offer Opinions: Within reason, Introverts like a little time to process their thoughts and ideas and are slow to offer opinions, fearing they may be too rash.

Extraverted People: Outwardly Engaged

More Outgoing: Extraverts tend to be outgoing both socially and in their willingness to interact with new and interesting environments.

Energetic: Extraverts have an energy that is almost replenished by its expression. They are energized by being energetic and putting themselves in stimulating situations.

Quick with Opinions: Extraverts are generally more comfortable with a flurry of opinions that typically are a part of casual conversations. It's almost like brainstorming ideas on the spot while saving the editing for later.

Intuitive (N) vs. Observant (S)

The second scale in our model is called Mind and addresses Intuitive and Observant styles. Each trait determines what kind of information we focus on and how it is used. It's the foundation on which all the other approaches are built.

All personality types include either those who favor the Intuitive style or those who prefer the Observant style. But before we start, it's important to say that this has nothing to do with how they take in information. The word "Observant" might suggest it does. But Intuitive and Observant types use their five senses in the same way. Rather than how they absorb information, these qualities show how each of these traits manages it once it's received.

Intuitive People: Living in the World of Ideas

Focus on Ideas: Intuitive people are fascinated by the world of ideas and love to discover the connections between various concepts and realities.

Are Deeply Curious: Within the realm of ideas, Intuitive individuals have a strong curiosity that leads them to somewhat adventurous discoveries.

Highly Imaginative: Those who prefer this trait typically stretch concepts to include possibilities beyond the obvious. “What if this not only means... but what if it could also mean...”

Observant People: Feet On the Ground

A Practical Focus: Observant people are more in touch with the concrete world and work within it. They favor consistent actions and measurable results.

Facts Over Theory: These individuals leave theorizing and brainstorming to others, preferring to effectively apply established facts.

More in the Moment: While Observant individuals have a respect for the past and the future, they see them through the lens of what they can do now. The task at hand is always the most important.

Thinking (T) vs. Feeling (F)

The Thinking and Feeling traits determine how we decide matters and cope with emotions. While we all have feelings, there are significant differences in how we react to them and what role those feelings play in our lives. This then influences several other areas, mostly related to our interactions with other people. This is what our third trait, Nature, focuses on.

Thinking People: Where Reason Rules

Rational and Objective: Thinking individuals are most comfortable dealing with things that come from rational thought and involve proven principles.

Logic Over Feelings: While these types often feel quite deeply, they typically place their rationality and logic above any emotional responses.

Constantly Assessing: Thinking people constantly scan ideas and actions to decide whether they make sense or not. They can be valuable in any process that requires any level of critical thinking.

Feeling People: Those Who Follow Their Feelings

Lead from the Heart: Feeling types listen to their feelings, care about how others feel, and are unafraid of sharing this perspective.

Focus on Morals and Ethics: People and their welfare are usually prioritized above any other consideration with the individuals who exhibit the Feeling trait.

A Different Kind of Rationality: While the Feeling type's way of choosing a direction may not always be totally objective, that doesn't mean that they lack rationality. There is practical wisdom in including feelings and consideration for the well-being of oneself and others in the decisions one makes.

Judging (J) vs. Prospecting (P)

The Tactics scale – Judging and Prospecting – is about how people plan and deal with the options they have. But this definition doesn't just concern what individuals write in their day planners. It's much broader. These traits answer questions like, "Do you

prefer spontaneity or certainty?" "Do you feel more comfortable acting only with all your ducks lined neatly in a row? Or does a certain amount of flexibility or chaos excite you and prove motivating?" "Do you need more choices or fewer?"

At its core, this scale determines our attitude toward certainty and structure in our lives, both at mental and physical levels.

Judging People: A Steady Hand

Predictability Rules: Judging types are most at home when there is a clear-cut, well-considered plan that provides sure steps and promotes certain outcomes.

Work Hard: Judging individuals tend to work hard, perhaps seeing strong effort as a way of ensuring predictability.

By the Book: Individuals with this trait usually like to do things by the book and respect reasonable protocols, established techniques, and duties. They sometimes see doing things any other way as "reinventing the wheel."

Prospecting People: Possibilities in the Moment

Relaxed Spontaneity: Prospecting types tend to deal with life and all its opportunities as it comes at them.

Creative: This trait can promote "coloring outside the lines." This can lead to discovering new creative solutions.

Serial Passions: Prospecting individuals may find themselves passing quickly through many interests in their lives. Because of these experiences, they can possess a broad array of knowledge and ideas.

Assertive (-A) vs. Turbulent (-T)

Assertive and Turbulent – the Identity scale – measures how confident one is and how that confidence influences all other traits. The degree that people move more boldly or more timidly affects the way they make choices. It determines how they express their skills. Whether one is too confident to accept criticism or puts too much weight on the criticism of others because they lack self-confidence can make a major difference. The caution or lack of caution people apply to the things they do can color everything.

Assertive People: A Confident Approach

Confident Style: People with the Assertive identity are self-confident and resist stress.

Often Success-Oriented: Because these individuals don't spend hours fretting, it might be assumed they aren't interested in results. For many of them, nothing could be further from the truth.

Responsive and Proactive: Assertive people may jump into a task quickly, not being as burdened with the need to think endlessly about what may go wrong.

Turbulent People: Always Improving

Useful Worry: Turbulent people often worry and engage in self-doubt. While that might sound negative, the flipside of the coin is that it fuels much of their drive and productivity.

Driven to Succeed and Improve: Turbulent individuals are constantly seeking to do better and be better. This pushes them to put great effort into life.

Problem Spotters: Because of their cautious nature and tendency to worry, those with the Turbulent trait often spot problems early and are able to contain them quickly.

Type Groups

Now you know what each type consists of. But how do they fit together?

In our system, we group personality types in two different ways:

- **Roles** determine our goals, interests, and preferred activities.
- **Strategies** reflect our preferred ways of doing things and achieving our goals.

You can think of Roles and Strategies as two ways of organizing personality types into categories. These two categorization methods each highlight different facets of the types. For examples, Roles can show us why certain types share similar interests, and Strategies can explain why certain types approach socializing the way they do.

We discuss Strategies in depth at the end of this e-book, in *The Puzzle of Personality*. With that in mind, let's explore the importance of Roles.

Roles

There are four Roles, each of which groups together four personality types.

- The **Analyst Role** includes Architects (INTJ), Logicians (INTP), Commanders (ENTJ), and Debaters (ENTP).

- The **Diplomat Role** includes Advocates (INFJ), Mediators (INFP), Protagonists (ENFJ), and Campaigners (ENFP).
- The **Sentinel Role** includes Logisticians (ISTJ), Defenders (ISFJ), Executives (ESTJ), and Consuls (ESFJ).
- The **Explorer Role** includes Virtuosos (ISTP), Adventurers (ISFP), Entrepreneurs (ESTP), and Entertainers (ESFP).

So, why do we organize the types in this way? To put it simply, Roles help us to recognize important common ground between personality types.

The types within each Role all share the same Mind trait – either Intuitive or Observant. As you might remember, this trait is incredibly important because it determines how we view the world. As a result, the types within a given Role are alike in a very important respect: they share similar ways of understanding the world and their place within it.

In addition to the Mind trait, the types within a given Role also share the same Nature trait (Thinking or Feeling) or the same Tactics trait (Judging or Prospecting).

Does this seem like information overload? If so, don't worry. To help you get a better grasp of the Roles, let's go through them one by one and find out what makes them tick.

Analysts: Intuitive (N) and Thinking (T)

The personality types in the Analyst Role – Architects, Logicians, Commanders, and Debaters – are known for their irreverent curiosity. Thanks to the Intuitive trait, these types are rarely satisfied with the status quo. Instead, they'll go deep in their search

for ways to make things better, more efficient, and more effective. Meanwhile, the Thinking trait means that they value rationality over emotionality.

Analysts' greatest strengths include:

Driven to learn. Analysts want to know how the world works. In their quest for knowledge, they push the boundaries of their understanding. The result? Their expertise in certain areas can be remarkable.

Questioning natures. Analysts rarely accept things at face value. Ever questioning, they look beyond superficial appearances. This enables them to come up with deep, unexpected insights.

Intellectual energy. Full of fresh, counterintuitive ideas, Analysts know how to spark a lively debate. Conversations with these candid, sharp-witted types can be a breath of fresh air.

Born to improve. Analysts are relentless self-improvers. Once they've recognized a flaw, they apply all their rationality, imagination, and ambition to make it right.

Analysts' forceful imaginations, when trained and focused, enable them to achieve incredible results. But, like anyone, these types can have their Achilles heels, such as:

Lost in thought. Thinking up great ideas gives Analysts a rush. As a result, they're at risk of staying in the realm of thought, never acting out their ideas.

Ever the critic. In the same vein, some Analysts are more comfortable thinking about and critiquing other people's work than jumping into the fray themselves. In time, these types may be frustrated to find themselves outpaced by people with real-world experience.

Hunting for flaws. If taken too far, Analysts' desire for improvement can have them hunting down the flaws in everything. As a result, they may undervalue the people and opportunities they encounter.

Emoti-what? Analysts feel more comfortable in the realm of thought than the messy world of emotions. But like anyone, they need to develop emotional literacy in order to deepen their relationships and fully understand themselves.

Fortunately, Analysts have enough creativity and ambition to move beyond these stumbling blocks. When they take action, look for the positive, and train their curiosity on the realm of emotions, these types can grow into their full potential.

Diplomats: Intuitive (N) and Feeling (F)

Diplomats – Advocates, Mediators, Protagonists, and Campaigners – tend to be warm, caring, and generous. Bringing together the Intuitive and Feeling traits, they shine in their understanding of emotions – both their own and other people's. This ability helps them shine when it comes to diplomacy, counseling others, and communication in general.

Diplomats' gifts and talents include:

Emotional literacy. Even when it's far from obvious, Diplomats can often perceive how others are feeling. From the outside, this might look like mind-reading. But in truth, it's a combination of self-reflection and radical compassion that helps Diplomats understand others' emotional states.

Only connect. Diplomats don't use their people skills to manipulate others. Instead, they aim to nurture genuine connections with the people they encounter. Moreover, many Diplomats feel called to serve others however they can.

Do no harm. Deep down, Diplomats want what's best for everyone. For them, causing someone else distress would feel like a wound to their own psyche. As a result, these types aim to promote cooperation and harmony rather than conflict.

Creators at work. Profoundly creative, Diplomats are always on the hunt for inspiration. Whether or not they take up artistic pursuits, these types tend to enjoy self-exploration and self-expression.

Diplomats have high ideals. For them, kindness and altruism burn as brightly as a fire on a chilly winter's night. But if left unchecked, this idealism can have its downsides, including:

Impractical magic. Tempering passion with cold practicality is a challenge for Diplomats. These types are often reluctant to make tough decisions – especially if those decisions require them to compromise on their ideals or hurt someone's feelings.

Beautiful ideas. Diplomats have the best of intentions, and they have countless ideas about ways to help people. They're at risk, however, of staying stuck in the realm of ideas instead of taking action and sticking to a plan.

Taking on too much. In their efforts to make a difference, Diplomats may overcommit themselves – emotionally, physically, or even financially. If they don't deliver everything they'd hoped, they may feel overwhelmed or disappointed in themselves.

Easily hurt. Sensitive to criticism and rejection, these types may react strongly if other people question the value of their ideals. Disagreement and conflict can leave Diplomats feeling discouraged and hurt.

In all their actions, Diplomats crave a sense of meaning and purpose. Specifically, they feel called to cultivate positive change and gentle beauty in the world around them. Motivated by intangible rewards felt in the heart and soul, these types have a conviction to serve the greater good.

Sentinels: Observant (S) and Judging (J)

Sentinels – Logisticians, Defenders, Executives, and Consuls – are cooperative and practical. This grounded approach helps them feel comfortable with themselves just as they are. Steadfast and hardworking, these types pride themselves on their character and competence.

Here are some of the ways that Sentinels contribute to their homes, workplaces, social circles, and beyond:

Loving duty. These types feel a deep responsibility for those they care about. Specifically, Sentinels feel duty-bound to keep their loved ones safe and to help them lead good lives.

Always on time. Sure, Sentinels might occasionally fall behind schedule. But most of the time, they pride themselves on being unfailingly reliable. As a result, friends, loved ones, and coworkers can trust that Sentinels won't flake on their commitments.

Keepers of tradition. Sentinels work hard to maintain the ways things are done. In their home life, this means they love to continue family traditions. At the workplace, these types keep track of and defend best practices.

Unwavering diligence. Sentinels aren't afraid of hard work. On a daily basis, they practice their virtues of consistency and persistence, refusing to take shortcuts or

stop before their work is done. And in situations where someone needs to step up and take responsibility, Sentinels can be counted on to come through.

Sentinels feel bolstered by having reliable people in their lives, and they make it a priority to hold up their end of the bargain. But even these dependable types can have their challenges, including:

Resistance to change. For Sentinels, trying new ways of doing things can feel wrong – almost like breaking an unwritten set of rules. These types can be skeptical of change, and they may stick with suboptimal choices on the grounds of “that’s how it’s always been done.”

Stubbornness toward others. Similarly, Sentinels may feel personally affronted when other people upset the status quo. What someone else might describe as “experimenting with new ideas” may seem reckless or disrespectful to Sentinels. As a result, these types might dig in their heels, even if that means forestalling progress.

Imposing their values. Sentinels love to give advice and shepherd people toward better lives – at least, what Sentinels consider better lives. It may be hard for these types to accept that not everyone holds stability, tradition, and respectability among their core values. And when other people don’t follow their advice, Sentinels may want to judge them harshly.

Sentinels’ loyalty and steadfastness shine in many situations. When they balance their firm convictions with curiosity and openness, these types can become nothing short of inspirations to the people in their lives.

Explorers: Observant (S) and Prospecting (P)

Explorers – Virtuosos, Adventurers, Entrepreneurs, and Entertainers – are self-reliant and quick-thinking. They're always ready to tackle a challenge or act on the spur of the moment. This spontaneity doesn't only help them solve problems – it also enables them to find opportunities for enjoyment in their everyday lives.

Here are a few of Explorers' notable strengths:

Surfing the waves. Many people struggle with change, but not Explorers. These types can adapt to new situations with minimal regret or second-guessing. In fact, they often enjoy change and appreciate breaks from routine.

Socially dynamic. Because of their openness, many Explorers enjoy meeting new people and trying out new social experiences. This helps them to build a network of diverse and interesting friends and acquaintances.

Getting things done. Explorers don't overthink things. Instead, they leap into action and get the job done. These types spend their energy on taking concrete steps, only pausing to consider abstract ideas or nitty-gritty details when it's absolutely necessary.

Picking up techniques. Utilitarian in their way, Explorers love to master new tools and techniques. Whatever their hobbies and passions, these types enjoy the challenge of building their skills and picking up new ways of doing things.

Explorers enjoy being free of obligations, where they can indulge themselves or their interests on their own time. Like most traits, this has its upsides and its downsides. Here are some tendencies that Explorers may need to counteract:

Losing interest. We all lose interest in our activities from time to time. But Explorers often run out of motivation as soon as a project no longer feels fun, novel, or exciting.

What planning? Explorers prefer to deal with challenges on the fly rather than plan ahead. Alas, sometimes an ounce of planning really is worth a pound of cure.

Risky business. Explorers are drawn to pleasure, risk, and – sometimes – risky pleasures. As they grow and mature, however, they often learn that some risks simply aren't worth taking.

Explorers connect with the world in a way that's almost childlike in its wonder and sheer fun. It can be a challenge for them to work for things with a distant or unexciting payoff, but when they harness their passion and administer just enough self-discipline, they can move heaven and earth.

Now, let's talk about you.

Personal Growth



Personal growth isn't the one-size-fits-all affair that some self-help books would have us believe. It's really about expanding beyond comfort and habit to explore new ways of existing. For Adventurers, personal growth is always about balancing spontaneity with responsibility, independence with intimacy, and desire for novelty with appreciation for things as they are. The goal is never about changing individual Adventurers' essential personalities but expanding themselves to include a greater array of tools for getting through their lives more skillfully.

For Adventurers to grow, they must first develop self-awareness, assessing themselves and their behaviors. Are their behaviors pleasant in the moment but harmful in the long run? These types should then ask themselves what they want from life, both now and in the future. This thinking need not box Adventurers into rigid plans. Considering the future can open up new, more fulfilling possibilities. The final step of growth involves replacing unhealthy behaviors with new behaviors that bring Adventurers closer to what they want in life.

However, not all growth is the product of deliberate effort. Sometimes it emerges gently from the subtle shifts caused by age and maturity, and sometimes life harshly demands growth through hard times and crises. No matter the method, as the saying goes, “You’re either getting better, or you’re getting worse. There is no staying the same.”

Motivation and Development

Adventurers can consider personal growth in three closely related but distinct areas that relate to internally developing self-regard.

Motivation

- **Self-esteem** speaks to how much Adventurers like themselves. Accepting both their flaws and strengths creates a base of internal appreciation that enables change motivated by desire instead of shame.
- **Self-respect** speaks to their sense of worth. People with this personality type value empathy and harmony, and when they live their beliefs and values, a balanced sense of pride in who they are follows.
- **Self-confidence** is the energy source that moves Adventurers forward in life. When belief in their abilities is confirmed using their skills, Adventurers are driven to make steady progress.

If these three core aspects are properly balanced and nurtured, they can promote a successful and fulfilling life. If these elements become unbalanced, however, they become a source of overwhelming difficulty. For example, when Adventurers feel a lack of self-confidence, they might compensate with behaviors that give them

confidence – but problems arise should they overcompensate and throw their lives out of balance.

Moving Forward

Conscious personal growth is about more than feeling obligated to change. When inspired, these types seek new ways to be happier and more successful – including an independent and personal definition of success. The goal is to spur their inner drive with ideas, encouragement, and gentle guidance for possible problems along the way.

In these sections, we'll first examine Adventurers' characteristics in their ideal, balanced, and developed form. Using these motivational aspects in balanced ways helps Adventurers lead fulfilling, productive, and happy lives.

Next, we'll describe the tendencies that emerge if these aspects become unbalanced. These represent departures from healthy, productive motivation strategies and explain adverse effects Adventurers experience when they disconnect from their true selves.

Finally, we'll discuss what can be done to improve balance in each of the motivational aspects.

Self-Esteem

It's common for sensitive people to struggle to reconcile emotion and memory with their logic. Yet Adventurers who maintain firm connections to their sense of emotional harmony also create strength in the higher functions of their beings.

Internal conflict inhibits happy and inspired lives, while self-appreciation is a state from which all good things can grow.

Balanced Self-Esteem

A sense of competence and mastery drives Adventurers' self-esteem engine. These types never want to settle for "good enough." Combining their natural curiosity, their extraordinary perception, and their creative edge, life beckons Adventurers to discover how far a scenario can go. This naturally leads to mastery of a skill or a situation. Without this sense of mastery, people with this personality type are likely to feel a lack of completeness.

Even if they do something well, unless they feel like they've done it expertly, Adventurers may feel like they haven't met their potential. They tend to strive to take any skill or achievement, large or small, to the next level until they can perfect it no further. This driving motivation can be an employer's dream come true. Adventurers accept the challenge of any problem, do the job, and do it correctly to completion.

Unbalanced Self-Esteem

How Far Is Too Far?

Is there such a thing as too much mastery? Not exactly. But Adventurers must decide if the intense focus it takes to develop expertise is worth certain sacrifices when all is said and done. With their desire to dominate any fields they enter or any problems they seek to solve, Adventurers may not consider any collateral damage that others may face because of their search for perfection.

Sometimes Adventurers must choose between focusing on their goals and caring for the needs of others. When this happens, they inevitably place others further down

on their list of priorities. They don't do this because they dislike people. They try to be kind and useful to others, and they may even regard themselves as "people persons," despite being Introverted. And they are – but they can see others as "getting in their way" when they're working hard to master something. This is especially difficult if they feel it's a boss or other decision-maker who's in the way. In extreme cases, Adventurers might achieve the mastery they crave but lose other valuable aspects of their lives – like jobs and relationships – in the process.

Rebalancing Self-Esteem

Adventurers must try to grasp the big picture to moderate an overblown need for mastery that can quickly turn into an obsession. A view of the overall picture can show Adventurers that sacrificing dependability and relationships for personal accomplishment and expertise does more harm than good in the end. Sometimes the long view must take priority over other, more immediate impulses, even the best of them.

Many philosophers throughout time have said in different ways what the philosopher Voltaire penned, "The best is the enemy of the good." Adventurers would do well to stop and consider this. Instead of obsessing over the things they can master, sometimes they must subordinate this desire to a larger goal that's "good enough" and fosters teamwork and relationship building instead. Perhaps, to balance their self-esteem, they should master working with others.

Self-Respect

For Adventurers, self-respect comes from their ability to think on their feet and solve problems on almost an improvisational level. Their self-respect doesn't involve deep

deliberation. They prefer the action required in assessing a situation and providing a hands-on solution. It doesn't matter which discipline they master – the dynamic is the same. They like to think of themselves as individuals who can manipulate the different parts of their specialty to provide results.

Balanced Self-Respect

Adventurers like themselves when they feel they're flexible and able to deal skillfully with unexpected things that come at them. "Steady as she goes" brings no sense of fulfillment to this type, because they assess themselves by how well they can troubleshoot. In striving for self-respect, Adventurers hone and exercise their skill at handling sudden predicaments.

While most types like some measure of stability, Adventurers find no satisfaction in staying on metaphorical solid ground. They feel better about themselves after they've navigated choppy waters and figured out how to keep the boat upright. To mix metaphors, successfully negotiating twisting trails beats traveling the straight and narrow highway every time. There's no sense of accomplishment for them in sitting around being content.

Because of this, there's nothing like having Adventurers around during a crisis – and Adventurers never feel better about themselves than when they're effectively dealing with one. If there's an emergency, find Adventurers. They'll take care of the situation and gain a feeling of fulfillment simultaneously. They must know they have the skills and flexibility to take care of such matters to respect themselves.

Unbalanced Self-Respect

The most significant problem people with the Adventurer personality type can face is that everybody else in the world *isn't* an Adventurer. To increase their self-respect, some Adventurers may resort to seeking difficulties to conquer or taking risks just to prove their worth to themselves. While they continue to look for problems to solve and things to master, family, friends and coworkers may not be so interested in constantly facing down difficulties to show their skills. Most other people like to avoid problems and don't find overcoming challenges as stimulating as Adventurers do.

Others may come to see Adventurers as careless, unstable, undependable, or, at times, even dangerous. In a social or work setting, this can cause a lot of disharmony. To make these conflicts even worse, Adventurers may not care that much about the opinions of others when they find themselves on a mission. Think of Don Draper on the TV series *Mad Men* and the unpopular, bold risks he frequently took to solve problems at his advertising agency. Such disregard for friends, business associates, and loved ones can be damaging.

When this motivational source is out of balance, Adventurers may like themselves as they solve problems, but they may also find that others aren't so enamored with them. Adventurers should try to understand boosting their self-respect at the expense of others may make their lives less than satisfying when all is said and done.

Rebalancing Self-Esteem

"Reframing" is a psychological trick we can play on ourselves to create a new attitude or encourage a new behavior. When we reframe, we shift our perspective, and this helps to help us respond to things differently.

Adventurers who have run roughshod over other people while overzealously trying to solve problems, create solutions, or master skills can instead try to reframe their social or business networks as other puzzles they need to solve. They can see each unhappy person in their social constellation as a challenge.

If a spouse or friend is upset, what can these types do to make their world better? If the boss is unhappy with their too narrow focus, what can Adventurers do to solve the “boss problem?” These are all worthy challenges for Adventurers who think about them that way. Therapists and counselors can help Adventurers reframe these behaviors, but these types tend to want to develop their people skills in their own ways.

Self-Confidence

While it might sound circular, Adventurers gain confidence when they act in confident ways. With their bold actions, they send a message to themselves that they’re on the right track and can move forward even more confidently. That their chosen action is bold is often the only sign of success they need. Trying new and different things drives the Adventurers’ self-confidence.

Balanced Self-Confidence

Many credit the German writer and statesman Goethe with saying, “Boldness has genius, power and magic in it. Begin it now.” This quotation is music to the ears of Adventurers. A sense of bold self-assurance gives them the thrust they need to move forward in life. They tend to have little regard for traditional standards or rules because they’re too confining and limit the Adventurers’ creative imagination.

Boldly finding new places to be (metaphorically or literally) and new ways to do things pull Adventurers confidently into the future. The “next new thing” energizes them. They’re likely to love change where others dread it. Attraction to bold innovation and problem-solving is what gives them energy and confidence.

Unbalanced Self-Confidence

We admire boldness in our culture. Our heroes are those who are audacious and act in bigger-than-life ways. However, when the need to feel confident becomes so strong that Adventurers act boldly simply for its own sake, it can be damaging.

Such daring action can become disconnected from anything that’s meaningful, such as business plans, security, and the things that make others feel secure and confident. This can detach Adventurers from their social or career networks. While they move forward with great bluster, those around them might simply shake their heads at what they can only see as erratic behavior.

Rebalancing Self-Confidence

Mission statements that describe the vision of organizations or individuals have become a staple for goal-setting and self-improvement. Adventurers would do well to spend a little time expanding their comfort zone and creating their own mission statements.

They also may want to review the mission statement of any organization to which they belong. While they can consider putting their own intrepid spin on them, such statements can help them stay in touch with what’s relevant and important. Maps like these can help these types remain on the road to relevant outcomes even when their need to express their boldness is urging them to veer off it. This counter-

balance to their Prospecting nature may help them stay in touch with the bigger picture and the needs and goals of others.

Pursuing Personal Growth

Knowing about personal strengths and weaknesses is great, but leveraging or addressing them is even better. Let's look at some ways Adventurers can do this.

What Causes Most Problems for Adventurers?

Impulsive Thrill-Seeking

Adventurers often enjoy giving in to their impulses and desires so much so the line between what is acceptable and what isn't can quickly become very blurry. Deeply utilitarian at heart, they're unlikely to worry too much about this, but it's essential to know their limits and not be too selfish or hurt anyone else – otherwise, people with this personality type can be in danger of drifting toward purely sensual or even antisocial activities. Adventurers have the potential to become outstanding maestros in any field they choose – but to achieve that, they must learn how to rein in their spontaneity occasionally.

Adventurers have a sensation-seeking disposition and are fascinated by things they can experience with their five senses. Abstract, theoretical matters don't interest them as much – people with this personality type seek sensual rather than mental stimulation. They're also one of the most impulsive and hot-blooded types, cherishing variety and unpredictability.

Sometimes, they may even come up with artificial challenges or issues just to liven up the environment – Adventurers can't stand boredom and routine. However, it's important to keep this predisposition in check. Otherwise, Adventurers may find themselves in a downward spiral of taking ever greater risks and seeking ever stronger sensations, all in the name of thrill and variety.

This can be especially destructive in romantic relationships – their lovers can either get stressed out because of increasing instability, or join their Adventurer partners, encouraging and enabling their adrenaline-seeking behavior.

Overly Optimistic

Adventurers tend to be over-optimistic and even careless, both in and outside of their professional environments. They want to have fun, to enjoy the moment, and to experience everything there is to experience – and they're used to close brushes with danger, always saved by their highly-developed observational skills and willingness to do everything and anything to achieve their desired goals.

However, even Adventurers sometimes run out of luck and there ceases to be a balance between their self-confidence and self-doubt. People with this personality type often find it difficult to resist the urge to jump in first and ask questions later, but it's important to learn to put everything in perspective.

It's their optimism and belief in their abilities that allow Adventurers to notice and take advantage of various opportunities; however, such traits may also push them to make rash and misinformed decisions, especially if they lack experience in specific areas. Other people may use this tendency to diminish Adventurers' contributions, instead focusing all the attention on mistakes they've made or matters they've left

unattended. Adventurers should try to join forces with others who are more meticulous and disciplined, as such partnerships allow their strengths to flourish.

Rejecting Rational Thinking

Adventurers may also want to pay more attention to their rational thinking skills. People with this personality type tend to dislike abstract, theoretical discussions, and do their best to escape such situations – or pretend they’re interested while their minds are elsewhere. Adventurers are no-nonsense people, always keeping their feet on the ground, and while this is a great trait when it comes to entrepreneurship and professional goals, it’s also important to learn to challenge their urges and instincts, and instead force all important decisions to pass through their rational filter.

If such skills are left underdeveloped, Adventurers may eventually end up with a bag of mistakes, often blaming other people for their own missteps. Focusing on what’s fun while avoiding what’s uncomfortable or difficult isn’t conducive to personal growth.

Struggling with Social Skills

Adventurers’ personality traits (especially their Introversion) can make it difficult for people with this personality type to engage in small talk and may lead to awkwardness in social situations, especially if others aren’t willing to take the lead. Adventurers may often experience anxiety well before social events, knowing they’re likely to be challenging. Being highly practical and observant, these types are more suited to handle such situations compared to Intuitive types, but this doesn’t mean they’ll feel comfortable.

This discomfort with certain social interactions can result in Adventurers becoming highly vulnerable to emotional manipulation. People with this personality type should be aware of this danger and keep an eye out for potential manipulation attempts. Adventurers tend to be very kind and friendly, but their good nature may be abused by less scrupulous individuals.

Making Good Use of Adventurer Traits

Excellent Improvisers

The most impressive trait of all is Adventurers' ability to "think on their feet" – people with this personality type can make snap decisions and can seemingly always escape even the most challenging situations. This makes them excellent improvisers, especially where there's a need to act quickly and come up with an idea without prior planning. Adventurers are fiercely utilitarian, willing to do what it takes to do the job, even if it means breaking with existing traditions – although this is also accompanied by their kind attitude toward other people. This approach may not win them many friends among the more cooperative and stability-oriented types (usually Diplomats or Sentinels), but it's likely to give them the reputation of being highly effective artisans, whatever their crafts may be.

However, Adventurers should pay attention to their tendency to focus on their primary goal and leave all other tasks aside – this attitude allows them to move quickly but poses a danger to their legacy once the main task is finished. Other people, especially those opposed to Adventurers' "Let's get this done!" attitude, may often point fingers at all the little things left unfinished or procedures overlooked, ignoring Adventurers' main achievements. These types are at their best when they're paired with others who can sort out the logistics behind the operation – Adventurers

tend to be brilliant artists and improvisers, but mediocre administrators or logisticians.

Adventurers are bold and able to both notice and act on opportunities that other types can't or don't want to. People with this personality type shouldn't be reluctant to embrace their spontaneity if the circumstances are right – they're well-equipped to deal with unexpected challenges and succeed with scarce resources. Adventurers can excel in the most unfavorable environments, knowing exactly how far they can push limits, what tactics they can pursue, and which resources they can employ.

Clever and Artistic

Adventurers are known for their cleverness, ingenuity, and artistic skills. The term “artist” can mean many things when talking about them – many are artists in the true sense of the word, but some also use their excellent grasp of the real world in other areas. There's no other personality type as adept at noticing what is likely to excite our senses – Adventurers can easily become masters of sound, color, flavor, design etc. This peculiar trait usually makes these types very creative and productive individuals, especially once they get enough freedom to follow their own paths.

Once they find a niche that's right for them, they can then follow their instincts instead of listening to critics and naysayers. To paraphrase playwright George Bernard Shaw, “The careful man adapts himself to the world; the reckless one persists in trying to adapt the world to himself. Therefore, all progress depends on the reckless man.” It's important for Adventurers to know their limitations, while not being afraid to capitalize on their strengths – no other personality type knows how to enjoy the present moment as much as they do, and no one should underestimate the importance of their skills.

Unpredictable and Exciting

Adventurers' boldness and thirst for adrenaline are also likely to be very attractive to other people, including potential romantic partners. Just like many other things in their lives, Adventurers' relationships are full of both excitement and unpredictability, as they're able to find something interesting to do and to keep the flames of romance burning brightly.

However, Adventurers often avoid committing to anything or anyone. Knowing full well that life is unpredictable, they're likely to live in the present instead of planning for the future. Many Adventurers are happy with this approach – after all, “Seize the day!” is their motto – but it's important to remember that many other people expect them to commit to their relationships relatively early and may get hurt if their Adventurer lovers don't seem that interested.

People with this personality type don't need to worry too much about attracting partners as it's likely their partners will find them instead – however, Adventurers may need to work on recognizing (and, if necessary, managing) their partners' expectations if they want to have strong, lasting relationships. The same principles apply to non-romantic relationships as well – other people may be surprised by their unwillingness to settle down and stop wandering.

Conclusion

Adventurers find acting in ways that bring about immediate, productive results gives them meaning and purpose, and they always seek to develop on that level. They hone their very lives to be fine and effective tools. Such self-refinement as artisans

in all senses of the word is Adventurers' preferred method of growth. That's the easy way for them to grow.

The harder way Adventurers can grow involves stopping long enough to thoughtfully plan and create consistency in their lives. Taking the time to see how other people are doing in the midst of their flurry of activity can bring them more satisfaction. Most people need others to comfortably fit into their lives – and there's happiness for Adventurers who figure out how to do that well.

There are classes everywhere called "life skills courses," verifying what everyone already knows. Life is a skill. It involves skill building. It's something to tinker with. It's something to polish. Developing their lives and attaining personal growth fits the Adventurers' foundational skillset perfectly.

Additional Tools and Tests

Want to dig even deeper into your personal growth? If you have access to the toolkits area of the website, we offer a variety of additional tools and tests to help you explore.

Locus of Control Test

Dig deeper into who or what you feel is responsible for your life satisfaction, happiness, and level of fulfillment.

Emotional Intelligence Test

Find out how good you are at understanding your own emotions as well as paying attention to the emotions of others with this test.

Confidence Test

How much do you believe in your competence and ability to successfully follow through on the choices you make? Let's find out.

Dark and Light Side Test

Your moral choices may not be as simple as you think. This test asks you to go deep and take an honest look at your attitudes.

Resilience and Grit Test

Some people are hard to knock down; some find it easy to get back up; and some are both or neither. Which group do you belong to?

Coping Styles Test

There are four primary ways to cope with crisis. This test explores the dominant and secondary techniques you're likely to turn to.

Optimism and Pessimism Test

This simple test measures your levels of both optimism and pessimism in a novel way. Find out where you fall in each of these areas.

Imagination and Magic Beliefs Test

How does your imagination work? What is your belief about magic? Explore the role of imagination, magic, and belief in your life.

Traveling Preferences Test

This simple test delves into your preferred choices during those times when you leave home to explore the world.

Romantic Relationships



People with the Adventurer personality type are often a complete mystery to others, even surprising their long-term partners from time to time. Although they tend to be quite sensitive, emotional individuals, their extreme vulnerability to criticism, conflict, and adversity results in their need to keep those traits well-hidden from the world. If their partners are willing to accept them for who they are, however, Adventurers also can be incredibly warm and enthusiastic.

Another defining Adventurer trait is an intense focus on the present. This makes for people who are very much “in the moment,” but there are downsides to this. Adventurers don’t always learn as much from their past romances as they could. In addition, their inability to tolerate discomfort in the present moment may lead to their bailing as soon as their relationships face challenges, stumbling blocks, or lulls. When it’s time to change old patterns, negotiate tricky situations, and make long-term plans and commitments, some Adventurers are tempted to cut and run. From the outside, it looks as if they’re utterly devoted one moment and then totally disconnected the next.

Adventurers face another major challenge in their relationships: feelings. The world of feelings can be gloriously all-consuming, from desire to joy to love itself, and people with this personality type tend to give themselves over to their emotions. At times, however, emotional regulation is necessary, whether it means taking a moment to cool down during an argument or considering criticism before defending against it. This skill doesn't come easily to Adventurers, and unless they consciously develop it, they may overreact to criticism or snags in their relationships, taking every slight – real and imagined – personally.

When they bring these traits into balance, Adventurers are generous and enthusiastic lovers. Always seeking fresh ways to express their affection and enrich their relationships, they delight in making their partners feel special. For Adventurers, ideal romance is founded on true love, simple pleasures, and plenty of sparks.

Dating and Single Adventurers

Feelings and emotions underpin every aspect of the Adventurer personality, defining their relationships as well. These types are likely to be very caring, loyal individuals who are always looking for ways to surprise their sweethearts. Fortunately, this isn't a difficult task for Adventurers, thanks to their mix of practicality and spontaneity. They do tend to have relatively poor long-term planning skills, but they almost never run out of things to do in the present. This helps them bring freshness and unpredictability into their relationships.

Adventurers are realistic, well-grounded partners, willing to spend a lot of time and effort making sure that their significant others are cared for and feel special. People with this personality type have excellent listening skills and are, generally, very interested in knowing how their lovers feel. Logic, rationality, and strategic planning

aren't their strongest suits, and most Adventurers are more than happy to let their partners take the lead in those areas. They're perfectly capable of holding up their ends of their relationships, though, especially when it comes to emotional matters.

Finally, it's important to note that people with the Adventurer personality type need to know that their love and attention are valued and appreciated. They're unlikely to ask for this validation, but they may feel frustrated and disappointed if their beloveds don't make efforts to express their feelings. Although this expression needn't be verbal – Adventurers believe in actions, not words – it's crucial that Adventurers know their partners reciprocate their feelings.

Adventurers in the Bedroom

From the sexual perspective, Adventurer personalities are likely to be very sensual and attentive. They love to engage all five senses and do everything to make sure that their partners are fully satisfied as well. Even though Adventurers tend to be relatively reserved or even shy in social settings, these masks come off when they're with those they completely trust. When Adventurers reveal this rarely-seen side of their personality, their sweethearts are likely to be very pleasantly surprised.

As in other areas of their lives, Adventurers seek pleasure in the present moment, and they may feel less devoted to their partners if their sex lives plateau or fall into a rut. They may even be tempted to stray or end relationships if the spark fades. If the romance is meaningful, however, Adventurers are more than capable of reigniting the flame. They can use their creativity to look for new ways to please themselves and their partners, including introducing novelty, play, and experimentation into even the longest-standing of relationships.

Potential Personality Pairings

The Right Approach

Adventurers are typically affectionate and caring toward those they love. They know how to have a good time and delight in the moment, but they also contribute to their relationships in practical and consistent ways, proving to their beloveds that they're trustworthy and reliable. Despite their craving for novelty, Adventurers recognize when relationships are too precious to lose.

Romance is far from an exact science, and Adventurers intrinsically understand that putting their best foot forward achieves the best results. With so many personality variables in play, romance can highlight their strengths, including open-mindedness and adaptability. Relationships can also provide Adventurers with invaluable opportunities to learn and develop, growing into the individuals they want to see reflected in the eyes of their sweethearts.

The information presented in this section can help Adventurers build and navigate successful, loving relationships. With that in mind, we'll offer a useful look at some of the ways Adventurers and other types are likely to interact. Additionally, we'll help Adventurers to maximize their chances for happiness by providing tips for creating fulfilling, balanced relationships with those types.

Adventurer-Analyst Relationships



Adventurers decide matters through a more emotional filter; Analysts prefer a more rational one. The first is also more in touch with the concrete world, where the second dwells in a world of ideas and theories. In romance, opposites have been known to attract on occasion and, even more, to make their other halves more complete. That potential is there when Adventurers and Analysts fall in love. If they avoid making their differences points of contention, they're likely to find something unique and interesting with a kind of growth potential neither would experience alone.

Balanced Adventurer-Analyst Relationships

Open Minds, Good Times

In the early stages of their shared relationships, Adventurers might delight in the novelty of Analysts' ideas, particularly if these ideas relate to something tangible. Adventurers might also enjoy helping break Analyst sweethearts out of their serious, intellectual shells. With their carefree, inventive mindsets, these types find it gratifying to introduce Analysts to new ways of kicking back and having fun.

As these love affairs progress, Adventurers often appreciate Analysts' lack of concern about conventions and traditions. Adventurers love to try new things and embrace new trends, and they crave life partners who won't hold them back in their experimentation. Analysts typically are unconcerned with aesthetics, and they won't object when Adventurers break the mold—whether that means wearing wild new outfits or performing edgy songs during karaoke date nights.

Adventurers also appreciate the breathing room likely to be granted by Analyst partners. At times Analysts need to ruminate on their ideas and theories and go into their own mind palaces. Adventurers may not go along for the ride, but they can take advantage of these opportunities to discover more about the world in their particular way. Nobody can ever accuse an Adventurer–Analyst pair of smothering each other.

Unbalanced Adventurer–Analyst Relationships

Mirror, Mirror

In the dating process, some Adventurers might be turned off by Analysts. These types have a highly developed aesthetic sense, but when it becomes unbalanced, Adventurers veer into superficiality, becoming obsessed with image or appearances. These Adventurers may be embarrassed even to be seen with Analysts, who are hardly known for their sharp sense of style.

If Adventurers try to change Analysts – encouraging them to shop at cooler stores, for example – they're fighting a losing battle. Analysts have a good measure of self-respect, but they rarely see the point of trying to impress other people. They won't withhold their opinions, either, and Adventurers may find themselves being criticized for focusing on appearances rather than more “important” matters.

Criticism and Contempt

Lovers in Adventurer–Analyst relationships may not always appreciate how their differences can actually serve as strengths. As their romances progress, conversations may regularly spiral into criticism or even contempt. Adventurers may occasionally find themselves taken aback by Analysts’ bluntness. In return, Adventurers might hurt their Analyst partners more than they realize.

Such conversations follow common patterns. Because Adventurers prefer to focus on actionable matters and the present moment rather than abstractions and hypothetical scenarios, their Analyst partners might accuse them of being shallow, unimaginative, or lacking in intellectual curiosity. Adventurers might also find themselves targeted for their interest in “frivolous” matters, such as fun, fashion, or receiving attention from others.

This is a two-way street, however. Adventurers may lose patience with their Analyst sweethearts’ need to theorize about everything, which to them may seem stodgy, boring, or pointless. Given Analysts’ disregard for such nitty-gritty, practical matters, Adventurers may find – to their dismay – that household chores regularly fall to them. For both types, stress levels can escalate in tandem with their increasing domestic chaos, as laundry piles grow and dirty dishes overfill the sink.

Although Adventurers are generally good-natured, they readily externalize their feelings – including, at times, their negative judgments. Because Analysts less readily express their emotions, Adventurers might not even realize when they’ve hurt their beloveds’ feelings. The result can cause pain and frustration on both sides, leaving Adventurers to wonder if it isn’t time to move on.

Rebalancing Adventurer–Analyst Relationships

Inviting Analysts Along

Rather than becoming irritated at what they perceive as Analysts' stodginess, Adventurers can encourage Analyst partners to come along on one of their adventures. By inviting Analysts into their world of fun and discovery, Adventurers get a win-win: quality time with their significant others and the joy of sharing a good time.

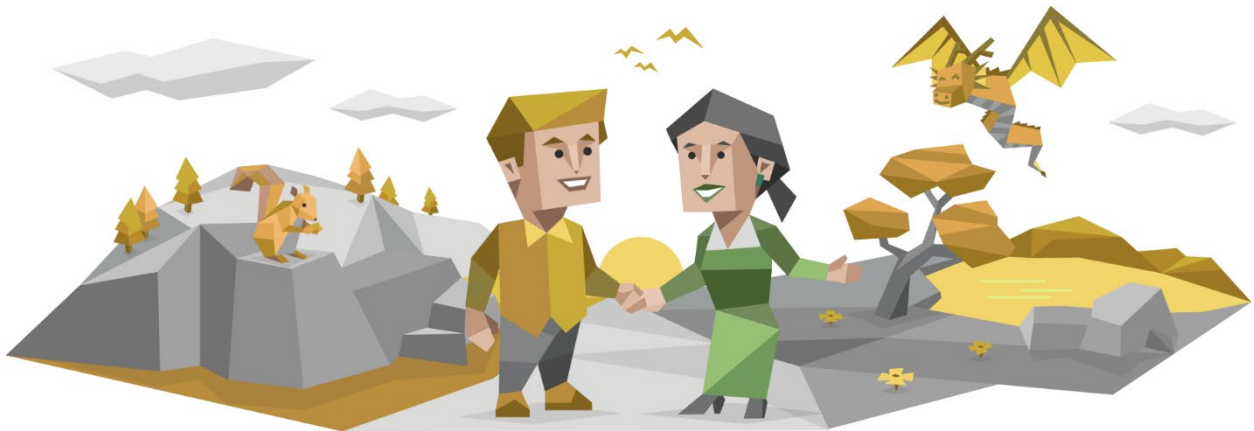
To persuade Analysts to participate in new activities, Adventurers can highlight the benefits or upsides of a particular adventure – whether that's taking advantage of a once-in-a-lifetime opportunity, seeing a new artist or band before they catch on, or just a stress-relieving hike and the resulting health benefits. Analysts think rationally, and they allocate their time and energy accordingly. Without losing their sense of spontaneity, Adventurers can focus just enough on the *why* of a particular activity to interest their Analyst partners.

Outsource, Automate, Skip

As relationships progress and couples move in together, they need to find sustainable ways to manage their shared homes. Because hands-on, mundane details are of less interest to Analysts, Adventurers may end up with more than their share of household responsibilities. As a result, Adventurers may feel bogged down by chores and duties that cramp their style – or they might be tempted to blow off these responsibilities, leaving their homes in a state of chaos. Although this might sound like a small matter, the division of domestic responsibilities can become a major issue in long-term relationships.

In this situation, Adventurers should sit down with their partners and – tedious though it may seem – write out a list of all recurring chores, payments, and tasks. Fortunately, the next step is much more fun: identify everything that can be outsourced, automated, or skipped altogether. This may mean budgeting for a cleaning service, setting aside some time to establish recurring bill payments, or even parting with rarely used items that require regular maintenance. By taking these steps, Adventurers and their Analyst partners can lighten their load of chores and responsibilities, leaving them more time and energy for pursuits that light them up instead.

Adventurer-Diplomat Relationships



While both base their decisions on humanistic, emotional foundations, Adventurers have a bias toward practical action, and Diplomats favor a less concrete approach. Diplomats might be at home reading books on ending poverty and dreaming of material equality in the world; Adventurers might just as likely be out pounding nails along with other volunteers with Habitat for Humanity. But romances between dreamers and doers are often successful. When they fall in love, they sometimes find the dimensions their partners add are just what they needed in their lives.

Balanced Adventurer-Diplomat Relationships

Free Spirits

When they first date, Adventurers' free spirits and enthusiasm for living in the moment are enthralling for Diplomats. Given their curiosity about other people, Adventurers may be drawn to Diplomats' unusual ways of expressing themselves and their almost mystical presence. These two types tend to find a fair amount of shared ground, including mutual desires for freedom and novelty. As a result, when they begin dating, it can be a truly exciting time full of energy and anticipation.

As their relationships mature, Adventurers and Diplomats can bring out the best in each other. Neither is a slave to convention, so each is likely to grant the other the freedom to pursue unusual interests, seize new opportunities, and grow to their full potential. Adaptable and flexible, they can respond to unexpected challenges as a united front, weathering storms and embracing change when necessary. Over time, Adventurers may find that Diplomats deepen and enrich their lives, helping them to identify and embrace their values without losing their free-spirited spontaneity.

Unbalanced Adventurer-Diplomat Relationships

Drama Ensues

Adventurers live in the moment, expressing themselves and their feelings readily. This can be a wonderful match for Diplomats in the early stages of romance. As time progresses and the stakes get higher, however, Adventurers may inadvertently rile Diplomats' sensitivity. They're often surprised by the extent of Diplomats' inner landscapes, including the amount of time they spend dwelling on past issues and dreaming about the future. Unbeknownst to Adventurers, Diplomats might be

engaging in such things as mulling over conversations from days before, putting their partners on a pedestal, or planning their future lives together.

When Adventurers levy criticism – even a mild one – it can suck the wind out of Diplomats' sails, particularly if it affects their visions of the future. Given their future orientation, Diplomats might assume that Adventurers are interested in pursuing long-term relationships when they're actually just enjoying the present moment. As a result, Diplomats' typical sensitivity can be heightened in arguments with their Adventurer sweethearts, creating a high level of drama. Such tension can cause Adventurers to act in unbalanced ways, such as leaving these issues unresolved, escaping conversations, or even bailing on relationships altogether.

Adventurer-Diplomat households might find themselves embroiled in drama for another reason as well: household chaos. Neither of these personality types is keen to commit to chore schedules or regular responsibilities. Although they might not seem like major issues, late bill payments and piles of mail can escalate the tension in any home.

I Love You, Now Change

Independent to the core, Adventurers dislike the idea of anyone trying to change them. In an unbalanced relationship, however, Diplomats – with their love of abstractions and possibilities – may try to turn Adventurers into theoretical, metaphysical thinkers. Over time, these Diplomats may grow tired of what they see as their Adventurer lovers' superficial need for novelty and good times.

Adventurers aren't always immune to the temptation to change their Diplomat partners, either. As their connections progress, they may become annoyed by Diplomats' tendency to live in their heads and dream about ways to help others

instead of embracing experiences and taking practical action. Adventurers can also become frustrated when Diplomats – particularly Introverted types – need to stay home and relax rather than go out and have a good time. Unless they learn to appreciate the differences between themselves and their partners, Adventurers may abandon their Diplomat significant others in search of greener pastures.

Rebalancing Adventurer–Diplomat Relationships

Ease and Plenty

In the early stages of their love affairs, Adventurers and Diplomats can thrive on each other's spontaneous energy and love of possibilities. As time progresses, however, these relationships – like all relationships – need solid, relatively predictable foundations. If they're constantly fretting about financial issues and car maintenance, these couples inevitably struggle to maintain their closeness and mutual respect.

As in relationships with Analysts, Adventurers should sit down with their Diplomat partners and make plans to handle recurring chores, payments, and tasks. Then, these two types can indulge their creative sides, identifying everything that can be outsourced, automated, or skipped altogether. Decluttering and donating unused items, and then arranging for a cleaning service once a week can go a long way toward making chores more equitable, and automatic bill pay apps can help take the guesswork out of handling household finances.

Over the long run, it's also important for Adventurers and Diplomats to face financial realities. Many of these can be automated or outsourced, as well, such as automatic contributions to retirement accounts or tax planning. By taking these steps, Adventurers and their Diplomat partners can spend more time and energy on their strengths, forging a strong connection rather than fretting over everyday matters.

Time Together, Time Apart

Adventurers and Diplomats might dive into romance headlong, wanting to spend great swathes of time with each other. As their partnerships progress, however, they need to set aside time to pursue their individual interests. Otherwise, Adventurers may exhaust their Diplomat partners with fun outings and events, leaving Diplomats insufficient time to tend to their ideas and dreams.

By balancing time together with time apart, these lovers can sidestep the need to change each other. Adventurers can venture to gallery openings, open mic nights, and parties to their hearts' delight, and Diplomats can nurture their Intuitive trait by reading, journaling, daydreaming, planning, or even setting up discussion groups or book clubs. Once they've satisfied these differing needs, Adventurers and Diplomats can focus on spending quality time together, doing mutually enjoyable activities.

Adventurer–Sentinel Relationships



While Adventurers and Sentinels might share many of the same preferences, their contrasting Prospecting and Judging traits make all the difference. Like the rudder on

a ship decides its direction, these opposing characteristics tend to turn Sentinels right and Adventurers left.

However, both these types enjoy the practicality that comes with living in the “real world.” Adventurers–Sentinel couples don’t have to put up with all the theories and abstractions they might with Analysts or Diplomats. Each likes to live practical lives where they manipulate material things. In sharing this focus, these sweethearts speak the same down-to-earth language.

Balanced Adventurer–Sentinel Relationships

Practical Action

When Adventurers and Sentinels date, they discover a mutual love of quick, practical action. Thanks to their shared Observant trait, both types live firmly in the “here and now,” focusing on life as it is, rather than life as it could be. They don’t have to put up with all the theories and abstractions that they might with Analysts or Diplomats.

Over time, Adventurers and Sentinels can become deeply attuned to each other. This can manifest itself even in the ways they communicate. Their conversations often center on specific, actionable issues – not the future-oriented vagaries that those with the Intuitive trait would favor. As a result, Adventurer–Sentinel couples can operate as effective teams, solving problems and facing challenges in real time.

Novelty and Security

Adventurer–Sentinel couples can complement each other in balanced ways, providing a perfect yin to the other’s yang. This might surprise some people, given Adventurers’ love of novelty and Sentinels’ love of security. It’s true that Adventurers

have a reputation for commitment-phobia, but, fortunately, they're unlikely to gravitate toward Sentinels until they're mature and see the value of settling down.

During long-term relationships with Sentinels, Adventurers find support, care, and consistency – three things they may not even realize they crave. Many Adventurers aren't recognized as bright or gifted as children, and devoted Sentinels can help them restore their sense of self-worth. Meanwhile, Adventurers get a kick out of exposing Sentinels to new things. After all, even Sentinels crave a little excitement in their lives, as long as it's not too disruptive.

Unbalanced Adventurer-Sentinel Relationships

Repetitive Roles

In the early stages of their shared romance, Adventurers may be fascinated by the differences between themselves and their Sentinel partners. Over time, however, Sentinel-Adventurer couples can fall into unbalanced roles that mimic a parent and a child, with Sentinels managing all the responsibilities and Adventurers initiating all the fun. At first, Adventurers may not mind this arrangement, but this dynamic prevents them from developing into their full potential –and can spark frustration and resentment in their Sentinel partners. If these relationships progress too far in this direction, it may seem as if Sentinels are smothering, controlling, or even infantilizing their Adventurer lovers.

When Adventurers feel that “smother-love,” they often back away from the relationship. This can trigger Sentinels, who crave stability and commitment, to attempt to regain control. Sentinels may respond to this by redoubling their caretaking efforts, making Adventurers feel even more trapped. The result is tumultuous, unhappy relationships where neither type feels free to be themselves.

Commitment Mismatch

It's no secret that Adventurers tend to be less keen on commitment than Sentinels. As we've established, Adventurers might not even consider Sentinel partners until they feel ready to settle into long-term relationships. That said, Sentinels make up a sizable portion of the population, so statistically, Adventurers are likely to encounter them in the dating pool.

In Adventurer–Sentinel relationships that lose balance, Adventurers might feel as if their sweethearts are pushing them to make commitments or major decisions – such as defining their relationships or moving in together – before they feel ready. They may also perceive their Sentinel partners as needy or clingy. Meanwhile, Adventurers might struggle to understand or validate their Sentinel partners' natural need for commitment and stability.

Even in other areas of their love affairs, this disjointedness between Adventurers' Prospecting trait and Sentinels' Judging trait can create tension. Adventurers' spontaneity and changeability can cause stress for their Sentinel partners, who rely on tradition and predictability in order to feel grounded. Adventurers might not understand why their partners become anxious about trying new restaurants or changing travel plans at the last minute. Over time, Sentinels' resistance to change can wear on Adventurers, leading to their looking for escape routes.

Rebalancing Adventurer–Sentinel Relationships

Appreciation and Affirmation

In relationships with Sentinels – or any personality type, for that matter – it's important for Adventurers to stay true to themselves. When they feel trapped or

stifled, they may indulge their instinct to move on and seek new relationships. That said, even if Adventurers aren't ready to commit to major transitions like marriage, they can still offer their partners reassurance and support. This is especially important with Sentinel partners, who, although they don't generally ask for it, thrive on recognition and praise.

Adventurers can set themselves the goal of expressing appreciation for their Sentinel partners on a daily basis. This can take the form of verbal thank-yous and compliments, but it doesn't have to – Adventurers' concrete, spontaneous natures can be an asset here. They can stay on the lookout for creative ways to validate and appreciate their partners, whether writing songs for them or treating them to date nights they'll love. When Sentinels receive this type of consistent affirmation, they can relax, making them less likely to control or smother their Adventurer beloveds.

R-E-S-P-E-C-T

In unbalanced Adventurer–Sentinel relationships, Sentinels end up taking on nearly all of the household responsibilities. Unbeknownst to Adventurers, these Sentinels may also keep score in their minds, noting all the ways they do more than their partners to keep things running smoothly. The result, unfortunately, is resentment and contempt – not exactly the ingredients for romance.

The solution to this situation is respect: both self-respect and respect for their partners. Adventurers do best when they notice the scales of responsibility are tilted too far in their partners' direction. In this situation, Adventurers recognize that they're capable of helping out more – a hallmark of self-respect. They then respectfully ask their partners how they can better help out. Adventurers can ask targeted, concrete questions such as:

- What tasks do you find the most burdensome?
- I have a free hour, so what can I tackle to allow you some time to do what you want?
- Are there any chores or errands that we can do together?

In balanced long-term relationships, both types make consistent contributions, demonstrating their care by sharing necessary responsibilities.

Adventurer-Explorer Relationships



Someone to explore with – at least, that’s what one might assume is the draw when Adventurers fall in love with other Explorers. But even such a match made in heaven can have nooks and crannies that make them less than perfect under the right circumstances. The Observant and Prospecting combination produces much energy and movement and, when multiplied in such couples, can be exciting. But doubling this characteristic in romantic relationships can also be a drain and subject these partners to unstable impulsivity. Both types may need to understand what commitment means to them and be honest with each other.

Balanced Adventurer-Explorer Relationships

Smooth Sailing

Old saws would have us believe that “opposites attract,” as though the human heart were the pole of a magnet. Fortunately, no two people are exactly alike, even if they share the same basic personality traits. There are adaptations and nuances that prevent relationships between two Explorers from being the same as looking into a mirror. There can be plenty of the differences that keep romance interesting even between couples of the same type.

In the early stages of their relationships, Adventurers may be exhilarated to be with lovers who share their craving for novelty. When Adventurers and other Explorers come together romantically, their emphasis is on playful, exciting experiences. Spending time together, they may feel even more alive than usual, creating a flirtatious, vibrant, almost electric energy between them. Because they often share similar views on commitment, these two types can enjoy the moment fully without having mismatched expectations about the future.

As these relationships progress, such couples can maintain flexibility not seen among any other paired types. Their partnerships are founded on the “here and now,” and any storms between them tend to pass quickly. Balanced Adventurer-Explorer couples sometimes engage in heated exchanges, but they don’t hold grudges, and they aren’t overly sensitive to criticism. As a result, their occasional arguments don’t compromise the foundation of their relationships. There’s typically a certain resilience with these couples who live lives that allow for a certain amount of flux.

Big Moves, Lasting Adventures

In the early stages of Adventurer–Explorer relationships, each may orchestrate large romantic gestures and “wow” their partners. When the mood strikes them, they go big: skywriting, lavish gifts, impromptu vacations, and so on. As their relationships progress, these impulses might become less frequent, but balanced Adventurer–Explorer couples still try at times to sweep each other off their feet.

Even as their shared relationships mature, there are plenty of opportunities for these couples to share novel experiences. To stay connected, Adventurers and their Explorer partners can pursue common interests in arts, crafts, and even business. They can also integrate and expand their social circles in harmony, enjoying contact with all sorts of interesting people. In balanced Adventurer–Explorer love affairs, these couples continue to embark on shared journeys even as the decades tick by. Such bonding of interests can provide creative stimulation and strong partnerships that last lifetimes.

Unbalanced Adventurer–Explorer Relationships

Conquests and Capriciousness

Explorers are perhaps the most mercurial types when it comes to romance. They may play the field as long as they can, resisting being “tied down” in favor of the chase. Both Adventurers and other Explorers often bounce from partner to partner, looking for fulfillment in novelty and new conquests. They leave unfinished business in their wake, sometimes breaking off relationships without even trying to explain why.

At some point, usually with age, many Explorers decide to settle down. However, they don't always date with such long-term plans in mind. Their decision to commit may be spontaneous and almost impulsive. When couples include not one but two Explorers, it's easy to see how their romance can be intense and unpredictable. These partners might enter their relationships with the intent to live in the moment and see where it goes, but if one type becomes attached and craves more of a commitment, they may end up deeply hurt or disappointed.

Burnout

In the early stages of dating, Adventurer-Explorer couples might feel giddy about all the things they can experience together: travel, adventure, sports, parties, art exhibits, restaurants, bars, and so on. Alas, even the most energetic Explorers can only bear such intensity for so long before it becomes too much.

Over time, Adventurer-Explorer couples may tire of expending so much energy and experiencing so much excitement. They might not realize this is the issue, however. Instead, they might attribute their feelings of burnout to their romance, concluding that their partners are responsible for their loss of enthusiasm and *joie de vivre*.

Rebalancing Adventurer-Explorer Relationships

Downtime and Stability

Although it runs counter to their natures, Adventurer-Explorer couples experiencing burnout need to cultivate stability and downtime in their lives. To do this, they can minimize needless stress by automating and outsourcing routine tasks and responsibilities. They might also plan to spend time at home on a regular basis – for example, cozy “Netflix-and-chill” nights once or twice a week. By dedicating time to

recharging their figurative batteries together, they can experience their relationships without distractions and stimuli from the outside world. They might even sweeten these evenings at home by establishing some quiet traditions, such as cooking new dishes together.

It's also important for these couples to give each other some space. It's perfectly fine if Adventurers want to go to an art opening and their Explorer sweethearts want to have dinner with friends. As long as they still nurture their shared interests and embark on adventures together, Adventurer-Explorer relationships may actually be strengthened by occasional time apart.

Remembering Why They Fell in Love

The honeymoon phase of romantic relationships may be sweet, but it isn't sustainable. Over time, even devoted couples can feel restless. Adventurers may be tempted to give up on relationships almost on a whim, to the extent that they lose sight of what drew them to their partners in the first place.

In this situation, it's helpful for Adventurers to remember *why* they fell in love. Before giving up on their relationships, they might want to sit down and list all the qualities that initially appealed to them about their significant others. These should be qualities that their partners still embody – for example, their intelligence, their honesty, or their wit.

Adventurers who truly struggle to remember their lovers' good qualities might try looking through old photos, recalling the details of their first dates, or even chatting with a few friends to see what they remember. After drawing up such lists, Adventurers might be moved by how many strengths and gifts their partners bring

to their lives. If they'd like, Adventurers can share their lists with their partners, but it's fine for them to keep them as private reminders of why they fell in love.

Conclusion

Relationships present Adventurers with wonderful opportunities to grow. Normally, people with this personality type feel tempted to bounce from option to option, but love can give them powerful motivation to explore the full range of life with another person. This won't happen overnight, but Adventurers are fully capable of balancing their desire for novelty with the demands of shared relationships, appreciating the inspiration and guidance they can gain from partners they love and trust. Dedicated life partners not only brighten Adventurers' days but also offer them wellsprings of care and support.

In balanced relationships, Adventurers push for positive change, enabling both their partners and themselves to reach higher and do more than they could alone. When romance is founded on acceptance, honesty, and respect, there's no reason why Adventurers cannot enjoy lasting and balanced love with any personality type.

Additional Tools and Tests

Want to dig even deeper into your romantic relationships? If you have access to the toolkits area of the website, we offer a variety of additional tools and tests to help you explore.

[Get to Know Your Partner](#)

Would you like to get to know your partner a little better? Try this simple, but very fun and effective, game.

[Couple Analysis](#)

A great tool for couples. Learn how your personalities are likely to interact, and how you can connect on an even deeper level.

[Type Guesser \(Romance\)](#)

Are you trying to figure out what personality type your partner belongs to? You may find that this simple tool helps.

[Romantic Fulfillment Test](#)

Grasp the roles that confidence and optimism play in your relationships, as well as what makes someone a good match for you.

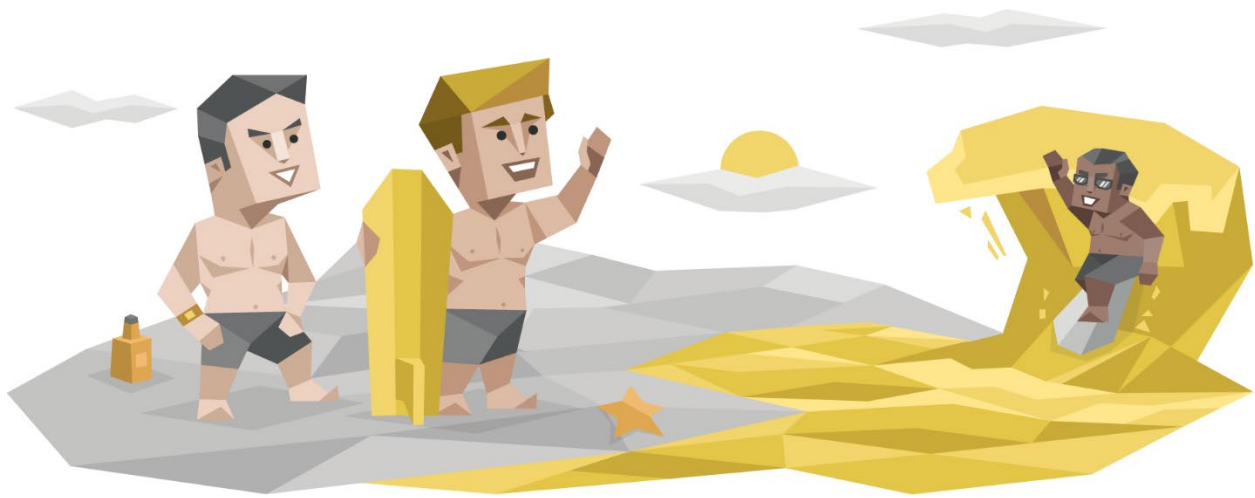
[Intertype Test](#)

Do you have a partner? Do you want to understand your relationship better? Learn more about it with our easy Intertype Test.

Loyalty Test

With this test, you will find out how you build relationships and loyalty in four major areas: Romance, Work, Friendships, and Family.

Friendships



Easygoing and Spontaneous Friends

When it comes to friendship, Adventurers are some of the most comfortable people around. Laid back and spontaneous, people with the Adventurer personality type don't bog things down with arguments or structured long-term plans. Intellectually exhausting pastimes like debates over European economic policy don't tend to hold their attention long. The here and now is what's important to Adventurers, and they love spending time with their friends engaging in casual, fun activities.

Adventurers believe in action, not words. They talk about what "is," not what "could," "should," or "will be," and then they *do it*. This passion for action is a blessing for these types since it helps them get past their shyness in meeting new people. They're sensitive – much more so than most – and it takes time for them to build enough trust with new friends to open up and feel natural.

People with this personality type are happy to get along with just about anyone, but potential friends must ease up on being too judgmental or demanding. If new

acquaintances start things out by explaining, “You’d do way better if...” it’s unlikely they’ll ever be close – Adventurers just take these remarks too personally.

If their friends keep things supportive and easygoing, Adventurers are happy to return the favor with added warmth and laughter. When they’re with friends they trust, Adventurers know how to relax, shedding rules, traditions, and expectations and just enjoy themselves.

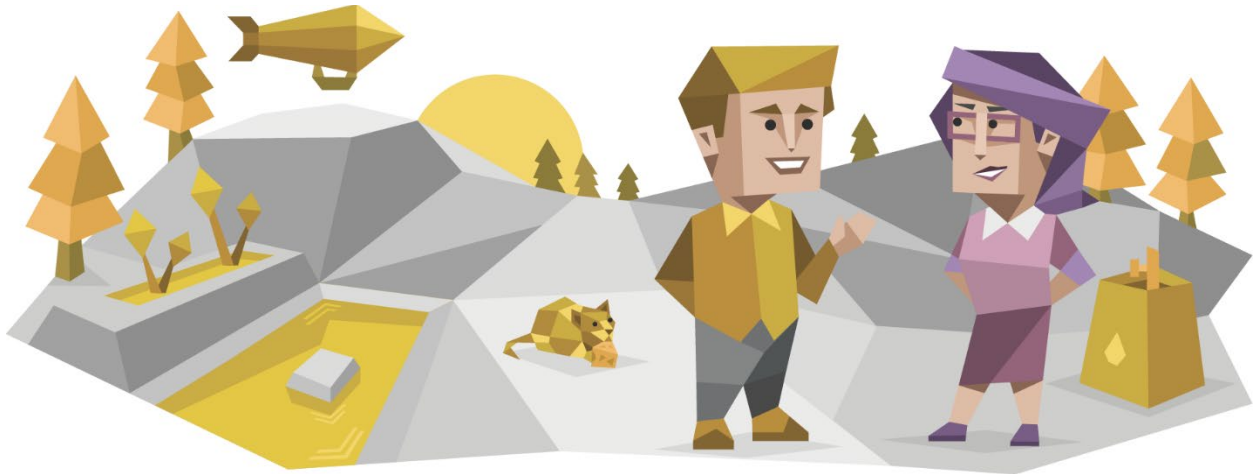
Adventurers’ relaxed, non-judgmental attitudes make it easy for them to get along with others, but it’s not always the same way around. Those types who prefer safe, structured environments might struggle in such friendships, especially if they lecture Adventurers on how they’re living their lives. As with any criticism, Adventurers feel such judgmental friends can do their own thing and should leave Adventurers to do theirs.

Adventurers and Friends of Other Types

Adventurers are popular, as their open-mindedness, interesting hobbies, and relaxed attitude are attractive to a remarkably broad range of personality types. With so many acquaintances, Adventurers are sure to strike up deeper friendships with at least a few.

Let’s examine the challenges and joys that Adventurers are likely to face in friendships with other people belonging to each of the major Roles – Analysts, Diplomats, Sentinels, and Explorers. We’ll look at some ways Adventurers can balance their style to make their friendships more valuable, fair, and fulfilling.

Adventurer–Analyst Friends



Friends who bring different perspectives to the table are sometimes the best friends to have. When Adventurers (Observant and Feeling) befriend Analysts (Intuitive and Thinking), the balance and counterbalance within their relationships can be sublime. Adventurers bring spontaneity and passion, while Analysts offer ideas and insights, both potentially contributing to rich, multidimensional friendships.

Balanced Adventurer–Analyst Friendships

Combining Strategy and Action

The best thing about having Analyst friends is that they're able to act as rational, insightful, and strategically-minded advisors for highly practical (and sometimes impatient) Adventurers. Analysts pride themselves in being objective, even with their closest friends. Companions belonging to this type group are likely to have few qualms about criticizing Adventurers' latest ideas or specific actions. Being direct themselves, Adventurers tend to feel right at home when it comes to such an approach – if the criticism isn't too harsh or personal. Analysts' penchant for conceptual thinking may frustrate Adventurers, but having such friends who are able

and willing to look at things from different viewpoints can be invaluable in many situations.

Adventurers and Analysts also share a desire for efficiency. If the topic is right, otherwise-aloof Adventurers may spend hours tinkering with systems or polishing their techniques. With Analysts trying to understand the principles behind the functionality, and Adventurers experimenting with what's in front of them, such partnerships can be mutually rewarding. Their principles and perspectives may not necessarily overlap, but there should be enough common ground for both types to benefit from opportunities to share their thoughts with each other.

Unbalanced Adventurer-Analyst Friendships

Tangible versus Conceptual

Adventurers and Analysts also have their fair share of differences that may cause tension in their mutual friendships. The most important difference is the way these types take in information. Adventurers are highly practical, live-in-the-moment individuals – as far as they're concerned, it's the real, tangible things that matter most. Analysts mostly focus on what they can imagine and deduce, taking pleasure in coming up with various concepts and ideas. While there are ways to combine the two approaches (for instance, while working on projects requiring both planning and execution), these two dissimilar thinking styles can be major barriers to communication and mutual understanding.

Another important difference is that, unlike Adventurers, Analyst types usually find it difficult to support their friends emotionally. Analysts can have very strong feelings, but they're neither comfortable with nor experienced in coping with the emotions of others. Adventurers enjoy sharing their feelings with friends and developing strong

support networks, so they can be surprised when their Analyst friends find it difficult to develop similar emotional connections. Adventurers shouldn't take this personally, as Analysts are notorious for their focus on logic and rationality, regardless of whose company they're in.

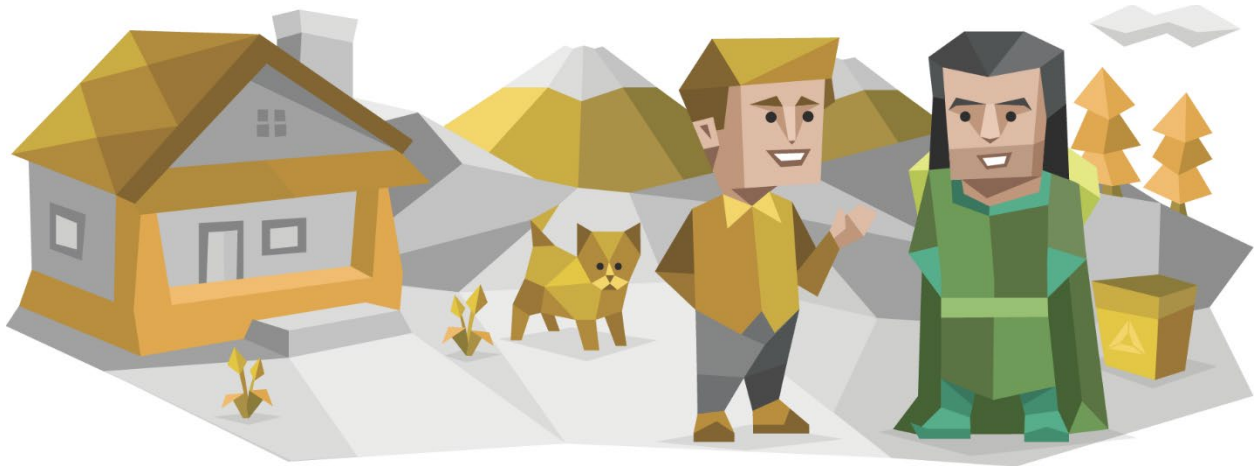
Rebalancing Adventurer-Analyst Friendships

Focusing on Common Ground

While these types may have drastically different ways of exploring, expressing creativity, and thinking about the future, they can rely on their common pragmatism to resolve any differences within their friendships. One very strong trait Analysts and Adventurers share is their appreciation of effectiveness – they both love to see practical solutions in place and functioning. This shared appreciation isn't limited to technical areas but also applies to the social realm. For both types, particularly in matters of pure preference (where to eat, for example), it's only rational to conclude that occasional compromise might be in order. Why? Because friends are worth it.

When these types experience more serious friction with each other, both can dial down their frustrated sense of superiority and instead focus on finding practical solutions together. Resolving their differing methods and preferences can be as easy as each opening their minds to see the merits of another perspective and trying it. Likewise, instead of just arguing for their own way, these friends can respect each other's approaches enough to justify their arguments with some facts. Telling friends they're wrong about something only carries hurtful judgement, but showing them better ways that work is a respectful form of disagreement that both these types can handle.

Adventurer-Diplomat Friends



When Adventurers befriend Diplomats, there's likely to be a warmth that stems from their shared focus on more humanistic interests. Both are passionate in their own ways, with Adventurers preferring hands-on expressions of their enthusiasms and Diplomats favoring ideas and dreams. If they choose to become friends, they're likely to already see the value of each other's style and that their differences can be assets rather than liabilities to their bonds.

Balanced Adventurer-Diplomat Friendships

An Exciting and Inspiring Pair

For Adventurers, having close Diplomat friends can be both a very rewarding and very perplexing experience. While both types are likely to share excitement about discovering and experiencing new things (although their definitions of what makes something interesting are likely to be very different), they may also remain enigmas to each other for a long time. This is probably the most challenging personality combination of all – and for several reasons.

Diplomats are enthusiastic, passionate, and imaginative individuals. Their energy is likely to be inspiring to Adventurers, at least initially, perhaps even making them think their friends are similar to them. Diplomats are rare compared to other personality types, and Adventurers may find their unusual thinking very intriguing. This passionate pairing can create the ideal combination of ideas and action – if they're on the same page.

Unbalanced Adventurer-Diplomat Friendships

Neglecting the Necessities

One issue Adventurers and their Diplomat friends may come across is their shared tendency to neglect day-to-day matters and necessities. Whether it's Adventurers going on unplanned road trips a week before their tax returns are due, or Diplomats forgetting to transfer their rent money amid their volunteering activities, both types may sometimes deal with unpleasant surprises – especially if those matters affect their shared friendship. Routine isn't these free-spirits' strong suit, and both Adventurers and their Diplomat friends must pay attention to their mutual responsibilities.

Additionally, Diplomats primarily live in their minds, and this behavior can be quite foreign to practical-minded Adventurers. Diplomats' nearly constant soul-searching is as meaningful to them as experiencing things is to Adventurers. From self-help books to seeking personal enlightenment, Diplomats are almost always pursuing self-improvement. Adventurers, meanwhile, are more focused on appreciating who they are and playing up their personal strengths. Their Diplomat friends' focus on self-improvement can eventually wear on them and may come across as impractical (and, at worst, completely self-absorbed.)

Rebalancing Adventurer-Diplomat Friendships

Regardless of these issues, Adventurer-Diplomat friendships can be fulfilling and inspiring. Empathic, insightful Diplomats can easily draw more reserved Adventurers out of their shells, encouraging them to share their thoughts and ideas. Diplomats tend to have a knack for making people feel relaxed and comfortable, and restless Adventurers can benefit from such company. On the other side of the fence, idealistic and often absent-minded Diplomats may find it helpful to spend time with highly practical, efficiency-oriented Adventurers. As rewarding as brainstorming can be, often there's just no substitute for some good, real-world fun.

Adventurers typically desire deep connections with others. Despite their need for independence, they appreciate interacting with others in meaningful ways. Thanks to their empathetic natures, Diplomats can not only understand their Adventurer friends' need for freedom but can be supportive of it.

Adventurer-Sentinel Friends



Glancing at the personality type letters, Adventurers and Sentinels may look very similar, but what a difference a single letter can make. Where Adventurers are spontaneous, Sentinels foster stability. Where Adventurers are pragmatists who aren't always concerned with the rules, Sentinels uphold every iota of established standards. These differences, however pronounced, don't necessarily make friendship between the two types impossible. There's actually much potential when these opposites attract.

Balanced Adventurer-Sentinel Friendships

Providing Practical Support

Sentinels are numerous and are likely to form a significant part of Adventurers' social circles. These personality types are likely to be loyal, practical, and down-to-earth friends, always eager to offer advice and support. Sentinel friends can help Adventurers stay focused and realistic when it's necessary – for instance, when Adventurers get so caught up in pursuing their hobbies and pet projects they forget to attend to daily matters or obligations. Sentinels' patience, stability, and sense of loyalty can be invaluable when their Adventurer pals feel confused or uncertain about their chosen paths.

Both Adventurers and Sentinels tend to be highly practical with their feet planted firmly on the ground. These friends are likely to focus on activities that engage their senses, such as participating in sports, going on hikes, or working on something tangible together. More adventurous and spontaneous Adventurers may convince their Sentinel friends to let go of their serious, composed attitude and simply have fun occasionally. Similarly, the structured and orderly style Sentinels embrace by can counterbalance Adventurers' occasional devil-may-care approach.

Unbalanced Adventurer-Sentinel Friendships

Freewheeling versus Stability-Seeking

The main point of contention in Adventurer-Sentinel friendships is likely to be their different definitions of freedom and individualism. Adventurers are famous for their unyielding, independent spirit, seeing many rules and traditions as stifling and redundant limitations. To them, freedom of expression overrides social cohesion or security every time.

Sentinels scoff at those who think about ignoring social conventions for the sake of individualism. From their perspective, stability and security are topmost concerns, and they're likely to argue that the needs of the many outweigh those of the few. These differences may lead to some heated discussions revolving around flexibility and responsibility, with each personality type sticking to their guns.

Rebalancing Adventurer-Sentinel Friendships

Appreciating Alternative Points of View

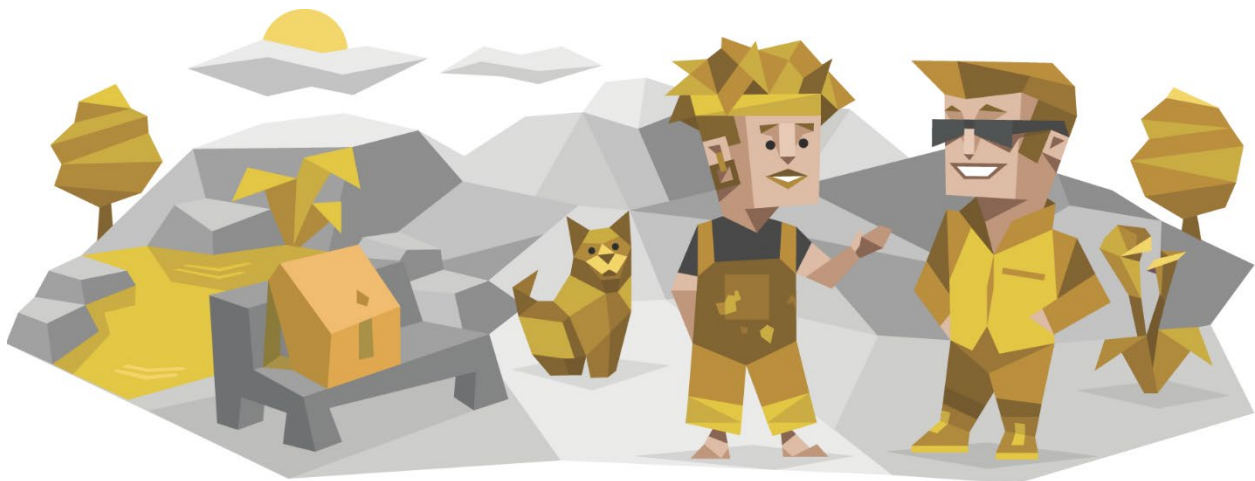
There's little these types can do to rebalance friction in their friendships unless they're willing to acknowledge the virtues of each other's perspective. This doesn't mean they must adopt those viewpoints as their own, but recognizing that different lifestyles can work for different people give these two types a chance to bridge their differences.

Adventurers can appreciate how Sentinels enjoy the sense of security that low-risk stability brings, and respect that what may seem like short-term limits or restrictions may create lasting long-term success. Sentinels can appreciate that while a spontaneous, risk-taking approach may not be for them, Adventurers can – and do –

make it work in their own lives. In true friendships, seeing comrades happy and successful is more important than being right. Sentinels can gaze at their Adventurer friends with supportive amazement instead of dismay, knowing that, win or lose, they're likely to pick themselves up and begin anew.

These friends can also accept input from each other, as each may be accomplished in their own ways, and equally capable of giving each other some balance. Sentinels who learn to take measured risks by following in their Adventurer friends' wake can undoubtedly increase their opportunities in life, and Adventurers who listen to the wise advice of Sentinel friends may sidestep some of their own worst mistakes.

Adventurer-Explorer Friends



“Live for the moment” could be the motto for Adventurers who strike up friendships with other Explorers. The exhilaration of such spontaneous and active relationships is likely to be heady for both since they're asked to conform and downshift in so many other facets of their lives. However, there is no such thing as a perfect friendship and even this seemingly seamless match has hazards to avoid – mostly because there can be too much of a good thing.

Balanced Adventurer–Explorer Friendships

Lively and Low-Stress Companions

For Adventurers, having close Explorer friends is like looking into a mirror. Explorers tend to be practical, inventive individuals, so it's very unlikely that such friends would ever run out of things to do. Explorers prefer to bond over shared activities, so such friends tend to find it easy to maintain camaraderie regardless of difficulties, often pushing each other to explore new hobbies or put more efforts into existing ones.

Lots of personal space and freedom are essential to Adventurer personalities, and its usually other Explorer types – who share their “live and let live” worldview and joy in doing things – that gravitate toward Adventurers. When spending time together, these types find it easy to drop their pretenses and enjoy low-stress fun.

Unbalanced Adventurer–Explorer Friendships

Unchecked Risk-Takers

The key challenge for Adventurer–Explorer friends is likely to come from the same source that fuels their relationship – their similarity. Having friends who think in similar ways can be fun and reassuring, but it can also put these types in a bubble, isolating them from criticism and different opinions. There's a risk that Adventurers may convince Explorer friends that their behavior and attitude are fine, even when some obvious issues need to be addressed – such as dealing with mundane yet necessary tasks – and vice-versa.

Another issue that Adventurers and their Explorer friends may face is that they're likely to place more importance on practical and tangible things than imagination and mental exercises. It may be a good idea for both types to encourage each other

to remember that finding time for intellectual growth and discussions about the past or the future can also be very beneficial. While Adventurers and their Explorer friends tend to mostly enjoy living in the moment, it's also important to stop and think about the big picture occasionally.

Rebalancing Adventurer–Explorer Friendships

Practicing Interaction and Accountability

Regardless of these hiccups, Adventurers and their Explorer friends tend to feel as if they've found their true mind mates. Their shared spontaneity, boldness, and willingness to push limits make them fun and interesting friends and give them plenty of opportunities to bond. The main challenge for Adventurers, however, is often finding other Explorers (especially with similar hobbies), not keeping such friendships alive.

Clubs, sports teams, and art classes are just a few locations where Adventurers can find fellow Explorers to befriend. While it may seem intimidating at first to these Introverted types, something as simple as striking up a conversation with someone at the gym can lead to future friendship. Adventurers can make a goal of chatting with one new person per week and may discover it not only becomes easier to interact with unfamiliar people, but they'll likely find friends that share common interests.

Finally, Adventurers and their Explorer companions are likely to benefit from a healthy dose of risk analysis occasionally. While their shared boldness may be one of their greatest traits, the resulting risky behaviors can have negative side effects. From ill-advised impulse purchases to reckless one-night stands, the consequences of their spontaneity can have severe and lasting repercussions. Fortunately, Adventurers and

their Explorer friends can learn to temper these behaviors and commit to holding each other accountable. Often such “accountability buddies” are the most effective in helping to prevent poor choices, and committing to this process with Explorer pals can bring balance to Adventurers’ lives and deepen their friendships.

Conclusion

Adventurers are Introverts who carefully select their friends and usually greatly value them as a rare commodity for these quiet types. Their bias toward action is likely to bring an extra measure of energy into the lives of those they befriend, and their practicality may broaden or shift their friends’ perspectives. Friendship with unique Adventurers is likely something to treasure.

Adventurers who try to develop friendships are likely to be more anchored and balanced because of those relationships. If they find someone who shares their interest, a partner in crime to bounce ideas and schemes off is likely to be prized. They may have to give up some of the independence they hold so dear, but the trade-off may be well worth it.

Additional Tools and Tests

Want to dig even deeper into your friendships? If you have access to the toolkits area of the website, we offer a variety of additional tools and tests to help you explore.

Type Guesser (Friendships)

Are you trying to figure out what personality type your friend belongs to? You may find that this simple tool helps.

Personal Authenticity Test

Can you be your true self with your friends and family? Let's explore how you feel about your authenticity in those circumstances.

Parenthood



Balanced Adventurer Parenthood

Warm and Practical

When it comes to parenting, Adventurers often feel right at home. Parenthood is a task for which no one is prepared, but individuals with the Adventurer personality type have a natural warmth, practicality, and relaxed nature that help them to settle in and appreciate every moment of joy and hardship that comes with raising a child.

The delight Adventurers' receive from being with and helping loved ones is arguably their greatest strength. Children of Adventurer parents have all their practical needs taken care of from day one and can always count on something exciting to do or learn every day. People with the Adventurer personality type love fun, hands-on activities, and as their children grow, they're often encouraged to pick up extra hobbies that revolve around those kinds of events.

Even as those extra activities increase, Adventurers are able to balance their Introversion and spend time with their children engaging in enjoyable activities that

center on quality time. Impromptu trips, home improvement projects like repainting bedrooms, or simply baking treats together are all likely to become fond memories for Adventurers' sons and daughters.

This doesn't mean Adventurer parents are overbearing – in fact, they're one of the most relaxed personality types there is when it comes to parenting. They believe the only way to really have their children grow up to be open-minded and well-balanced people is to let them explore and experience new things, make mistakes and learn from them, and to always know that they'll be able to come home at the end of it. Interventions and hardline rules just aren't Adventurers' style.

Unbalanced Adventurer Parenthood

Struggling with Structure and Criticism

The freedom Adventurers grant their children comes with risks, too, because it demands a certain level of maturity from the children themselves. Some lessons are harder than others. This can prove difficult for parents with the Adventurer personality type because they're more sensitive than most when it comes to facing criticism about their lifestyles or parenting. For them, nothing's quite as unpleasant as, "I told you so."

Long-term planning is another challenging area for Adventurer parents, especially those with an unbalanced preference for spontaneity over any form of structure. When it comes to things like saving for their kids' college education, Adventurers may need to rely on partners who take care of that sort of thing more readily.

Adventurers sometimes struggle as well as their children grow into adolescence. These parents need to know their work and effort are appreciated, something

teenagers aren't well-known for expressing. It can take a lot of practice on the part of Adventurer parents to learn the emotional control necessary to not overreact when things don't go the way they want. Children try to distance themselves at that age, and, private individuals or not, Adventurers need to know that those they love are by their sides during their kids' trying teen years.

Rebalancing Adventurer Parenthood

Providing Structure and Support

Although it may not come naturally, Adventurers need to find a way to provide some sort of structure – which includes discipline – for their children. By using the warmth and practicality that does come naturally to them, they can provide the loving support that their daughters and sons need while also communicating the necessity of the rules they're enforcing.

Discipline is a tricky topic for all parents, especially those who always want to feel “liked,” but their kids are more likely to both like and respect them in the long run if they provide the necessary boundaries. It may seem like they're doing their teenagers a favor by not enforcing their curfews, but they're actually doing their teens a disservice by setting up unrealistic expectations about how rules actually work. It's important for Adventurer parents to remember that fun can be had (and is often more rewarding for both themselves and their children) within consistent, loving boundaries they enforce.

Ultimately, Adventurers are much less likely to create the kinds of divides that other more rigid personality types sometimes drive between themselves and their children. There's always going to be some push from developing adults, but with such

warm, caring parents, Adventurers' children can always rest assured that they know where home and hearth are.

Parent-Child Type Combinations

Talking about personality types and children is always an interesting proposition. While most see personality as something that's at least partly genetic and inherent, those influences may only lightly touch little ones or only be vaguely apparent during their development. Childhood is about experimenting, learning, and adapting. This means their behavior is often exploratory rather than permanently defining. There may be hints of a personality type, but with so much adapting going on, it may be hard to pinpoint their consistent traits exactly. Since children aren't self-aware enough to take a personality test, they don't have the same advantages as adults who can answer questions describing their preferences.

Therefore, when we talk about the Analyst child, for example, we are referring mainly to children who may show a preference for a rational approach – even if it's sporadic. But we urge caution toward labeling children until they're older and can tell us their preferences themselves. Childhood is all about discovery, and we advocate giving them a chance to do that on their own and in their own time without the confines of labels.

Nonetheless, for the sake of discussion, we'll describe things that Adventurers may want to notice when parenting children who engage in certain trait behaviors – whether those behaviors are a phase or prove to be more consistent over time.

Adventurer Parent and an Analyst Child



A Curious and Open-Minded Duo

Analyst children are likely to be intellectually-minded, curious, and very imaginative. Their creativity and tolerance tend to delight their Adventurer parents, as their kids' willingness to explore the unknown intrigues them and any similarities to their own penchant for improvisation is a pleasure to discover.

Adventurers and Analysts share an interest in finding out how things work, which is why it's unlikely that Adventurer parents have major difficulties communicating with their children or coming up with interesting activities. Furthermore, Analyst children tend to be focused and driven once they find something that interests them. Adventurers share this trait as well, and they're likely to be delighted to see that their sons and daughters are as determined as they are.

Practical Parent versus Theoretical Child

On the other hand, the core engines that drive this kind of exploration and curiosity are completely different in Adventurers and Analysts. Adventurers usually enjoy

exploring things simply because they present a challenge, and then either move on to something more interesting or choose to spend time honing their skills in that particular area. Like other Explorers, Adventurers focus on the tangible and the real.

In contrast, Analysts are concerned less about the practical application of something and more about why something works the way it does from an intellectual perspective. They want to understand the hidden principles, systems, and patterns behind things, even when this knowledge offers few tangible benefits.

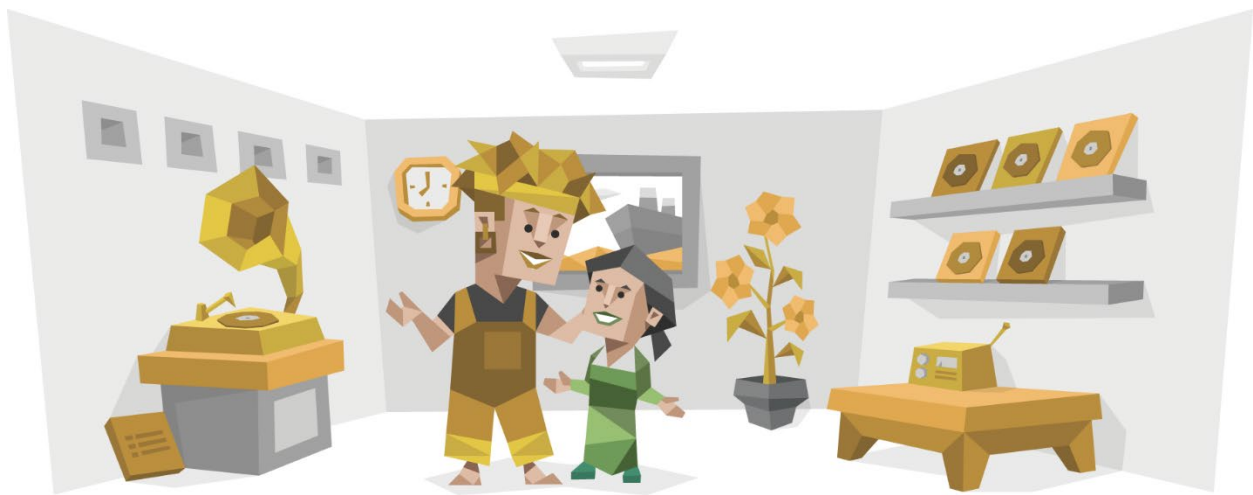
Consequently, Analyst children may not hesitate to question their Adventurer parents' suggestions or assumptions, not necessarily because they don't trust them but often because they're interested in why their parents believe they're right. However, such questions may also frustrate Adventurers, who may likely see them as a waste of time, and wonder why their kids just don't give something a try or focus on experimenting instead. Analyst children may not be persuaded by statements such as, "because it works," or, "this is the best way."

Finding Shared Interests

Analyst children are unlikely to require much emotional support, which can seem rather strange to kind, sensitive Adventurers. Analysts tend to be more self-sufficient than Feeling types – although this may cause problems when there's a genuine need to open up and discuss something, instead of hiding and rationalizing one's feelings. Adventurers, however, can certainly appreciate their Analyst children's need for independence and can be supportive of their desire for rational communication over emotional interactions. That being said, they'll likely need to find other ways to promote bonding with their Analyst kids.

More often than not, Adventurer parents bond with their Analyst children through shared activities and hobbies rather than heartfelt discussions about principles and values. It may be a good idea for these parents to make conscious efforts to encourage their daughters and sons to partake in something they're doing, developing mutual appreciation and understanding in this way.

Adventurer Parent and a Diplomat Child



An Inquisitive and Creative Combination

Even though Adventurers and Diplomats are complete opposites on many fronts, there is also some overlap among their traits. To begin with, Diplomat children are likely to be quite inquisitive and willing to explore new things. This inborn desire for freedom and creativity is likely to delight their Adventurer parents as well.

Adventurers tend to have an excellent grasp of reality, impressive practical skills, and the ability to focus completely on what's in front of them, immersing themselves fully in the present moment. However, Adventurer parents must remember that Diplomat

children may have difficulties recognizing and understanding such traits due to their detachment from the practical world.

It's likely that Diplomat kids can always find something to focus on, even without their Adventurer parents' help. This is likely to delight Adventurers – however, parents with this personality type should ensure that their children have enough mental stimulation when it comes to available activities. Diplomats are idealistic and even somewhat poetic individuals, and these characteristics may baffle their practical and realistic Adventurer parents.

To give an example, these parents may see planting trees as a fun physical exercise, but their Diplomat children may start pondering what would happen if everyone in their city did the same – and then cheerfully present that idea to them.

Impulsive versus Idealistic

Just like Adventurers, Diplomat children are also likely to understand the importance of personal responsibility and the need to be able to make their own decisions. However, Adventurer parents shouldn't confuse this with their own tendency to experiment and push limits – Diplomats seek to develop strong inner principles and tend to pick noble, often too idealistic goals. These children may respond better to arguments based on values and principles than rewards and practical benefits.

This particular aspect is likely to be responsible for most of the tension between Adventurer parents and their Diplomat sons and daughters. Like other Explorers, Adventurers tend to be very selective about what interests them and have little patience for things that don't fall into that category – Diplomats prefer to dive deep and try to find something fascinating in everything they encounter, even when this promises few tangible rewards. Adventurer parents may need to at least pretend to

be interested in their children’s musings, or find activities that combine opportunities for personal growth with real-world experiences.

Accepting and Encouraging Differences

Adventurer parents should bear in mind that their Diplomat children require a completely different approach compared to what is natural for them, and they shouldn’t attempt to “fix” their children’s idealism or occasional naiveté. Rather, Adventurer parents should try to appreciate (and learn from) their kids’ enthusiasm, open-mindedness, and creativity. Diplomats’ abilities are often underappreciated and rejected as offering little practical value, so a little encouragement can go a long way.

Such issues are even more important during the teenage years. Thankfully, being nonconformists themselves, it’s unlikely that Adventurer parents would be critical of their Diplomat teens’ habits or push them to look for more conventional career paths. Instead, they’re likely to encourage their Diplomat children to pursue something that inspires and motivates them and then help them along the way.

Adventurer Parent and a Sentinel Child



A Practical and Perceptive Pair

Adventurers share the Observant trait with their Sentinel children, which means that communication is likely to be relatively uncomplicated between them. Both types focus on practicality and facts, preferring to leave theoretical and abstract conversations to the Intuitive Analysts and Diplomats. Expectations tend to be straightforward, and Sentinel children always know exactly where they stand with their Adventurer parents.

The Observant trait also effects how these types experience their environment, and both Adventurer parents and Sentinel children are perceptive and focus on what's happening around them in the moment. Adventurers notice even subtle changes in their children's behavior, allowing them to respond quickly and efficiently to prevent situations from escalating to an unmanageable level.

This perceptiveness also promotes connection between parents and their sons and daughters – which is especially powerful for Adventurers who, as a Feeling type themselves, are very sensitive and caring individuals.

Not Enough Structure

Sentinel kids are likely to be very dutiful and obedient, trying very hard to meet their parents' expectations. They respect family hierarchy and traditional roles and expect their parents to set up clearly structured environments with well-defined rules. Sentinels don't like to find out what's acceptable through trial and error the way Adventurers do – they prefer to have a clear and upfront understanding of what's okay and what isn't. Although this is rarely the main goal of freedom-minded Adventurers, parents with this personality type are likely to appreciate their Sentinel children's willingness to cooperate and listen to what they have to say.

Additionally, Sentinel children seek a safe and stable atmosphere above all else – spontaneity and fun come after these needs have been met. Adventurers should recognize these different needs and remember that their Sentinel daughters or sons are likely to be far more careful, traditional, and methodical in their exploration of the world. Children of this type are far more structure-seeking than Adventurers, and the latter's somewhat *laissez-faire* approach to parenting may not be ideal in such circumstances.

Respecting the Need for Stability

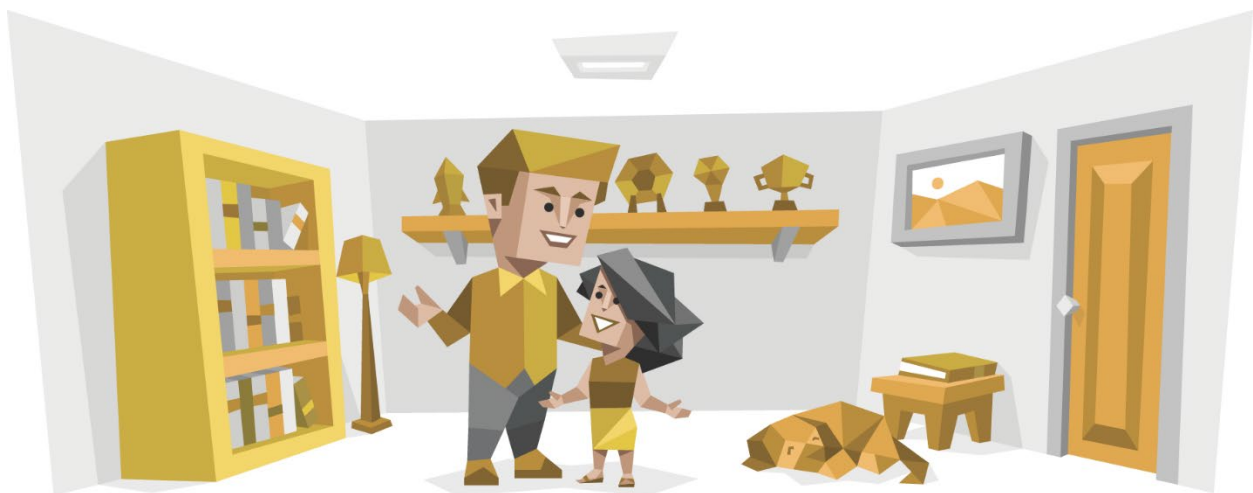
Sentinel children, and young children in general, need stability in order to build trusting relationships with their parents. Sentinels desire dependability and structure more than any other personality type, and they'll certainly struggle to connect with parents who don't provide such environments for them. Although they thrive on adventure and spontaneity, Adventurer parents need to modify their behavior to best meet the needs of their children, especially in their early years. From keeping a

consistent feeding schedule to creating a bedtime routine, Adventurers can create the sense of security and dependability that their Sentinel children truly crave.

It's also important for Adventurers to respect their kids' aversion to risk-taking. Sentinels aren't the thrill-seeking type – making them less likely to be interested in riding a roller coaster or trying new foods. And, although they certainly benefit from moving outside of their comfort zone every so often, it's important to do this slowly and with their approval – breaking Sentinel children's trust is one of the most harmful mistakes parents can make.

Start by adding some new spices to the food they already like rather than forcing them to try a completely foreign dish. Take them for a spin on the carousel and then gradually introduce them to more intense rides. Adventurers may find that Sentinel children who trust them and are allowed to take their time when trying new things are much more willing partners for future adventures.

Adventurer Parent and an Explorer Child



An Adventurous and Independent Team

Naturally, Adventurer parents find it easiest to communicate with their children if they belong to one of the Explorer types. Explorer children tend to be very adventurous and practical, often able to come up with exciting activities on their own as long as they're encouraged and given enough freedom to express themselves. Adventurer parents are likely to be fascinated by their children's curiosity, finding it easy to relate to and communicate with them.

Furthermore, Explorer children tend to feel very in tune with the present moment and the world around them, often enjoying sports and nature, even from a very young age. Nature-related activities are likely to form a large part of Adventurer parents' repertoire.

Like Adventurers themselves, Explorer kids are likely to place a lot of importance on freedom and independence, often insisting on being allowed to experiment and do things in their own way. Adventurers tend to cherish the idea of seeing their curious and enthusiastic children discover something new or exhaust themselves while spending hours on recently acquired hobbies.

That being said, such an improvisational and hands-off attitude is a double-edged sword. Knowing that their children love freedom of action, Adventurers may be reluctant to discipline them for overstepping their boundaries with all those experiments or to be firm in telling their sons and daughters that playtime is over and they should get back to studying.

Missing the Bigger Picture

Tangentially, Adventurer parents may also have difficulties teaching their Explorer children to find time for introspection and personal development. All Explorers are far more interested in real, palpable matters than internal discussions or abstract ideas, but both approaches have valuable things to offer. It's way too easy to forget to find time to stop and think about the direction their lives are going if they live mostly in the present.

Finally, as Adventurer parents focus more on improvisation and thinking on their feet, they tend to have difficulties with purely administrative and practical tasks. When unbalanced, this tendency can lead to serious issues in the future, especially in areas such as finance. Their Explorer children are likely to share this particular weakness, which is why parents with this personality type should make conscious efforts to teach their kids the importance of being economical, able to make fact-based decisions, and of knowing how to combine that restless curiosity with practical needs and responsibilities.

Considering the Future

As pleasant as it can be to live in the present moment, Adventurers may do their Explorer children a disservice by neglecting to consider the future. Encouraging their Explorer daughters and sons to view life as an adventure seems harmless enough, but children who lack direction or the ability to form well-thought-out plans can venture into some unsavory situations.

Going to college with absolutely no direction, for example, can result in some hearty student loans with no degree to show for it. Buying their first car without budgeting

for payments, insurance, or fuel can result in a repossessed vehicle and a badly damaged credit score.

In order to prevent these potentially long-term issues, Adventurer parents should be intentional about helping their children to understand how their present actions affect their future. Children of all ages (even adolescents) aren't cognitively capable of fully understanding the potential consequences of their behaviors, so it's their parents' job to help them until they develop these abilities.

As impulsive individuals themselves, Adventurers may need to explore how their lack of planning or direction have affected their lives. Anecdotes about poor decisions they made as kids ("I decided to try some beer at a friend's party my sophomore year in high school.") and the negative outcomes that resulted ("I got really sick, and my parents grounded me for two months when they found out.") can help to illustrate the importance of considering future consequences.

Conclusion

Balancing their refreshing spontaneity and somewhat *laissez-faire* attitude with the responsibilities that come with parenthood can be challenging for Adventurer parents. But if they master the right approach, they not only raise children who are capable and responsible, but there's also an element of whimsy and adventure built in. It doesn't matter what personality type their children turn out to be. Smart discipline and the teaching of responsibility paired with Adventurers' unique personality style can help all children experience the best of both worlds.

Responsible parents always adapt themselves, regardless of their own core inclinations, to raise their children compassionately and intelligently. If Adventurers

see parenting as a skill to acquire and try to do so, they're likely to be marvelous, conscientious parents who open unique doors in sometimes unconventional ways.

Additional Tools and Tests

Want to dig even deeper into your role as a parent? If you have access to the toolkits area of the website, we offer a variety of additional tools and tests to help you explore.

Parenting Styles Test

Whether you have children already or hope to become a parent in the future, this test offers you useful insights into your parenting style.

Type Guesser (Parent)

Are you trying to figure out what personality type your parent belongs to? You may find that this simple tool helps.

Type Guesser (Child)

Are you trying to figure out what personality type your teenage child belongs to? You may find that this simple tool helps.

Academic Path



Adventurers are naturally curious individuals who love learning new skills, especially those with practical benefits. True to their name, they see education as an opportunity to engage themselves in experiences that result in gaining knowledge and skills applicable to their interests and activities. Rock-climbing enthusiasts, for example, may pursue a degree in geology to learn more about the formations that they're in such close contact with.

Whatever path they take in their lives, Adventurers can benefit from embracing their education and looking for learning opportunities. Whether they're studying medieval history in the classroom or teaching themselves how to build websites in their own home, Adventurers profit from expanding their minds and increasing their expertise. The following paragraphs will discuss how Adventurers learn best throughout their educational career, the struggles they may face in the academic environment, and how they can improve their learning habits.

How Adventurers Learn

Hands-on mastery is the type of learning that appeals most to Adventurers. They learn best in loose and unstructured environments with loose and unstructured curricula that emphasize the experiential. Adventurers respond to a high level of personal involvement in their learning. They're usually restless in a lecture hall setting. However, if they discover their niche – acting, for example – Adventurers can express their love of performing on a stage in an auditorium or even in a classroom.

Balanced Learning Habits

Valuing Hands-On Experiences

Adventurers love to create. As long as they can make them themselves, it doesn't matter if it's artistic pieces, musical compositions, or beautiful graphic designs. People with this personality type don't respond well to just sitting still and absorbing information. Give them something to do, and they quickly become engaged. Allow them to express themselves in interesting and amusing fashions, and they'll shine, but ask them to recall a historical timeline, and they'll instantly lose interest.

Adventurers also enjoy coaching and feedback on their performance. Although nobody likes criticism, these types are serious about mastering what interests them and tend to appreciate any observations that can honestly help them accomplish this. The optimal learning style for Adventurers is to watch someone modeling a technique, immediately perform that same technique themselves, and then receive feedback on their performance. Once they mature and gain mastery, they're likely to then put their own spin on their work.

Unbalanced Learning Habits

Struggling with Traditional Structure

Even the most adaptable Adventurers can struggle in an overly-structured, traditional classroom setting – but this issue is much worse for those who have trouble operating outside of their trait preferences. Unfortunately, most academic environments focus on providing structure for students as if everyone learns in the same way. Because Sentinel personality types make up most of the population – and, consequently, educators – the idea that structured curricula work best is consistently reinforced in the academic world.

This system doesn't work well for many Adventurers, who are, ostensibly, the anti-Sentinels. This doesn't mean they don't like Sentinels or are against them; rather, they work in an almost opposite manner. Sentinels are rules-based, and they like to uphold tradition. They're orderly, think linearly, and favor the predictability of the traditional classroom model. Alternately, Adventurers tend to struggle in regimented environments.

Rebalancing Learning Habits

Finding a Niche

Parents and instructors who want to reach Adventurers and engage them in the learning process must help them find their niche and keep opportunities to be spontaneous open for them. They can give them something to work on independently, offering them some freedom to express themselves. Adventurers are always looking for something new and novel, and tend to respond to instruction that cultivates boldness and improvisation.

People with this personality type also like to reach decisions or conclusions in their own time based on what they discover. However, once they learn something, they may not wait around for others before they implement it. Instructors should have enough flexibility to accommodate this.

Still, it's important to remember that Adventurers are likely to only take so much spoon-feeding before they go off on their own. When teachers must give instructions, Adventurers usually respond best to multisensory learning using media and computers in novel ways. They need a wide range of activities rich in personal involvement. For these students, an effective activity is something physical, not an exercise on paper.

Adventurers in High School

If you've attended high school or ever watched one of the thousands of films about teenage angst, then you already know that there's more to high school than just academics. Most would agree there are as many lessons to be learned in school yards and hallways as there are in classrooms. So, let's take a moment to consider high school as a place where some important life lessons unfold.

Balanced Adventurers in High School

Independent and Innovative

Adventurers can be reclusive, especially if they feel out of place in the classroom. However, those who understand themselves and have found their niche can offset this tendency with their natural charm, boldness, and mastery of the right skills. Even if this occurs in areas outside of the classroom, the effects can transfer; for instance, everybody gathers around the guy with a guitar at a party. Associating with

Adventurers may even appeal to the rebellious streak in some of their otherwise conventional peers.

In terms of learning, Adventurers at their best understand the necessity of attending classes and getting passing grades. They may struggle with the structure but are likely to excel at anything that allows them to use their creativity to pursue a unique idea or to acquire new skills. Hands-on activities, such as building a bird house in shop class or participating in a model United Nations project for civics, can lead to greater interest and increased learning for these perceptive and practical students.

For many Adventurers, extracurricular activities and joining clubs or groups may represent more structure than they typically want. If they choose to participate, it most likely would be with groups that are more physical than cerebral and more skills-based than theoretical, such as art club or jazz band. Adventurers who find high school groups that interest them enough to join tend to be among the most passionate and committed participants.

People with this personality type rarely aspire to be in leadership positions. They dislike structure and are unlikely to impose it on others. Instead, they often serve throughout life in advisory capacities and can offer a lot to organizations by coming up with innovative ways of self-expression and problem-solving.

Unbalanced Adventurers in High School

Out of Sync with the System

Some Adventurers have a difficult time in high school. As discussed above, the typical classroom isn't a great fit for them. Their aversion to the structure of most classes might result in the impression that they're troublemakers or possibly even

unintelligent. Within the traditional system, it's easy to miss the genius of another type lurking below the surface in such students. Unfortunately, too many teachers and parents lack this perspective, and they often view Adventurers as uncooperative or incapable.

Let the other students memorize cold, hard facts or play with ideas, but make sure Adventurers have something practical and tangible to do. In high school, point these students toward music, art, or other courses based on skill mastery. If left to struggle with traditional education, Adventurers are likely to earn poor grades and experience painful emotional and psychological distress. The constant message they receive from their school environment is that they're out of sync with everyone else. If it's clear to them they don't fit, this realization can cause a great deal of damage to their self-esteem.

Rebalancing Adventurers in High School

Relating Learning to Personal Interests

Many places are cutting or reducing their arts programs to tighten their budgets. These cuts can be disappointing for many reasons, but they're potentially devastating for students who perform creatively. If available or reasonable, transferring to a high school of the arts may be an appropriate option for Adventurer students. They may feel more at home in such an environment and receive a healthy dose of affirming feedback.

There are also many accredited alternative schools that cater to students who feel out of place in a traditional setting. These schools often allow students to create their own curricula and explore their talents in very active ways. These non-traditional schools could be great opportunities for Adventurers, but these students can also

greatly benefit from counselors, teachers, or parents who understand this personality type.

Those Adventurers who form a connection with an activity or artistic expression won't only put in a great deal of effort to master it, but also may tolerate the passive lecture hall better. People with this personality type settle down and apply themselves more to school when they find their niche (or, in essence, themselves). When Adventurers can express themselves in ways that are true to their natures, they sometimes find more patience for subjects that wouldn't normally fit their interests. With a strong sense of fulfillment, they won't be as likely to feel as if they're denying themselves. Once Adventurers feel able to commit to something such as school, they're passionate and loyal people.

Work or College?

There are many factors to consider when deciding whether to go to college and understanding personality types can have a role in the equation. Most people previously considered college or university to be the quickest path to success and security. Now, some of these same people argue against higher education based on the amazing success stories of college dropouts, such as Bill Gates and Steve Jobs, during this current technological age. There's a niche for everyone, and college is just one possible path on the road to discovery. So, what might Adventurers consider when deciding between going to college or going to work?

It's easy to see action-conscious Adventurers wanting to get out into the world quickly to perform and produce, but their need to master their crafts can be just as insistent. These tend to be the two things that they must weigh and balance when thinking about higher education. College would be an unappealing choice for those

Adventurers who look at it and see only lecture halls and books; but to those who see studios and practice rooms, higher education may be attractive.

Often, their perspective depends upon choosing the right major at the right college. Although Adventurer personalities could find an apprenticeship in the nonacademic world, college provides “ready-made” opportunities to learn from others. (Occasionally, Adventurers get into occupations requiring certification, in which case higher education is a necessity rather than a choice.)

When Adventurers Go to College

Adventurers who attend college or university are likely to feel as though they’ve been set free. Leaving home and high school for college offers many of them the independence and autonomy they crave. No longer bound by the rules of high school life, people with this personality type may finally find an educational model that fits their learning style.

Balanced Adventurers in College

Free to Find Their Own Way

Adventurers tend to choose college courses that share similarities with the subjects they connected with in high school. The artistic disciplines are a primary interest for many Adventurer college students, along with various other active professions such as teaching, forestry, and psychology.

Adventurers are likely to avoid the pressure to choose majors and courses they struggled with in high school. Sometimes parents and guidance counselors, with all the best intentions, can send a high school graduate in the wrong direction in college.

If Adventurer students didn't embrace more abstract, theoretical coursework in high school, the chances aren't any better for them doing so in college.

Unbalanced Adventurers in College

Too Focused on "Right Now"

Some think the purpose of college and university is to obtain the tools needed to make a good living. Most Adventurers, however, reject this as the primary reason to get a degree. Mastery and creativity tend to be the chief motivators for these students, and they're usually convinced that their passion can see them through. Some Adventurers may place their emphasis on picking up skills in the "here and now" with little regard for the future.

Do Adventurers look for "party schools" to strengthen their university experiences? Like most young people, they are likely to delight in the autonomy going away to college offers. For most students, this is their first significant taste of life without their families and their rules. Some even choose their universities based on the distance from the family home.

The same is true for Adventurers who are interested in coming into their own. They're Introverts, so a vivacious social life wouldn't necessarily be attractive to them. A few good friends tend to do nicely. However, nearly all students are susceptible to the temptations of college freedom, especially when they're under some emotional stress. Explorers all tend to seek a little adventure and novelty, which could, at least occasionally, draw Adventurers into the campus party world. They may want to exercise caution.

Rebalancing Adventurers in College

Learning to Deal with Difficulty

College is a time for Adventurers to consider and exploit their strengths and talents in real ways. This is their opportunity to customize their courses of study to a level that leaves them feeling fulfilled. One area of difficulty for collegiate Adventurers is the necessity of taking those unavoidable courses – the foundational prerequisites that many independent-minded students dread. Although some students “test out” of them, into every college career a little mundane classwork must fall.

Learning to cope with this can be good disciplinary practice for Adventurers. It won't be the last time they run into required tasks they find meaningless and boring. College can help self-aware Adventurers gain tolerance for such things and prepare them to approach the adult world in more realistic manners.

Conclusion

In aiming for the mastery that even the name “Adventurers” suggests, this personality type naturally embraces the role of lifelong learners in search of novelty and experiences. The initial trick in promoting learning for them doesn't involve directly motivating them or pushing them to improve skills, hoping their interest ignites after the fact. The trick is to help them find interactive disciplines that grab and inspire them up front.

On discovering such interests, Adventurers are likely to throw themselves into the academic process. Typically, when they find their niche, they look for ways to increase their expertise on their own. With this focus in place, they may even find education, in a broader sense, more appealing.

Adventurers can help themselves gain a foothold in academia by understanding how education and training work for them. Nurturing and indulging their tendency toward curiosity can be beneficial as they search for their passions. Exploring with a purposeful emphasis on discovery can help start them on their educational – and perhaps professional – paths.

Additional Tools and Tests

Want to dig even deeper into your academic path? If you have access to the toolkits area of the website, we offer a variety of additional tools and tests to help you explore.

Thirst for Knowledge Test

What is your interest in gaining knowledge? How does your desire for learning affect your life? This tool will help you explore that.

Academic Exploration Test

Do you ever wonder what areas of study might suit your personality? Find out which subjects might be the most satisfying for you.

Perfectionism Test

Perfectionism is a desire to be remarkable and outstanding in everything you do. Let's see what role it plays in your life.

Type Guesser (Academic)

Are you trying to figure out what personality type your classmate belongs to? You may find that this simple tool helps.

Professional Development



Adventurers need more than a job. They need creative outlets and opportunities to put their imaginations to good use. In the right environments, Adventurers tend to find success and satisfaction by using their intrinsic qualities to their benefit – including their independence and their willingness to experiment.

Despite being bold and flexible, Adventurers face many unwanted challenges in their careers if they choose the wrong path. People with this personality type don't respond well when their skills and efforts aren't utilized or recognized. Ultimately, for them, it all boils down to picking careers that are good matches for their strengths and traits.

The Here and Now

Adventurers dislike speculating about the future or dwelling on the past; instead, they inhabit the here and now. This enables them to excel in fields that require sensory awareness and present-moment attention. When it comes to adapting to rapid changes, they're in their element. Given these strengths, many Adventurers

shine as artists, musicians, photographers, designers, athletes, therapists, teachers, tour guides, and freelancers of all types.

This intense focus on the present comes with a cost: an aversion to long-term planning. This doesn't necessarily mean that Adventurers are reckless or shortsighted. Rather, they prefer to focus on managing controllable factors and taking immediate action, not following multi-step procedures that might have some benefit in the future. Careers that require forecasting, theorizing, or performing routine or incremental tasks are typically poor fits for people with this personality type.

Live Free

Adventurers cherish their freedom and resist any attempts to force them into restrictive, predictable roles. Stable, unchanging positions and one-size-fits-all career ladders make them feel suffocated, not reassured. Even in otherwise pleasant environments, people with this personality type become restless if they can't follow their instincts and express themselves freely.

One reason Adventurers crave independence is so they can experiment and improvise without having to ask permission. They enjoy breaking molds and trying out new things – which is why they're often known as trendsetters. It's difficult to imagine Adventurers being happy in office cubicles, following top-down directives from nine to five. People with this personality type are free spirits, and they don't do well with strict structures, rigid expectations, or inflexible protocols.

Mastery and Freedom

Adventurers are often called artists for a reason – they have a keen eye for detail and excel in fields that reward creativity. People with this personality type leave building extensive systems or planning for contingency scenarios for more technical-oriented Analysts to conquer. When it comes to security and stability, favored qualities of Sentinels, Adventurers are uninterested. Finally, unlike Diplomats and despite their Feeling trait, Adventurers care little about diplomacy or idealism. Effectiveness often supersedes both.

People with the Adventurer personality type live and breathe creativity, seeking excitement and novelty at every possible moment with energy not always found in Introverts. They're passionate about developing mastery and pushing limits.

For exploring the unknown and reaching the heights of human ability, Adventurers can't be matched; it's their driving force and primary motivator. Their focus should be positioning themselves to master specific techniques to benefit their employers, while also retaining enough freedom to choose their own methods. This may be a challenging task for many employers – however, smart managers won't take long to notice it's good to have Adventurers on board.

Practicality and Learning

Practical and down to earth, Adventurers typically remain levelheaded even when facing challenges. Where other types might focus on theories and methods, Adventurers concentrate on the reality of a situation when deciding how to proceed. They should steer their careers toward roles that reward practicality and efficiency. In addition, they should develop areas of expertise that allow them to focus on concrete details rather than abstract matters.

As they progress in their careers, Adventurers should indulge their interest in learning and work by seizing opportunities for education and experimentation. For instance, many organizations offer various training programs or subscriptions to professional magazines. Employers may even offer reimbursement for courses, conferences, or workshops. By taking advantage of such opportunities, Adventurers will not only stave off boredom in their career paths but also broaden their skill sets, potentially laying the groundwork for future advancement.

Tangentially, it's worth mentioning that this applies to educational qualifications as well. Regardless of whether Adventurers are employed or not, they might want to explore fields and subjects loosely connected to their main specialization. Plenty of areas reward Adventurers' tactical thinking and their skilled ability to see what needs to be done and do it. Keeping their eyes open can sometimes yield great results. Those not satisfied with their roles may want to try out new subjects as an easy way to open new horizons and boost self-confidence simultaneously. Another bonus is this doesn't necessarily require formal qualifications; nowadays, pursuing independent study is easier than ever.

They may also want to try finding hobbies with future income-generating potential. This approach is quite common among Adventurers, especially those who are in stable and well-paid positions that fail to excite them. The actual earnings don't matter that much in the beginning; what matters is the chance to do something that stimulates and inspires them, without the constraints of employer-employee relationships.

Career Options for Adventurers



Balanced Career Options

This section looks at some specific jobs that may fit Adventurers best, but it isn't an attempt to provide a full list of professions. As new and different career options are created almost daily, it would be impossible to comprehensively create a list of job choices. The sampling below is a list of occupations loosely compatible with Adventurer personality traits, along with some added explanation. This is a guide for Adventurers thinking about their own career goals.

For those who are already employed, this may serve as a confirmation or an explanation for why they might be happy or unhappy in their positions, but it's far from a firm prescription of what Adventurers must do to succeed or achieve fulfillment.

The Arts, Crafts, and Design

Adventurers love to be creative, particularly in tangible, concrete ways. Fine arts and crafts of all types appeal to their need for mastery and their drive to experiment.

Music can appeal to these types, and Adventurers attracted to a career in music strive to become virtuosos.

The arts occasionally demand group participation – such as in an orchestra or on a film set – but artists and craftspeople do most of their work as individuals. For example, cellists can be members of orchestras or other ensembles, but, even as members of such groups, they still practice for hours on their own. These independent pursuits appeal to Adventurers, who generally thrive when they can avoid social pressures and “office politics.”

Freelancing or working independently in creative careers allow Adventurers to set their own agendas, choose the problems they want to solve and chart their own timelines. These free spirits crave the opportunity to take risks without worrying about the reactions of others.

The following careers generally fit this description:

- Musician – instrumental, vocal, or composition
- Potter
- Painter
- Illustrator
- Sculptor
- Graphic artist
- Weaver
- Interior designer
- Fashion designer
- Jewelry designer
- Metal smith

- Photographer
- Woodworker (carpenter)

Mechanics and Engineering

Adventurers are attracted to the problem-solving nature of these types of positions, as they also typically appeal to their need for hands-on opportunities to create and innovate. These are also practical professions where real objects are modified in real ways. Engineers and mechanics often must collaborate with others and conform to rules, which can pose problems for Adventurers; however, they can also establish their own sphere of influence, within which they can explore and experiment freely.

Some specific occupations in this field include the following.

- Auto, boat, or airplane mechanic
- Small-engine mechanic
- Appliance repairer
- Heavy-equipment mechanic
- Engineer (mechanical, computer, structural, environmental, acoustic, robotic – any of the many branches of engineering)

Animal and Child Care

Many Adventurers do well in jobs that nurture others. Thanks to their sensory awareness and love of discovery, combined with their gentle and charming nature, they connect easily with children. Their patience and sensitivity also serve them well when working with animals. Some jobs that might use these special qualities are listed below.

- Veterinarian or veterinarian's assistant

- Animal trainer, groomer, or boarder
- Animal rescue worker
- Pet-adoption counselor
- Kennel manager or worker
- Preschool or early-education teacher
- Nanny
- Child psychologist or therapist
- Social worker
- Children's museum curator or docent (particularly if activity based)

Medicine

Medical careers can afford Adventurers the opportunity to master skills and use their problem-solving abilities in time-critical environments. As long as the work brings in new and interesting cases, these types do well in the medical professions. If mundane activities or restricted protocols dominate the job, however, these positions can lose their appeal for Adventurers.

Overall, people with this personality type often do well in the healing professions.

The following is a list of some possible roles:

- Nurse
- Doctor (general practice, specialist, or emergency medicine)
- Physician's assistant
- Midwife or doula
- Therapist or counselor
- Physical therapist
- Dentist or dental hygienist

Unbalanced Career Options

In modern society, we spend a great deal of time at work, but we also tend to find great meaning in our employment. It's important for Adventurers to avoid situations to which they're not well suited, as they may become stuck in a difficult position. Here are characteristics of jobs that may not be suitable for Adventurers.

Dependent on a Team

Adventurers like to operate independently. Although they may fare well enough as part of a loose team, they're more comfortable – and perhaps even more productive – when working on their own. Dealing with social and office politics or waiting on others can exhaust and frustrate Adventurers.

Mundane and Repetitive Work

People with this personality type crave novelty, spontaneity, and challenge. Repetitive work of any kind loses their interest, even if it's well compensated or otherwise advantageous. Unless they can use their improvisational skills, Adventurers become unfocused and bored.

Restrictive Environment

If the structure or the rules of a workplace are too rigid, Adventurers feel stifled and unfulfilled. When they can't act on their instincts, people with this personality type lose their edge on solving problems and facing challenges. Adventurers need the latitude to act swiftly and to take risks – two behaviors generally discouraged in hierarchical or rules-bound environments.

Alternative Options

Self-Employment

Many people find self-employment scary; however, gone are the days of spending decades working at the same company with ensured employment. Except for certain specialized fields, job security and guaranteed prospects are generally considered things of the past. Working for oneself can be a viable alternative to conventional employment.

This option also comes with a range of other benefits that appeal to Adventurers, such as planning their own time, seeing the tangible results of their work, and being their own boss. Adventurers value freedom and independence and being self-employed gives them an excellent opportunity to enjoy these things.

Self-employment essentially eliminates one of the major hurdles that Adventurers are likely to encounter in the corporate environment: forced compliance with numerous rules. As self-employed individuals, they may choose which tasks they want to perform and which they want to delegate or outsource. This self-determination can relieve them of any mundane administrative work or irrational orders they disagree with. Self-employment offers many major benefits to Adventurers, especially in today's global and always-connected environment. People with this personality are likely to succeed as their own bosses.

Entrepreneurship

Adventurers may feel comfortable with a business of their own making. Building an enterprise takes risk, which is a challenge they're ready and willing to take. Plenty of

“entrepreneurs” have given up because they were too afraid to jump into a pool full of what they perceived as sharks, but Adventurers are comfortable with risk and can deal with the consequences. People with this personality type know what it means to be entrepreneurs because they’ve been trying new and chancy things all their lives.

Without the right idea, though, a business will fail. Adventurers wishing to start their own business need to think of an interesting way to fulfill an existing need (or create one), then do it better than their competitors. As they tend to have an amazing ability to improvise, they typically are up to the task. If they have a strong idea from the start, they’re likely to manage the rest with ease.

Getting on the Career Ladder

Adaptability is among Adventurers’ greatest strengths. Even at school, which is a source of frustration for many with this personality type, they’re likely to improvise, experiment, and cope with daily challenges. They love to make decisions on the spot, often refusing to plan for contingencies.

Like other Explorers, Adventurers are unstoppable when they find opportunities to master specific techniques or niches that give them the freedom to choose their preferred courses of action. Because finding such opportunities can be challenging, let’s explore themes that can help Adventurers establish themselves on the right path.

Creativity and Experimentation

In both hobbies and aspirations, Adventurers excel when they embrace their creativity – whether this means photographing nature, designing homes, creating music, or even starting a business. Driven to become masters of technique, they love

the practical challenges of getting just the right color, lighting, or sound. Adventurers who come up with a successful plan usually aren't content to stick to it, as other types might. Instead, they experiment and improvise, constantly pushing their limits.

Adventurers can embrace these strengths in the job-hunting stage. As Introverts, they may not especially enjoy networking or socializing, which is the primary means of getting a job for many other personality types. By leveraging their creativity, however, many do just fine without an extensive social network. Thanks to the hours they've spent honing their expertise and trying new things, they can make resumes, CVs, and portfolios that stand out from the crowd.

To do so, Adventurers should highlight a range of past projects, list skill sets they've developed, and mention side gigs or hobbies where they've established mastery. Even if these details seem only tangentially related to the position, they emphasize their abilities in problem-solving and innovation and help distinguish them from the competition.

Finding the Right Job

With job interviews, Adventurers may not want to spend time preparing; instead, they trust their skills and enthusiasm can put them above everybody else. Many interviewers rely on template questions, though. Adventurers may lose out to other candidates who have prepared answers to common interview questions, such as "What's your greatest weakness?" or "Who are some people you admire?" By spending even a few minutes before an interview brainstorming likely questions and drafting answers, Adventurers can increase their chances of success.

On the flip side, Adventurers shouldn't hesitate to ask their interviewers questions, as it might be the only way they can determine whether a position is a good fit that allows for such things as room to experiment and freedom from micromanagement.

To do this effectively, people with this personality type should prepare relevant questions to ask their interviewers, like "What's the management structure like?" and "What types of decisions or actions would require approval from my manager or team?" Ultimately, unless they ask, Adventurers can't know whether a given professional environment can give them the breathing room they need in order to feel happy and motivated.

Workplace Cooperation Between Types

Adventurers may prioritize completing their projects and duties above making connections in a professional setting. To reach their full potential, most inevitably must collaborate and cooperate with other people. While their Feeling trait makes them likely to get along well enough with others, their independent streak pulls them their own way.

By thinking in terms of agreement and compromise rather than conflict, it's possible for Adventurers to enjoy constructive working relationships with any personality type. This section covers possible pairings of Adventurers with other Role groups, including brief overviews of potential synergies and obstacles, and some tips that may help Adventurers navigate these tricky waters.

Adventurer–Analyst Cooperation



Balanced Adventurer–Analyst Cooperation

One-Two Punch

Both Adventurers and Analysts enjoy the search for answers, although their style and scope of doing so are different. If they recognize that they're both looking for better ways to do things, their commonality can make discussions more productive. Early in their working relationships, they may come to appreciate each other's interest in efficiency and improvement.

As they become better acquainted, Adventurers and Analysts can learn to work together as a one-two punch. Adventurers function as implementers, using their present-moment awareness and adaptability to turn Analysts' often abstract ideas into reality. Consequently, Adventurers can sidestep theorizing and planning, neither of which is particularly appealing to them, in favor of quick action and improvisation.

For an illustration of this dynamic, consider *Apollo 13*, the space mission (and the eponymous movie) that brought us the iconic phrase, "Houston, we have a problem."

After a mechanical mishap, three U.S. astronauts had to operate a crippled space capsule. Ground control – whom we might compare to Analysts – calculated all the numbers, ran analyses, and worked out a trajectory that could get the astronauts home. The astronauts – whom we might think of as Adventurers – then had to work as problem-solvers, implementing the plan and coping with mishaps along the way. In the end, the astronauts did indeed make it back to Earth safely, exemplifying how different functions and styles can work together to fulfill the same goal.

Unbalanced Adventurer–Analyst Cooperation

Ideas versus Action

When they first meet, Adventurers might feel as if Analysts ignore important details in favor of vague, impractical ideas and hypothesizing. As time goes on, it can be tempting for Adventurers to dismiss Analysts as having their heads in the clouds and not understanding the practical side of – well, anything. In return, Adventurers might be judged by Analysts as reckless or narrow-minded. In such situations, communication and collaboration can grind to a halt.

To make these situations worse, Analysts can be condescending, and Adventurers might feel as if their intelligence and worth are being called into question. This can open old wounds for Adventurers, whose strengths and intelligence may not have been recognized during their earlier years. As a result, Adventurers might stop listening to Analysts altogether, choosing to act as they see fit without input from their colleagues.

Rebalancing Adventurer-Analyst Cooperation

Connecting to the Big Picture

Although Adventurers enjoy details and implementation, they need to remember that Analysts don't share these preferences. Analysts are more likely to pay attention if Adventurers connect their words and thoughts to the big picture, explaining how different courses of action affect the larger organization or system. For example, in a situation where Analysts are dragging their feet by weighing options instead of deciding, Adventurers might point out how missing their deadline may incur costs down the line.

Adventurers should also ask Analysts to give them feedback from a big-picture perspective. This can help Adventurers identify their blind spots, particularly any long-term considerations that they've been neglecting in favor of quick action and results. Such a vantage point can save Adventurers from going in a wrong direction or wasting their efforts.

R-E-S-P-E-C-T

Adventurers and Analysts, like all personality types, operate best in an environment of mutual respect. To cultivate this, Adventurers shouldn't rush to dismiss Analysts and their theories. After all, Analysts are seeking efficient outcomes, just like Adventurers. Instead, Adventurers can pose concrete, specific questions about their ideas, such as, "What type of budget would this entail?" and "What milestones would we want to set to stay on track?" These questions have a dual benefit: They remind Analysts of practical considerations, and they force Adventurers to acknowledge the merits of an analytical process.

Adventurer-Diplomat Cooperation



Balanced Adventurer-Diplomat Cooperation

Adventurers with their practical approach to life and problems and Diplomats with their more idealistic bent seem likely to conflict with one another. However, if, instead of thinking of these traits as opposite, these types see them as complementary, there may be much potential for Adventurer-Diplomat cooperation. They find common ground when they tap into each other's passion and desire to bring about improvements.

The Pursuit of Something Better

Both Adventurers and Diplomats deploy their creativity in pursuit of something better. For Adventurers, this means finding novel and interesting solutions to practical and specific problems. They can look at a tangled mess of a program and figure out how to make it work – often in unique and interesting ways. Although Diplomats and Adventurers have a shared interest in improvement, Diplomats are more focused on personal growth, moral development, and well-being.

As their professional relationships together progress, Adventurers and Diplomats might discover additional common ground: Both types respect independence, and neither feels beholden to rules or convention. Together, these two types can enjoy productive and pleasant working relationships, particularly if their missions involve innovation and change.

Better Together

As with Analysts, Adventurers and Diplomats can function together as a one-two punch. Adventurers play to their strengths, focusing on acting and managing crises. Meanwhile, Diplomats use their Intuitive trait to generate and manipulate ideas, dealing with abstract concepts and planning for the long term – areas that don't interest Adventurers. Adventurers benefit from Diplomats' big-picture vision because they can stick to the hands-on work they prefer. Let someone else worry about all the broader "why" questions.

As an illustration, suppose that a Diplomat recognizes that an organization needs to create a greater sense of community and cohesion within its ranks. Communication around the office is poor, and the Diplomat senses a lack of connection among coworkers. An Adventurer might then step in to address the Diplomat's insight – for example, by creating an email newsletter, a phone chain, a podcast, or an agenda for lunchtime activities. In this relationship, the Diplomat can stick to generating ideas and insights, and the Adventurer can step in and act.

Unbalanced Adventurer-Diplomat Cooperation

Action versus Consideration

Adventurers may trust their instincts a little too much by putting their plans in motion without taking other people's opinions, views, or welfare into account. Such behavior can rile sensitive Diplomats, whose values include cooperation and harmony. By acting unilaterally, Adventurers may also ignore potential long-term consequences, upsetting Diplomats even further.

For example, Adventurers might want to publicize a new product as soon as possible, going so far as to alert the media and schedule a launch party before checking in with colleagues. This might cause Diplomats to lose their cool, pointing out potential issues that could delay production and arguing that key team members may be unable to attend the event. When communication breaks down in this way, Adventurers and Diplomats clash, losing sight of the benefits that can arise from their different approaches.

Rebalancing Adventurer-Diplomat Cooperation

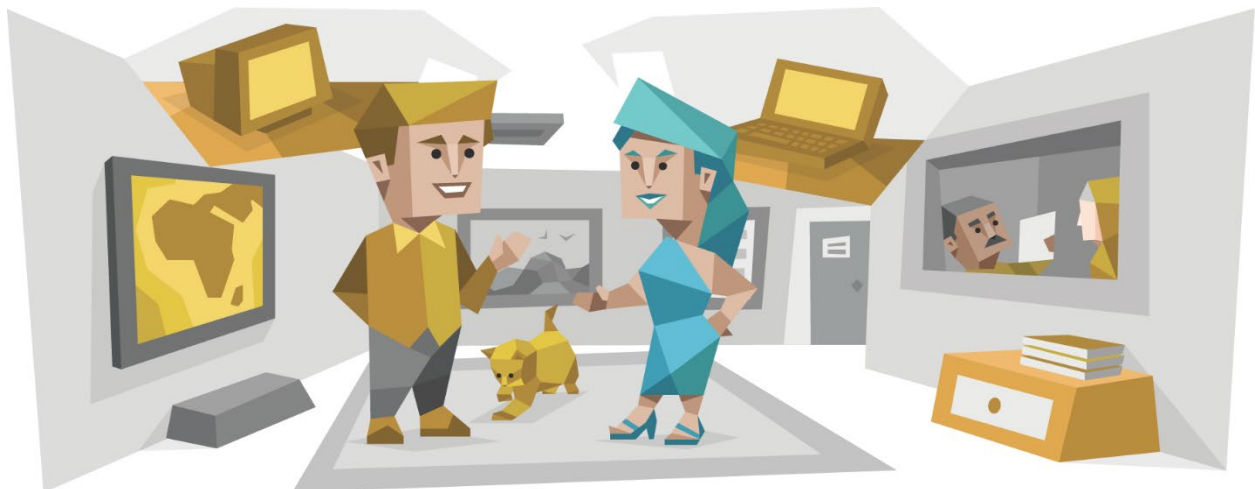
Speaking Each Other's Language

Adventurers can teach Diplomats how to most effectively communicate with them. To do so, they can ask their Diplomat colleagues questions that bridge the gap between the here-and-now and future considerations – for example, “What benchmarks should we focus on hitting first?” or “How can we start working toward this goal today?”

In turn, Adventurers can communicate in ways that take advantage of the strengths Diplomats have to offer. This entails keeping them abreast of developments and

action plans, allowing them to weigh in on potential conflicts or long-term consequences. When Adventurers sense that Diplomats are tuning them out, they can connect what they're saying to bigger-picture concerns or values – a surefire way to catch Diplomats' attention. For example, if an Adventurer says something along the lines of, "If we don't devote resources to fixing this problem now, then we risk losing our customers' trust," a Diplomat is likely to refocus and recognize the significance of a quality-control issue.

Adventurer-Sentinel Cooperation



It's easy to get the impression that Sentinels and Adventurers are opposites, as they often approach things differently. But they aren't without some commonalities. They both prefer to gather information directly from the world around them, instead of filtering it through internal mechanisms – neither type has much interest in theories.

While Adventurers are more in touch with things directly and immediately, Sentinels usually judge their experiences by remembering how things have always been. They're generally sticklers for rules and structures that support a traditional perspective. Adventurers relish the new and exciting, while Sentinels favor the stable.

Balanced Adventurer-Sentinel Cooperation

Troubleshooters

Adventurers and Sentinels can complement each other well when things go wrong. Sometimes even the tried-and-true ways of doing things fail us. This can be disconcerting for Sentinels – but a compelling problem to solve for Adventurers. When it's time to experiment, there are few people better to step in and help Sentinels than Adventurers.

However, Adventurers in such situations can benefit from Sentinels, too. Adventurers might feel tempted to act impulsively. When this happens, Sentinels can ground them and help them retrace their steps as necessary. Sometimes, boldly “winging it” can lead to effective solutions, and sometimes, this approach can create more problems than it solves. If willing, Adventurers and Sentinels can negotiate a balanced approach to tackling challenges together.

Unbalanced Adventurer-Sentinel Cooperation

Order versus Flow

Adventurers may also feel as if Sentinels are continually blocking their efforts to try new things – whether this means hiring a new vendor or even buying a different type of printer paper. Adventurers don't mind cutting corners when necessary, but Sentinels want those corners to remain intact – just the way they've always been. This can trigger tension and disagreement.

In unbalanced working relationships, Adventurers can come across as reckless and undisciplined to Sentinels. Meanwhile, Adventurers might perceive their Sentinel

colleagues as boring or uninspired. Such misperceptions can hinder trust and open communication.

For example, an Adventurer might want to hire a different graphic designer to create a company's annual brochure. A Sentinel might very well object, insisting that the designer who's always done the brochure would be the best choice. The Adventurer might roll their eyes at the Sentinel's stodginess and hire the new designer anyhow, reasoning that a better product is worth leaving their colleague in the dark.

Rebalancing Adventurer-Sentinel Cooperation

The Value of Protocols

As philosopher George Santayana wrote: "Those who cannot remember the past are condemned to repeat it." Adventurers can be too quick to dismiss Sentinels' attachments to the past and its settled protocols. To satisfy their own curiosity and make Sentinels feel heard, Adventurers can ask specific questions about their views, such as, "What do you see as the risks of veering from the status quo?" and "What would help you feel reassured about trying a new course of action?"

Mutual Learning

For Adventurers, accepting Sentinels' counsel may help them avoid problems. They might benefit from experimenting with Sentinels' suggestions, even if they seem too rooted in tradition. Adventurers are at low risk of permanently losing their spontaneity and edgy creativity by occasionally playing by the rules.

When Sentinels offer counsel that proves to be sound, Adventurers should take a moment to acknowledge them. Sentinels may never ask for it, but they're always

happy when someone shows appreciation. By offering credit when it's due, Adventurers can build stronger working relationships with them.

Adventurer-Explorer Cooperation



Adventurers and their fellow Explorers typically find themselves “speaking the same language.” Theoretical and conceptual problems, which thrill Analysts, seem superfluous or annoying to both. Conversations about solving problems or mastering skills or situations are of greater interest. People with these personality types gain energy and motivation from acting, not from pausing to consider the meaning of life.

Balanced Adventurer-Explorer Cooperation

Getting the Job Done

When working together, Adventurers and other Explorers want to figure out the best way to do the job. They may bypass rules, standards, or traditions that hinder their strategies. Because of this pronounced spontaneity and independence, other types

often see them as risk-takers. In the workplace, Adventurers may bond with other Explorers who share this willingness to experiment and break from protocol.

Practical Innovation

Working together, Adventurers and Explorers can free an organization from being stuck in a rut and following old, ineffective patterns. They may not spend their days making diagrams on whiteboards, but by jumping in and solving problems on the fly, together they often innovate in ways that create new best practices. The harnessed energy of Adventurers and other Explorers can be a formidable asset to any organization.

Unbalanced Adventurer-Explorer Cooperation

But at What Cost?

Adventurers and Explorers might feel so in tune with one another that they stop soliciting – or listening to – feedback from other colleagues. These two types can become trapped in their thinking style and lose the benefit of insight and perspective from those with different thought processes. If not balanced by the ideas and advice of other personality types, Adventurers and Explorers may act impulsively or take needless risks in their drive to get things done.

This drive to act and accomplish can also motivate Adventurers and Explorers to put practical solutions ahead of the feelings and concerns of others. It's not that they don't like their colleagues, especially those with the Feeling trait, but people tend to fall below solutions on their priority lists. The result can be a gulf between them and other coworkers.

Solutions with a Small Perspective

Adventurers and other Explorers might also find that their actions, although efficient in the short term, don't align with their organization's larger vision. Because both types are detail oriented and think in the present, they may disregard their company's overall concept of objectives and focus. Just as it takes only one degree of a compass to send a ship hundreds of miles off course, a small, misguided solution can disrupt an organization's larger goals.

The immediacy of the shared mindset of Adventurers and Explorers can create a type of tunnel vision if not adjusted and kept in check. Even when both types don't recognize the problem, their supervisors might accuse them of thumbing their noses at the vision and values of the company.

Rebalancing Adventurer-Explorer Cooperation

Appreciating Commonalities

When Adventurers and Explorers work together, they can take advantage of their easy camaraderie by brainstorming new and better ways of doing things. The two types are likely to come up with fresh approaches and promising experiments. They can make the work experience even more productive and rewarding if they find something to tinker with while they're chatting.

Getting a Second Opinion

When two types are so similar, a second opinion from someone with a different perspective is often essential. To identify their blind spots, Adventurers and Explorers can ask colleagues with other personality types for feedback. By doing so, they can

push beyond their comfort zones – something both Adventurers and Explorers often enjoy.

Asking “Why?”

Adventurers and Explorers who work together may find they're comfortable exploring the “how” questions involved in finding a solution. Learning to ask “why” may be just as essential. This, again, may require a second opinion from someone who's more in touch with the overall concept. By pausing to contemplate the “why” of their actions, Adventurers and Explorers can increase their efficiency and direct their energy in ways that align with the big picture.

Conclusion

Adventurers need to exercise independence – their autonomy is essential to their happiness and it motivates them to produce and succeed. If a job feels like overstructured conformity based on unskilled actions, Adventurers won't be able to access that part of themselves that responds in healthy ways to challenges.

To thrive in their work, Adventurers must find a niche that's their own. Most are good at this, having practiced it while dealing with school systems focused on more conventional things than they, as young people, could relate to. While not always good at commitment in any traditional sense, once they find their niche, they're usually all in for the duration. This allows them to become highly skilled and often specialized – making them valued workers and professionals in many fields.

Additional Tools and Tests

Want to dig even deeper into your professional development? If you have access to the toolkits area of the website, we offer a variety of additional tools and tests to help you explore.

Job Preferences Test

Among the most important things you decide in life is how you're going to make a living. Discover which job fields fit you best.

Job Burnout Test

We've all heard the term "burnout." But what does it mean to you? This test will guide you as you take a look at how burnout affects you.

Career Values Test

What should your job look like for you to call it "ideal"? What aspects matter most to you? This tool will help you answer these questions.

Leadership Styles Test

What is your leadership style? There is no right or wrong answer to that question. This test will help clarify your preferred approach.

Leadership Styles II Test

The second part of our Leadership Styles test will explore your desire to be a leader and willingness to delegate power.

Motivation Test

On average, we work for about 90,000 hours over our lifetime. With that in mind, it's helpful to figure out exactly what motivates you.

Ambition Test

How eager are you to succeed, and at what cost? Ambition can be a double-edged sword – explore how it works in your case.

Professional Authenticity Test

When at work, are you acting in a way that is consistent with your true self? Explore difficult questions about authenticity with this test.

Goal Orientation Test

What's the underlying motivation you feel when confronting a challenge? See which of the Goal Orientations influences you most.

Type Guesser (Workplace)

Are you trying to figure out what personality type your coworker belongs to? You may find that this simple tool helps.

Final Words



Independently Passionate

Creative and artistic, Adventurers seek to apply a fresh spin to ideas they're passionate about. Often, they dabble in what they find aesthetically pleasing. Living life believing each moment is an exciting opportunity to create something new overwhelmingly provides the wind for their sails. True Introverts, they need solitary time to recharge, evaluate their directions, and regroup.

But they're kind and sensitive to the needs of friends and strangers who enjoy their spontaneity and sometimes quirky take on things. While this renders Adventurers interesting to many, it can also provide them an air of being flighty. Their impulsiveness and unique perspectives can come across as unpredictable and unconventional to those unfamiliar with them, leaving the underlying impression that they're unreliable. However, Adventurers are often sensitive and easily stressed. Their imaginative and independent impulses involve risk and, consequently, invite criticism that can shake their confidence and self-esteem. This may be the challenge

of their lives: to be true to themselves while not being undermined by the opinions of others.

These tendencies need not debilitate Adventurers. Similar to the way they solve design problems, finding the right solution might only need enough creative attention to the problem – something that’s well within clever Adventurers’ skill set.

What’s Next?

We’ve covered many different topics in this profile, and we hope that the chapters have offered insight and answered questions about the Adventurer personality type. We hope that readers will now find it easier to understand other people and their perspectives. This profile isn’t meant to be read just once. When trying to understand another person better, or struggling to understand oneself, another read-through can offer fresh insight.

Furthermore, spend some time on our [website](#) – for example, by exploring our [articles](#) or [additional assessments](#). If you lead a team, our [Team Assessments](#) can help you understand its unique dynamics. There is a wealth of inspiring advice and information on the website, and we strongly recommend that you take a look. If you have some spare time, consider lending us a helping hand by taking additional [surveys](#) or simply [sending us a message](#) and sharing your thoughts about this profile or the website in general. We would love to hear from you.

We wish the best of luck to all Adventurers. What matters most in Adventurers’ lives is that their paths through life reflect who they are, deep within. Reflecting on values, dreams, and ideals often reveals the right path through life by clearing out superficial distractions. Our lives are often too full of troubles, conflicts, and worries. By working

to better understand each other, we can make our relationships, communities, and world more aware, more genuine, and more peaceful.

Until next time.

Addendum: The Puzzle of Personality

Often the very first question people ask after completing our personality test is “What do these letters mean?” We are of course referring to those mysterious acronyms like INTJ-A, ENFP-T, or ESTJ-A. As you may have already learned from the Type Descriptions or articles on the website, the five letters of these acronyms each refer to a specific trait, with certain trait combinations forming various types and type groups. But before we discuss those traits in depth, let’s explore their historical foundations.

The Historical Detour

Since the dawn of time, humans have drawn up schematics to describe and categorize our personalities. From the four temperaments of the ancient civilizations to the latest advances in psychology, we have been driven to fit the variables and complexities of human personality into well-defined models. Although we are still some time away from being able to do that, the current models account for our most important personality traits and can predict our behavior with a high degree of accuracy.

Personality is just one of many factors that guide our behavior, however. Our actions are also influenced by our environment, our experiences, and our individual goals. On our website, we describe how people belonging to a specific personality type are likely to behave. We outline indicators and tendencies, however, not definitive guidelines or answers. Significant differences can exist even among people who share a personality type. The information on this website is meant to inspire personal

growth and an improved understanding of yourself and your relationships – not to be taken as gospel.

Our approach has its roots in two different philosophies. One dates back to early 20th century and was the brainchild of Carl Gustav Jung, the father of analytical psychology. Jung's theory of psychological types is perhaps the most influential creation in personality typology, and it has inspired a number of different theories. One of Jung's key contributions was the development of the concept of Introversion and Extraversion – he theorized that each of us falls into one of these two categories, either focusing on the internal world (Introvert) or the outside world (Extravert). Besides Introversion and Extraversion, Jung coined the concept of so-called cognitive functions, separated into Judging or Perceiving categories. According to Jung, each person prefers one of these cognitive functions and may most naturally rely on it in everyday situations.

In the 1920s, Jung's theory was noticed by Katharine Cook Briggs, who later co-authored a personality indicator still used today, the Myers-Briggs Type Indicator® (MBTI®). Briggs was a teacher with an avid interest in personality typing, having developed her own type theory before learning of Jung's writings. Together with her daughter, Isabel Briggs Myers, they developed a convenient way to describe the order of each person's Jungian preferences – this is how four-letter acronyms were born.

Of course, this is just a very simplified description of the Myers-Briggs theory. Readers interested in learning more should read *Gifts Differing: Understanding Personality Type* by Isabel Briggs Myers. As we define personality traits and types differently in our model, we will not go deeper into Jungian concepts or related theories in this article.

Due to its simplicity and ease of use, the four-letter naming model has been embraced by a number of diverse theories and approaches over the last few decades, including frameworks such as Socionics, Keirsey Temperament Sorter, Linda Berens' Interaction Styles, and many others. While the acronyms used by these theories may be identical or very similar, however, their meanings do not always overlap. One of the reasons behind such a lengthy introduction is that we want to make it clear that there is no single definition assigned to these type acronyms – each theory defines them in their own way and it is entirely possible that if you meet five people who all say “I am an INFJ”, their definitions of what INFJ means are going to differ.

Types vs. Traits

Regardless of its structure, any type-based theory will struggle to describe or characterize people whose scores lie near the dividing line. A different way to look at personalities is through the lens of a trait-based rather than a type-based model. What do we mean by that? Instead of creating an arbitrary number of categories and attempting to fit people within them, a trait-based model simply studies the degree to which people exhibit certain traits.

You may have heard the term Ambivert, which is a perfect example in this case. Ambiversion means that someone falls in the middle of the Introversion-Extraversion scale, being neither too outgoing nor too withdrawn. Trait-based theories would simply say that an Ambivert is moderately Extraverted or moderately Introverted and leave it at that, without assigning a personality type.

A trait-based approach makes it easier to reliably measure correlations between personality traits and other characteristics – for example, political attitudes. This is

why trait-based approaches dominate psychometric research, but that's more or less the only area where these approaches are dominant. Because they don't offer types or categorizations, trait-based theories don't translate as well as type-based theories into specific recommendations and takeaways. Assigned categories such as Extravert or Introvert may be limiting, but they allow us to conceptualize human personality and create theories about why we do what we do – something that a more scientifically reliable but colorless statement, such as you are 37% Extraverted, simply cannot do.

Our Approach

With our NERIS® model, we've combined the best of both worlds. We use the acronym format introduced by Myers-Briggs for its simplicity and convenience, with an extra letter to accommodate five rather than four scales. However, unlike Myers-Briggs or other theories based on the Jungian model, we have not incorporated Jungian concepts such as cognitive functions, or their prioritization. Jungian concepts are very difficult to measure and validate scientifically, so we've instead chosen to rework and rebalance the dimensions of personality called the Big Five personality traits, a model that dominates modern psychological and social research.

Our personality types are based on five independent spectrums, with all letters in the type code (e.g. INFJ-A) referring to one of the two sides of the corresponding spectrum. You can see where you fall on each scale by completing our free personality assessment, NERIS Type Explorer®. This approach has allowed us to achieve high test accuracy while also retaining the ability to define and describe distinct personality types.

Five Personality Aspects

This section will describe five personality aspects that, when combined, define the personality type: Energy, Mind, Nature, Tactics and Identity. Each of these aspects should be seen as a two-sided continuum, with the “neutral” option placed in the middle. The percentages you would have seen after completing the test are meant to show which categories you fall under, and how strong your preferences are.

Let us now go through the personality aspects one by one:

Introverted vs. Extraverted

More Than People Power

When considering people who are Introverts (I) and Extraverts (E), it's natural to go straight to the more social aspects of these personality traits. However, they are more than this. These traits are also defined by their broader response to their environments, which includes other people but isn't exclusively about them.

Introvert (I) Personality

Strength in Reserve

Introverts are well-suited to many situations. A tendency to be reserved helps these personality types to pace themselves. They're likely to listen to others more carefully. Very introspective, Introverts enjoy more focused “alone time” – leading to more and deeper insights. And, while sometimes too sensitive to their environments, this often helps them pick up cues more quickly, making them great at reading many situations.

However, this same reserve means that Introverts tend to find outside stimuli like noise, motion, or intrusive lighting frustrating. Some of this can be an invigorating change of pace – too much unsettles them and drains their energy. These personality types often prefer to be in their own space where they can adjust their environments. Add a human factor to this sensitivity – for example, insistent conversations where they're expected to be just as insistent – and it can exhaust them. They need time alone to regather their energy and restore their calm.

Introverts' reserved, more solitary nature presents challenges, as many societies favor Extraverts and their bolder approach. But it helps Introverted personality types to take things slowly, cautiously, and with less fanfare. Fortunately, if they're willing – and create the time to recharge on their own – most Introverts can handle society's strenuous demands.

In fact, many successful leaders and entertainers come from their ranks, often remaining humble and avoiding an unnecessary spotlight in fame. The Introversion personality trait never needs to disqualify those who possess it from pursuing a goal.

Extravert (E) Personality

The Power of Engagement

Extraverts are interested in engaging with their environment, and they feed off the responses of the people and events around them. They enjoy pushing limits and seeing what the world can do. This all depends on many other factors and life's natural limitations, but Extraverted personality types lean toward taking the initiative and relying on the world around them for validation.

While all of this is noble and often admired in society, it can also become unbridled. Extraverts may put too much value in their engagement with those around them. Being with others can be so important to these personalities that they often find it difficult if they're stuck alone. Boredom comes too easily. This can lead them to do things simply for excitement rather than thinking through more subtle but important considerations. Becoming the center of attention – at any cost – might be too appealing.

However, when they suitably address these challenges, Extraverts are forces to be reckoned with. People with this personality trait tend to advance projects important to them quickly, whether personal or professional. They often choose to lead when given a chance – and can be dynamic in that role. Their outgoing energy can be vital to a social gathering, and their liveliness can be contagious. And there always remains a sense that people are important to them.

Intuitive vs. Observant

Thought at Every Scale

Our second personality scale includes the Intuitive (N) and Observant (S) styles. These traits describe what people are more likely to do with the information gathered from the world around them. Intuitive personality types rely on imagining the past and future potential of what they see. Those with the Observant style are more interested in observable facts and more straightforward outcomes. They prefer to avoid layering too much interpretation on what they see.

Being Intuitive doesn't mean someone can't be practical, and being Observant doesn't mean a lack of imagination. They both use their minds and their physical

senses well. The difference is the spin they put on their experiences – it's where their thinking goes after an encounter with their environment. If Intuitive personality types appreciate Observant types' practicality, and Observant personality types appreciate Intuitive types' imaginative perspective, they can complement each other in ways that make for unbeatable partnerships.

Intuitive (N) Personality

Eyes on the Horizon

People with the Intuitive trait prefer to exercise their imaginations as they seek new ideas and possibilities. They live their day-to-day lives just like any other personality type. But while that's happening, their minds tend to point inward while at the same time gently focusing somewhere beyond the horizon. Their lives are ones of questioning, wondering, and connecting the dots in the "bigger picture," and they love the theoretical. They often ask, "What if?" and ponder the possibilities the future might hold.

But Intuitive people aren't always the most practical, preferring instead to give things deeper meaning. There may be a long wait as these personality types allow their imaginations free rein. They may also leap in too quickly to more complex matters. An entire theory can come together in moments, leaving others confused. In either case, they can appear out of touch to the Observant individuals in their lives. For some Intuitive folk, there may be some truth to this observation.

That said, when there's a need for innovation or a different perspective, people with Intuitive personality types can usually step up and provide a new direction. Practicality can sometimes be overrated, especially when a situation calls for serious change and "coloring outside the lines." This is where Intuitive people shine. They

bring interesting dimensions to life beyond everyday ideas – and take those who decide to go along with them.

Observant (S) Personality

Do What Works

The phrase “real-time” was created with Observant individuals in mind. They’re most in touch with what occurs in front of them, in the present. This doesn’t mean Observant personality types have no regard for the past and future. But they view both from the perspective of how each influences their present actions. This makes them focused and practical people. They mostly root their thinking in the actionable, tangible, and useful. But make no mistake, these personalities can be creative within that realm.

One challenge people with the Observant personality trait may face is a too-narrow perspective. They may reject far-reaching solutions in favor of something more obvious. By continuing something that appears practical at arm’s length but doesn’t fit the bigger picture, they might reduce their hard work to busywork.

People with the Observant trait are often a steadying force that tends to get things done. Their energy is very “hands-on” in the sense of working on real things in real-time. While they’re often smart people, spending a lot of time sitting around and pondering possibilities doesn’t cut it for Observant personality types. They want thoughts and talk to lead to action.

Thinking vs. Feeling

How to Think and Feel About the Thinking and Feeling Traits

Our third, Nature scale reveals the extent to which we value emotions or rationality more when considering options. Does a person tend to use the Thinking (T) personality trait, which relies on the head, or the Feeling (F) trait, which relies on the heart?

But let's not oversimplify. Think of it instead as you might your hand preference: A left-handed person leans more heavily on their left hand, but they still use their right hand, albeit less. We can apply the same approach to a person with a dominant Thinking trait or a dominant Feeling trait – they aren't without some qualities of the non-dominant trait.

Thinking (T) Personality

"How Does This Help?"

When presented with a decision, people with the Thinking trait typically lean on objective information. Knowledge is their indispensable tool. Once these personality types gather the facts, they test their alternatives against logic and reason to see which decision, by those standards, proves the most effective or realistic. They generally manage their relationships by employing fairness and effectiveness as their primary method of dealing with others. Their passions are born of respect.

Whatever value people with the Thinking personality trait place on relationships, they can still dismiss emotional responses, either their own or those of others. This is often because of their discomfort with emotions, which don't always follow the rational path they value. Sometimes, emotions just puzzle them. But that doesn't

mean they have hearts of stone. They often feel in deep, profound ways – they would just rather not decide matters from that place. And, perhaps unfortunately, they may see those who do as weaker decision-makers.

Personality types with the Thinking trait are likely to evaluate things almost relentlessly. This isn't as bad as it sounds. They aren't satisfied if they believe something is not well thought out – they revel in the brilliance of an elegant plan. This makes them great to have around when critical thinking and impartiality of any kind is the focus, and this makes them immensely helpful for sorting out ideas and methods. Their primary filter is, *"How does this help?"*

Feeling (F) Personality

"Who Does This Help?"

People with the Feeling (F) trait follow their hearts and emotions – sometimes without even realizing it. They may show it to different degrees and in different ways, but however they do it, Feeling personality types tend to be caring, compassionate, and warm. These concerned people can be highly protective of those they care about – whether that is their immediate family or remote populations in need.

However, people with the Feeling personality trait often find they become excessive in their concern for others. They may easily burn out – or cause others to – when they become too involved. These emotionally aware individuals can become depressed if they feel they haven't been as selfless in life as they imagine they should be, or if those they have helped seem to fall down regardless.

Feeling personality types' concern for others typically affects all their endeavors. This can be practical and close, as with family, friends, and colleagues. Or it can be broader, as with world peace, ending hunger, and giving the disadvantaged a boost.

But this reliance on feelings doesn't mean there is no logic – theirs is just a different logic. They see that emotions can't simply be waved away, so feelings and the welfare of others shape their lives more than stark facts and cold objectivity. Weighing things this way makes these personalities valuable to have around when the big question is, “Who does this help?”

Judging vs. Prospecting

Crossing the Finish Line (By Whatever Means)

The Tactics scale, which includes the Judging and Prospecting personality traits, reflects how people plan and deal with the options they have. But this definition doesn't just concern what individuals write in their day planners. It's much broader. These traits answer questions like, “Do you prefer spontaneity or certainty?” “Do you feel more comfortable acting only with all your ducks lined neatly in a row? Or does a certain amount of flexibility or chaos excite you and prove motivating?” “Do you need more choices or fewer?”

Judging (J) Personality

Making Things as They Ought to Be

People with the Judging (J) personality trait feel most comfortable when the course ahead is well-marked. They would rather come up with five backup plans than deal with events as they come. Preferring to consider their options ahead of time,

personality types with this trait prefer clarity and closure, sticking with the plan rather than going with the flow. It's as if Judging types always keep a mental checklist. When they cross something off their list – or even start an item on their list – they consider it complete and not open to reconsideration.

The downside is, if they take this too far, those with the Judging trait sometimes come across as rigid. However, most are not unreasonably stubborn. It's important to remember their need for structure always is a preference and reality often calls on them to respond in unforeseen ways. Too many surprises in a row can leave these personality types frustrated and stressed. When this happens, they can still be relied on to develop a plan (and a contingency plan), but however well they handle the unexpected, they rarely enjoy it.

Judging individuals tend to have a strong work ethic, putting their duties and responsibilities above everything else. To them, rules, laws, and standards are the key to success. They can be too dependent on these measures, whether applied to themselves or others. But the intent is almost always one of fairness and results.

Prospecting (P) Personality

Figuring Things Out as They Go

Prospecting (P) individuals are much more flexible when it comes to dealing with unexpected challenges. This flexibility helps them seize unexpected opportunities as well. These personality types tend to react to their environments rather than try to control them, helping them to make their own luck in whatever the world delivers. People with this trait hold that life is full of possibilities.

All this opportunism can lead to impulsive decision-making, though. At the same time, they can be overwhelmed by the sheer number of options on their radar. People with the Prospecting personality trait can be slow to commit to something because of uncertainty or the potential of everything else. If they don't moderate this trait, indecision or a lack of conviction can be a problem. They can seem unfocused. What was important to them one week may be forgotten the next.

Despite those concerns, this personality trait can offer a great deal of creativity and productivity. Theirs is almost a stream of consciousness quality. In many ways, it's like these types are constantly brainstorming as their minds create a web of options. This can be a powerful tool for finding solutions. And if they aren't satisfied with something in their lives, it's easier for them to let go of it and choose something else. This can lead to serial passions that keep Prospecting individuals stimulated as they explore the buffet of choices always before them.

Assertive vs. Turbulent

Confidence, Achievement, and You

The Identity scale, made up of the Assertive and Turbulent personality traits, affects all other scales and indicates how confident we are in our abilities and decisions. Identity triggers the way we react to the things life constantly throws at us. How do we respond to success and failure? Criticism or feedback from other people? Unexpected events that suddenly change many things or everything? Even the unknown future?

Assertive (-A) Personality

Calm in the Storm

Assertive individuals are self-assured, even-tempered, and resistant to stress. They don't worry too much, but this is different from apathy. They aim for goals and want successful results, but they typically won't let nervousness color the path to their accomplishments. They're unlikely to spend a lot of time thinking about their past actions or choices. According to Assertive personality types, what's done is done.

However, problems may arise for them if their confidence turns into overconfidence. Assertive individuals may gloss over problems or details that can interfere with their goals and desired results. They may lean toward assuming all will be positive. Assertive people also sometimes presume they are free to do much more than others would allow or tolerate. If overconfident, these personality types may come to believe their confidence overshadows what others want.

But their confidence remains. It can help them move forward where others might hesitate. People with this personality trait report more satisfaction with their lives. They feel more assured of their abilities to handle the difficult and the unexpected. Through this lens, they often create the kinds of success that matter to them.

Turbulent (-T) Personality

Power of Stress, Activate!

Turbulent individuals are success-driven, perfectionistic, and eager to improve. They are always trying to counterbalance their self-doubts by achieving more. Just as they push themselves to become better, they're as likely to push their projects or efforts

in the same direction. Turbulent personality types tend to notice little problems and often do something about them before they become larger ones.

There are potential downsides to all this attention and achievement. Always feeling the need to do more, to have more, and to *be* more, Turbulent individuals can also get caught up in endless thoughts of criticisms, slights, or regrets. This can either bog them down or motivate them to do better. Their sensitivity to potential problems can be useful – unless that’s all they think about and the problems clutter their attention. Turbulent personality types may compulsively scan for what might go wrong instead of keeping their eyes on more positive targets – on what could go right.

Careful and attentive people are always important to society and keep it safe. At the same time, a fear of stagnation can bring about great change. Turbulent individuals beautifully cover both. When these personalities balance their worries and concerns with positive action, they’re likely to prove themselves to be of great value.

Type Groups

Now you know what each type consists of. But how do they fit together?

Our system has two layers: the first (inner) one defines our Roles, the second (outer) one – our Strategies.

Roles

Personality theory is a study of similarities among people with shared traits and how these traits might be expressed through behaviors and attitudes. Traits are the most fundamental part of our framework and include characteristics like Introversion or

Thinking. The next level contains personality types, in which four of the traits are combined and sorted to create 16 personality types. Roles, simply put, are the next level. At the Role level, the 16 types are divided into four groups.

Which personality types belong to each Role depends on two shared traits that they have in common. While all traits influence behaviors and attitudes, the two traits that determine a Role are shared by only four personality types and instill in them some unique, matching characteristics.

Those with the Intuitive trait (Analysts and Diplomats) are paired with the Thinking/Feeling traits because the Intuitive trait focuses on internal processes like thinking and feeling. While they may ultimately play out in the external world, they are primarily inward-looking.

In like manner, those with the Observant trait (Sentinels and Explorers) are paired with the Judging/Prospecting traits. Judging and Prospecting, while they have their internal aspects, are more likely to be played out in the external, concrete world of action and doing. Sentinels with their Judging trait are likely to bring order to their worlds, while Explorers with their Prospecting trait are likely to instill spontaneity into all the actions they perform.

The four Roles are primarily used when they are more likely to explain concepts in a clearer, less complicated way than involving all 16 personality types might. Using Roles this way is particularly warranted if the topic consists of a trait or traits that are a prominent part of the core traits of the various Roles – such as when Intuitive or Observant have a greater influence. But use is not limited to just that. They're like shorthand when Role commonalities suffice in talking about a subject.

In summary, Roles are just another level of the same theory, with each of the four containing four personality types. Those within a Role share a combination of two prominent traits and, therefore, share some similar characteristics.

The Role layer determines our goals, interests, and preferred activities. There are four roles:

Analysts – Intuitive (N) and Thinking (T)

Thinkers, Not Robots

The personality types in the Analyst Role – Architects (INTJ), Logicians (INTP), Commanders (ENTJ), and Debaters (ENTP) – are known for their love of rationality. Because they share the Thinking trait, these types often aim to make decisions with their heads rather than their hearts. But Analysts are far from being robots. Their Intuitive personality trait energizes their imaginations, helping them to come up with creative strategies and motivating them to explore things deeply – whether that’s an intellectual pursuit, a new interest, or even a crazy scheme or thought experiment.

These personalities are driven to understand and create. They have no problem switching between speculative musing and tactical problem-solving. Of course, these broad abilities need to be honed – and, when appropriate, they need to lead to action. Otherwise, Analysts’ active minds can give them a false sense of accomplishment.

These types often love ideas and speculation more than the realities of follow-through. As a result, they risk being outpaced by those who simply sit down and do the work. This can earn these types a reputation for being “armchair analysts” – and,

at times, Analyst personalities may forget that they actually need to test their ideas in the real world.

Driven by Curiosity

Analysts are innately curious. This helps them to ensure that their ideas are workable, rather than just clever. These personality types have a strong drive to learn, and they want to find out things for themselves rather than accept received wisdom. These types may be found stockpiling books, questioning teachers, spurring debates, or driving conversations in forums across the Internet.

Analysts are also relentless self-improvers. Once they've recognized a flaw, they apply all of their rationality, imagination, and desire for results to make it right. Especially when it's balanced with self-understanding, this drive can enable Analyst personalities to push the boundaries of what's possible – no matter what anyone else may think.

Socially Selective

Analysts can have a reputation for being lone wolves. These personality types don't necessarily care about befriending everyone they meet, and they definitely don't surround themselves with random people just for the sake of having some company.

Given a choice between spending time with someone incompatible or spending time alone, many Analysts would choose the latter. And they may not be so subtle about it. 71% of people with Analyst personality types say they're good at shutting down unwanted conversations – far more than any other Role. This brusqueness can make Analysts seem rude, unapproachable, or antisocial, particularly to types that value social harmony.

That said, it's important to note that only 17% of Analysts actually describe their ideal social life as "mostly by myself." Much greater numbers – 30% and 41% respectively – say they'd prefer to have a few good friends or a partner and a few good friends. As a result, it's inaccurate to view these personality types as antisocial.

Instead, it makes sense to view Analysts as socially selective. Like other types, they crave social connection. But these personalities won't feel socially fulfilled by spending time with just anyone. They want to surround themselves with people who really get them – even if it takes effort to find those people. That might be why 46% of Analysts say they actively seek new friendships – which is more than any other Role except Diplomats.

Independent Minds

Analysts have little patience for following in others' footsteps. 58% of these personality types describe themselves as "very independent" – far more than any other Role. Independence isn't just a characteristic of these types – it's an important part of their self-image.

This mindset shows up vividly in how Analysts approach academic and professional settings. These personality types are questioners, reluctant to take anything on faith. And "anything" includes what their teachers or bosses say.

From the outside, this might look like a lack of respect. In our Teachers Survey, Analysts were far less likely than other Roles to say they admired their past teachers. And this mindset persists in the professional sphere as well. 43% of Analysts in the workforce say they would be better than their boss at their boss's job – again, far more than any other Role. Analyst personalities are also far less likely than other Roles to express admiration for their bosses.

But does this represent a lack of respect? Maybe – but this choosiness might well have other roots. Analysts tend to hold themselves to high standards, and they often hold the people around them (bosses and teachers included) to these high standards as well. In addition, Analyst personality types tend to care a great deal about learning and professional success. 85% of Analysts say they have a strong desire to be an important and successful person.

It makes sense, then, that these personality types hold their teachers and bosses to rigorous standards. After all, an Analyst with a poor teacher or boss may be less likely to become successful. Of course, Analysts – just like anyone – will almost certainly find themselves faced with a less-than-stellar teacher or boss. As a result, figuring out how to navigate these situations is an important part of their development.

Problems? What Problems?

You know who talks a lot about their problems? Not Analysts. In fact, 83% of Analysts say that most people complain too much about their problems.

But that doesn't mean that people with these personality types don't *think* about their problems, and they certainly don't shy away from challenges. 61% of Analysts say they're excited by the idea of being responsible for solving problems, and 85% say they enjoy tackling difficult challenges.

A core strength of Analysts is their faith in their problem-solving abilities. Analyst personalities tend to express the highest intellectual self-confidence of any Role, and this gives them the willingness to try their hand at things that may be hard. Taken too far, this can turn into cockiness – which is rarely an asset, whether in relationships or in other spheres. But as long as Analysts balance their intellectual self-assurance

with their innate curiosity, these personality types can find success and even enjoyment in the face of challenges both large and small.

Diplomats – Intuitive (N) and Feeling (F)

Longing for Connection

Diplomat personality types – Advocates (INFJ), Mediators (INFP), Protagonists (ENFJ), and Campaigners (ENFP) – care about helping and connecting with others. They prioritize being kind and generous, and in general, they'd rather cooperate than compete. Empathy seems to come naturally to these personalities. It can almost seem as if their hearts and minds resonate with other people's emotions.

These types aim to understand themselves and others. They often have deep insights into human nature, and they can use these insights to influence the people around them. Fortunately, Diplomat personality types tend to do this with care. They are sensitive to other people's feelings, and they want to nudge the people around them in positive directions.

Striving for Change

Diplomats have a deep belief in the ideals of humanism – altruism, compassion, and understanding. These personality types believe it is possible to create a kinder world, and they strive to do so every day.

The Intuitive trait fuels this optimism. Paradoxically, though, it also makes these types hyper-sensitive to wrongdoing. This sensitivity provides Diplomat personalities with the motivation they need to tackle injustice, which is important. If left unchecked, however, this personality trait can trigger self-righteousness or single-mindedness.

In general, Diplomats are motivated by principles rather than practicality. This helps them to stay true to their big dreams and ideas. That said, these types may have trouble enacting plans that are pragmatic rather than passion-driven. Diplomats can be tempted to ignore day-to-day tasks in favor of their big dreams and ideas. As these personalities mature, however, they often learn to balance these necessary tasks with the big-picture thinking they enjoy.

A Higher Purpose

Among friends and family, Diplomat personalities can range from quietly caring to brightly gregarious. Unfortunately, their open hearts can make them vulnerable when others are inconsiderate. That said, these types wouldn't have it any other way. Someone must trust first, and Diplomats will almost always volunteer.

These personality types see magical beauty where others see the humdrum of daily life. This trait attracts many Diplomats to creative expression. These types can be passionately inspired by music, writing, cuisine, theater – or many other creative pursuits.

Diplomats want to bring progress and beauty to the world around them. These types are led by a sense of higher purpose, and they care about serving the greater good. As a result, activism, spirituality, healing, and volunteering are common interests for these personality types.

The Need to Belong

For Diplomats, authenticity and connection aren't just buzzwords. These concepts – which might seem vague or wishy-washy to other types – form the bedrock of

Diplomats' lives. This explains why relationships matter so much to these personality types – and not just *any* type of relationship, but rather real, meaningful bonds.

When asked about their ideal social life, only 8% of Diplomats would like to spend most of their time alone. Instead, the majority of Diplomats express a desire for a partner and a few good friends. These personalities may also worry more about loneliness than other types, with nearly two thirds of Diplomats saying they worry about being lonely in their old age.

For many Diplomats, a central challenge of their lives is to balance their need for authenticity with their need to belong. More than any other personality Role, Diplomats say that the need to belong often motivates them to do things they otherwise wouldn't. This sort of behavior might not bother other types, but it poses a real dilemma for Diplomats. Being fake can feel literally painful to these types, who long to be loved and accepted for who they are, not for their ability to fit in.

For Diplomats, an important part of self-development is learning to be real – even if they fear that doing so won't make them popular. The irony is that many Diplomat personalities only feel a deep sense of belonging and connection once they learn to approach relationships as their whole, true selves.

What is Success, Anyway?

If your life goals are to earn pots of money, land an impressive job, buy a fancy car, and be better than everyone else – well, you're probably not a Diplomat.

But that isn't to say that Diplomats don't have their own type of ambition. 85% of Diplomats say it's important to them to make a lasting impact on other people, outside of their family and closest friends. In other words, these personality types

want to make a lasting difference in the world – which is no small feat. This might explain why Diplomats are second only to Analysts in saying that they sometimes set impossibly high standards for themselves.

Perhaps because they have such a lofty view of success, Diplomats are the Role least likely to consider themselves successful. It's important to note that the great majority of people with these personality types still say they'd be upset if they never became successful. As a result, many people with these types may feel as if they're constantly striving toward ideals and expectations that they'll never meet.

To address this sense of inadequacy, many Diplomats find they must let go of comparisons to other people. 79% of Diplomats say they consciously compare themselves to others either often or very often. By releasing these comparisons, Diplomats can free themselves to do things their own way, in their own time – rather than fretting over whether they're successful yet.

Time to Leap

You know that expression, “Leap and the net will appear”? Diplomat personality types can fall into the trap of thinking they've leapt – metaphorically speaking – when they're actually still perched at the ledge. Because these personalities have such active mental lives and imaginations, they can forget that thinking about starting a business isn't the same as actually starting a business, or that watching videos of dancers isn't the same as throwing themselves into a pirouette.

For many Diplomats, the secret to tackling their greatest challenge is simply to take action. Of course, that's easier said than done. The majority of Diplomats say they overthink simple tasks – so you can only imagine how much they might overthink major life decisions or their most precious dreams.

Fortunately, Diplomats tend to have a deep intuitive sense of what is right for them. Many of these personality types find that by tuning into this wisdom – and honoring it – they can find satisfaction and meaning in their everyday lives, no matter what challenges arise along the way.

Sentinels – Observant (S) and Judging (J)

Character and Competence

Sentinels – Logisticians (ISTJ), Defenders (ISFJ), Executives (ESTJ), and Consuls (ESFJ) – are cooperative, practical, and grounded. They feel comfortable with who they are, and they take pride in their good character and their competence. These personality types seek order, security, and stability, and they tend to work hard to maintain their way of things. This leads to a deserved reputation as the cornerstone of any group or organization, from family to church to the office and the factory floor.

Careful and consistent, Sentinel personalities tend to be self-motivated. This means that they rarely need external inspiration to be productive and focused. They work hard and aim never to let anyone down, and they expect other people to embrace this same ethic as well. Given a choice, these personality types prefer to collaborate within a clear set of rules. Following proven methods makes more sense to them than swanning around in search of innovation. Their motto is, “If it works, don’t break it.”

Steady Progress

That said, Sentinels are hardly unimaginative. They simply take inspiration from the past rather than the future. These personality types remain loyal to established best practices and traditions, whether that’s the best way to make a pizza crust or the

most efficient way to write an algorithm. This enables them to make steady, consistent progress – which is exactly what they enjoy. Sentinels would much rather guide a single project to completion than start (and abandon) a flurry of interesting ideas.

Sentinel personalities thrive in environments that have clear hierarchies and rules. Whether or not they're in a formal leadership role, they care about setting a good example, and they gain great satisfaction from guiding a well-functioning group. This can make them excellent teachers, managers, and community officials, as well as caring parents and hosts.

Guidance and Wisdom

In their personal lives, Sentinels want to offer stability and wisdom to others. They see it as their duty to give their families safe, happy lives that prepare them for the real world. An appreciation of strong relationships allows these personality types to share generously with those they respect and love. Sentinels feel bolstered by having reliable people in their lives, and they make sure they hold up their end of the bargain. Birthdays, dinner parties, and camping trips are delightful events under their enthusiastic direction.

These personality types are happiest without drama – though they can occasionally be stubborn. In particular, inconsistent people can test Sentinels' patience. It can be difficult for Sentinel personalities to accept people who lack their conscientiousness. Fortunately, they often serve as engaged and caring mentors to those who wish to grow in that direction.

Love and Care

Sentinels are the personality Role least likely to say they fall in love easily – but don't let that fool you. Sentinels may not spout love poems, but they do express affection and admiration – they just do it a little differently than other personality types. Sentinels often show their love in practical ways, such as checking the tires on their partner's car or making them a nutritious dinner. To other types, these actions might not look romantic, but Sentinels do these things with love and care.

In all of their relationships, Sentinels want to make contributions. This attitude informs how they treat not only their nearest and dearest but also their acquaintances, neighbors, and coworkers. These aren't the personality types who neglect their responsibilities or leave the office kitchen a mess – in fact, they're often the types who quietly clean up other people's messes, both literal and metaphorical.

Of course, Sentinels wouldn't *mind* being recognized for the ways they help others, but these personalities rarely demand attention. Instead, they work behind the scenes to make everyone's lives run as smoothly as possible, even if that means taking on unglamorous tasks like remembering to buy toilet paper or handling their family's income taxes. They may not be obvious with their feelings, but Sentinels do care and care deeply – you just have to know how to spot it.

Due Diligence

Sentinels have a core set of principles that they bring to their academic and professional pursuits. These principles include diligence, honesty, and respect. The result is that Sentinel personality types tend to work hard, striving to meet deadlines, and generally get things done. This can be seen even from a relatively young age –

Sentinels are far more likely than other Roles to say that they developed productive work habits in school.

These personality types have a clear vision of what it means to do things “right,” and they take great pride in living up to these standards. Sentinels are rarely willing to cut corners and do shoddy work – even if doing so would help them get ahead. They are less likely than any other Role to say that they could compromise some of their principles to advance their career.

Above all, Sentinels stand out for their ability to stick with their work until it’s done – even if the work is tedious or rote. These personality types are far less likely than others to say that they often abandon work in favor of doing something more interesting and fun, and they’re also less likely to say that they get distracted from what they’re working on. For Sentinels, productivity is a bit of a superpower – and they get great satisfaction from exercising their ability to get things done.

Planning Ahead

Sentinels know the value of a well-made plan. Compared to other Roles, Sentinel personalities are far more likely to say they’d rather prepare for problems rather than tackle them as they arise. And Sentinels aren’t afraid to think up every contingency that might arise – as long as they can do something to avert disaster, that is.

Of course, we can’t prepare for everything – although if anyone could, it would be a Sentinel. Like everyone else, these types must occasionally face unforeseen problems. Learning to roll with the punches, so to speak, is an important part of their personal development. Over time, Sentinels can learn to distinguish between when they should stick with their plans and when they’d do well to change course. And

when they do so, these personality types can press through even the most challenging of circumstances, bringing together determination and adaptability.

Explorers – Observant (S) and Prospecting (P)

On the Fly

Explorers – Virtuosos (ISTP), Adventurers (ISFP), Entrepreneurs (ESTP), and Entertainers (ESFP) – tend to be self-reliant and quick-thinking. These personality types don't mind handling uncertain situations on the fly – in fact, they live for those types of situations. Explorers' flexibility helps them to adapt to the moment, even if they don't feel particularly prepared.

These types tend not to be obsessed with precise detail – unless they're really in the zone, in which case they can muster a level of precision and focus that would make a seasoned engineer blush with envy. Usually, they prefer workability and usefulness to perfection. Explorer personalities enjoy learning different tools and techniques, from rotary saws to sheet music to emergency response strategies.

Living for Change

Explorers can change their minds with minimal regret or second-guessing. People in this Role dislike monotony, and they may stray from their obligations in order to try new things. If these personality types sometimes leave business unfinished, let clutter build up, or misplace important things – it's because they've moved on to something fresh.

These types enjoy being free of obligations, where they can indulge themselves or their interests on their own time. They love delving into something interesting, but their interest tends to wane as soon as something becomes “mandatory.” An

Explorer personality might design and build their own dream house, but end up procrastinating on simple repairs after a few years.

Social Ingenuity

This free-form attitude can make Explorer personalities socially dynamic as well. Their spontaneity draws them to appealing strangers and interesting experiences. When things get in the way of a good time, they apply their ingenuity to get around it. Explorers want to see what happens next!

Explorers enjoy being on the leading edge of things – whether that means having the latest technology, trying out fashion trends, or checking out the newest restaurant in town. Many Explorer personalities enjoy sharing these findings with others, and they take pride in introducing their friends and loved ones to the latest and greatest things. The result is that time spent with Explorers is almost never boring or repetitive – and Explorers wouldn't have it any other way.

Explorers in Love

Explorer personality types have a reputation for constantly being on the move – and some people might wonder whether this restlessness applies to their romantic relationships as well. According to our research, however, relatively few Explorers (32%) say they're easily bored by romantic relationships that are stable and predictable. In fact, Analysts and Diplomats are significantly more likely to agree with this statement.

So, what *are* Explorers like in romantic relationships? First, Explorers are slightly less likely than other Roles to say that falling in love scares them. These personality types thrive in unpredictable situations, and what is falling in love if not unpredictable? The

early phases of a relationship are energizing for these types – full of new experiences and fresh discoveries.

It's true that Explorer personalities are somewhat more likely than other Roles to avoid commitment. Still, the majority of Explorers – 63% – say they usually seek commitment in their relationships. And overall, Explorers are slightly more likely than average to say that intimate relationships have increased their maturity more than anything else. So, while Explorers might have a reputation for being commitment-phobes, it's clear that these personality types see the deeper value of long-term relationships – and, more often than not, this is exactly what they're looking for.

Doing the Work

Explorers are highly spontaneous, connecting with their environment in a way that's almost childlike in its wonder and sheer fun. But when they need to work on something that's frustrating or unexciting – well, that can prove something of a challenge.

This may show up in how Explorer personality types approach their academic and professional lives. Explorers are slightly less likely than other Roles to say that they developed productive work habits in school. They're also less likely to say that it was easy for them to do well in school. Many school environments are relatively prescriptive, filled with required courses and standardized curricula. As a result, Explorer personalities often find themselves forced to sit through classes that just don't excite them – which, for these types, can be unmotivating. Unfortunately, this can persist in their professional lives as well – after all, most jobs require at least some degree of routine, unglamorous work.

This isn't to say that Explorers are slouches – far from it. When they're working on something they're passionate about, these personality types can move heaven and earth. And, over time, they often find ways to deal with the necessary evils – in other words, the unexciting tasks – that make work and life run more smoothly.

Perhaps it's most accurate to say that Explorers look for ways to balance work with leisure. They're the Role least likely to say they make themselves finish all of their tasks before they allow themselves to relax. While some personality types might brand this behavior as laziness, this isn't necessarily the case. Explorers' ability to balance work with fun can help them avoid burnout. Ultimately, this can help them to enjoy more fulfillment – and yes, a surprising degree of productivity – in their lives.

The Power of Risk

51% of Explorers say they take risks simply for the fun of it – far more than any other personality Role. This might sound reckless, and indeed it can be. But, done responsibly, risk-taking can be one of the best ways to learn new things, solve tricky problems, and grow as people. As Explorers know, we can only make so much progress in life if we stay in our comfort zones.

As long as they temper this trait with a degree of self-control, comfort with risk can be one of Explorers' greatest strengths. It can motivate them to open up in their relationships and empower them to seek out new academic and professional opportunities.

These personality types don't resign themselves to the "lives of quiet desperation" that Henry David Thoreau famously wrote of in *Walden*. Instead, Explorers can use their own brand of bravery to free themselves from conventionality and create lives that work for them.

Strategies

The word “strategy” suggests a course of action. In our use, Strategy describes how personality types act in response to the world around them and how they might choose to accomplish things.

Strategies express themselves primarily in two ways: social style and resistance to stress. Social style entails how other people factor into an individual’s Strategy and to what degree. One example might involve whether a person prefers working in a team or alone.

Resistance to stress includes the degree of impact that a stressful situation might have on an individual and their efforts, as well as how resilient they might be when trying to restore themselves after a challenging event. An example of this might involve whether a person quits after a jarring setback or presses forward.

The Energy aspect (Introverted/Extraverted) brings to each combination a social piece. When individuals pursue their goals or satisfy their needs and wants, to what degree will they involve other people? Do they want to achieve things independently, or are they collaborators and team players? Extraverted personality types often wish to have more people around, and Introverts tend to prefer doing things more independently.

But the Energy aspect also speaks to risk and taking leaps of faith. Extraverts tend to be more adventurous, and they are brimming with enthusiasm for the activities in their lives – especially if they involve other people. Introverts feel a pull toward lone activities and are usually calmer and quieter, preferring quiet and solitude or smaller, more intimate groups when possible. Introverted personality types are not as interested in adventures as their Extraverted counterparts.

The Identity aspect (Assertive/Turbulent) describes levels of confidence and resistance to stress. It helps us understand what might motivate someone. Are they being pulled along by their self-confidence, or are they pushed to excel because they are perfectionists focused on preventing mistakes and failures?

Assertive personalities are much less likely to worry about things – even results. Their motivation may involve boldly realizing the potential that they assume they have. They are less concerned with the opinions of others and may stand up to their critics – not to impress them but to “correct” them. Turbulent personalities are self-conscious, cautious, and perfectionistic. They may go one of two ways. They may push themselves to high levels of success to avoid disappointment in themselves, or they may opt out of doing something because of the potential for stress and the chance of failure.

In summary, Strategies combine the Energy aspect and the Identity aspect. Together, they describe how individuals respond to life and reflect their preferred ways of doing things. When merged, the Energy and Identity personality traits influence many areas of life, including social preferences, confidence, stress, and risk-taking, to name a few.

The Strategy layer shows our preferred ways of doing things and achieving goals. There are four strategies:

Confident Individualism – Introverted (I) and Assertive (-A)

Substance Over Superficiality

Confident Individualists tend to trust in themselves. They enjoy their own company and don't mind spending time alone to pursue their interests. Over time, this can give these personalities an impressive range of skills and interesting ideas.

But these types take pride in their skills for their own sake, not to impress others. They tend not to see the point in social displays and bragging. While they're proud of who they are, these personality types don't always feel the need to prove themselves to anyone else. They prefer substance to superficiality and personal honesty to playing along.

Confident Individualists are motivated by their inner world rather than outside expectations. They're opinionated, but they aren't excessively worried about what others think. These personality types express their thoughts unapologetically. They're rarely pressured into agreeing with others – even if agreeing would be more convenient.

Self-Assurance and Self-Reliance

If left unchecked, this relaxed self-assurance can lead to complacency. These personality types' live-and-let-live attitude goes both ways: They don't push others to change, and in return, they don't particularly want anyone to push them to change. At times, Confident Individualists may miss information and opportunities that challenge their views because they simply don't place much importance on others' approval.

In their personal relationships, these types tend to be strong and honest. Their loyalty and affection are genuine rather than forced. These personalities only express respect and care if they really feel them. Fortunately, if they do feel them, they see no reason to hide how they feel.

No matter how strong their relationships, these types also value self-reliance. They can handle difficult situations well because they tend to be emotionally secure and resistant to stress. Although these personalities rarely seek the spotlight, their quiet examples of determination and honesty can be nothing short of inspiring.

Confident Individualists in Love

Confident Individualists tend to be a bit choosy about their closest confidants. This is especially true when it comes to finding a romantic partner. Perhaps because Confident Individualists know how to find contentment and fulfillment even when they're single, they're in no rush to settle for a partner who's less than a good match.

These personality types may also be less likely to stay with a partner who lets them down. Confident Individualists are less likely than any other personality Strategy to say they often give second chances to those who fail to fulfill commitments to them. Again, perhaps because of their strong intrinsic sense of worth, these types don't necessarily feel compelled to stay in a relationship that isn't working out.

Confident Individualists are the Strategy least likely to say they believe in soulmates. They're also the least likely to say they know a lot of couples whose marriages they envy, or would aspire to have. And it might not come as a surprise, then, that they're the most likely to say they don't want to get married.

It would be inaccurate, however, to assume that Confident Individualists are lone wolves with no interest in committed intimate relationships. The majority of these personality types – 79% – *do* express an interest in getting married. A similar percentage say they're unafraid of being committed to a single partner for the rest of their lives. It's true that Confident Individualists are independent, and they probably won't get into a relationship just for the sake of being in a relationship. That said, these types often do have an interest in romantic connection – they just want to find the right person before they become attached.

Unlikely Leaders

Confident Individualists bring their love of independence into their academic and professional pursuits. They're more likely than any other Strategy to say that learning as part of a group is distracting rather than helpful. As you can imagine, group projects can be frustrating for these personality types – whether at school or in the workplace.

This isn't to say that Confident Individualists *can't* work well with others – far from it. But if given a choice, these types would prefer to operate independently and figure things out on their own. At school, these personalities may be drawn to independent study opportunities. At work, they may try to develop a specific area of expertise that allows them to make their own decisions and do most of their tasks on their own.

From this description, Confident Individualists might not sound like natural leaders, but that isn't necessarily the case. Just over half of these personality types say they're inclined to seek out leadership and management roles. This is well less than their Extraverted peers, but it's still a majority. In addition, nearly 70% of these types say

they have excellent leadership skills. A quick look at famous Confident Individualists includes real-life leaders (Bill Gates) as well as fictional ones (Gandalf).

Confident Individualists tend to hone their ideas and skills on their own, and they often prefer to work alone. That said, these personalities may be willing to take up the reins of leadership if that's what is necessary to turn those ideas and skills into real-world progress.

The Right Mindset

Confident Individualists are more likely than any other personality Strategy to say that control over their mindset is the most important factor in determining their happiness. On average, they rank their mindset as a more significant factor in their happiness than their financial situation, their friends and family, their job, or their health.

This statistic reveals a great deal about Confident Individualists. These personality types believe in their personal effectiveness and their individual worth, and they know how important it is to maintain this mindset. As long as they balance this self-conviction with a willingness to learn from others, Confident Individualists' positive mindset can become a self-fulfilling prophecy, helping these personalities to not only achieve great things but also find lasting happiness.

People Mastery – Extraverted (E) and Assertive (-A)

Bold and Confident

Personality types with the People Mastery Strategy are known for their ability to handle stress. This helps them to act boldly and maintain confidence, even in the face of challenges or criticism.

Thanks to this confidence, people with this Strategy feel energized and at ease in social situations. They seek social contact as well as stimulating and challenging experiences. These personalities like traveling to see things, people, and places, and trying something new – even things they don't end up liking can be exciting for them.

Nothing to Prove?

If they don't keep themselves in check, though, People Masters can become too confident. These personality types tend to be insulated against self-doubt and the need to prove themselves. As a result, they don't always test, or even consider, their own limits or ambitions.

Taken to the extreme, this can create a pattern of comfort-seeking. They may even roll their eyes at people who chase more intimidating goals. At the other end of the spectrum, these personality types can ignore sensible caution, landing themselves in extraordinary and dangerous situations.

At times, People Masters may not be considerate to those who aren't able to maintain such a comfortable boldness. But this doesn't have to be the case, by any means. By taking others into account, these personalities can actually help to draw other people out of their shells in a way that's energizing and empowering.

Finding Balance

Fortunately, most People Masters fall somewhere in the middle. Ideally, they embrace healthy ambition while finding social fulfillment and connection. Social interaction plays a big part in People Masters' happiness. Although these personality types are self-confident, they still appreciate praise and recognition. They don't need

people's approval, but they still crave friends and loved ones with whom to share their lives.

These types may be opinionated, but they don't always worry about having others agree with them. This can help these personalities to be moderate even in disagreements because their ego and confidence aren't at stake the way they often are for Turbulent Strategies. People Masters are not fond of grudges, and at heart, they want to bring people together to make things happen.

These types often stand out for their charisma and self-assurance. As long as they don't use their talents to steamroll or put down others, these personality traits can be quite appealing. These types have little fear of rejection, and they love including others. This can make these personalities wonderful friends, loved ones, and colleagues, who always aim to energize those around them.

People Masters in Love

According to our research, People Masters seem to fall in love a bit more frequently than the other Strategies. They're also less likely to say that falling in love scares them. It's easy to imagine why this is the case – People Masters' Extraversion leads them into situations where they're likely to meet new people, and their Assertive personality trait helps them to feel confident about the prospect of new relationships.

Some might wonder whether this would make People Masters less reliable than other personality types when it comes to being a good partner. Is it possible that these types' self-assurance would make them complacent or uncommitted once they're actually *in* a relationship? Not necessarily: About half of People Masters say it's necessary to go out of their way to please someone they love, and this response

puts them on par with other types. In addition, People Masters are the Strategy least likely to say that long-term commitments make them anxious.

In other words, although People Masters' confidence and social ease might make them sound like players, these types can be as committed and eager to please their partners as anyone else. And being in a relationship with a People Master can be a wonderful thing – even for people who are completely different. After all, People Masters' social energy and their can-do take on life can be infectious in the best possible way.

Speaking Up

People Masters don't tend to filter their opinions. These personality types say what they think, and they think what they say. As with nearly any trait, this can be a strength or a weakness.

People Masters are often seen as straight-shooters who can be trusted to speak honestly. In academic and professional settings, many teachers, classmates, colleagues, and managers appreciate this quality. After all, if used appropriately, candor is a powerful way to connect with other people. The “what you see is what you get” nature of a People Master personality can be refreshing, whether in the classroom or the workplace.

But there's a difference between being candid and being rude – and at times, People Masters may toe that line. In academic settings, this can put them at odds with their teachers and classmates. And in professional settings, these personality types may gain a reputation for being inconsiderate, arrogant, or even ruthless.

Learning to speak honestly *without* speaking over other people is a step on many People Masters' path to personal development. Fortunately, once they master this balance, People Masters can unleash the many gifts they bring to their schooling and their work. In particular, People Masters can excel at dealing with awkward or tense interpersonal situations – whether that's getting a group project back on track or delivering bad news to a customer in a straightforward but considerate way.

Going for It

79% of People Masters say they see problems as opportunities. These personality types trust themselves to tackle hard problems – *and* to gain insight and experience from the process. Ideally, this conviction becomes a self-fulfilling prophecy, with People Masters taking on ever harder challenges and learning important lessons along the way.

What sets People Masters apart isn't just their confidence, however. It's also their willingness to team up with others. These personalities know that we tend to be more effective when we collaborate and ask for help. People Masters can be especially good at creating opportunities for the people around them to use their strengths. And that may just be one of the secrets to People Masters' success.

Constant Improvement – Introverted (I) and Turbulent (-T)

Sensitive Souls

Constant Improvers tend to be sensitive and introspective. They are often deep individuals who enjoy having their own space and freedom. In general, these personality types feel more comfortable on their own than mixed up in the judgment of the real world.

This may be because they share the two personality traits most representative of sensitivity to their environment – Introversion and Turbulence. As a result, they may find it stressful to deal with tense environments or new situations. In these moments, Constant Improvers can be deeply uncomfortable – although they may not want to let on how they really feel. In reaction, these personalities might retreat inward, react defensively, or try to escape the situation altogether. Alternatively, they might give up their own wants or needs in an effort to keep the peace.

Driven by Doubt

Constant Improvers tend to experience self-doubt. They have a strong drive, but it comes paired with a strong fear of failure. These personality types invest a great deal of their identity in their successes. As a result, even a minor misstep or embarrassment can be crushing.

On the upside, this vigilance offers these personality types a knack for sensing trouble. This can be quite useful in situations that need to balance risk and reward – whether a financial investment or a romantic opportunity. When faced with a potential risk, these types look for ways to prevent problems. Although it slows them down in the short term, this approach can prevent longer-term issues.

Constant Improvers direct much of their attention toward their personal interests. They strive to master hobbies, careers, or new means of self-expression. This level of dedication can create impressive, beautiful results.

People with Constant Improvement personality types can be perfectionistic, dedicating tremendous time and energy to their pursuits. Unfortunately, if they put too much pressure on themselves, this approach can backfire. For example, Constant

Improvers may feel forced to abandon an endeavor because a single detail doesn't line up right.

Reality and Romance

At times, Constant Improvers may experience a nagging feeling that something is missing from their lives. It's worth noting that often this really is just a feeling, not a reflection of reality. These personality types have it in their nature always to be seeking something more – even if their lives actually are going just fine.

But as Constant Improvers assess their lives, wondering what might be missing, they may find themselves focusing on their romantic relationships – or lack thereof. These types are significantly less likely than their Assertive counterparts (also known as Confident Individualists) to say that they enjoy being single. And these personalities are more likely than Confident Individualists to say they often construct an ideal partner in their heads when they're single.

Although Constant Improvers may find themselves longing for romance, they don't necessarily find it easy to start up a relationship. They're less likely than other personality Strategies to say that they usually take the initiative in asking someone out. This makes sense, given that Constant Improvers can feel hesitant about putting themselves out there – and asking someone out is an incredibly vulnerable position to be in.

This might sound like bad news, but it doesn't have to be. As they grow and mature, Constant Improvers often learn how to transform their feeling that something is missing into positive energy – and by doing so, they not only discover gratitude for the good things in their lives, but also become proactive about making helpful

changes. This mindset shift can empower these personality types to find fulfillment in their relationships – as well as in every other aspect of their lives.

The “Right” Career?

Constant Improvers’ longing for “something more” extends to their professional lives. Just over a quarter of these types say that their career is a great fit for them – a rate of agreement that is less than the other Strategies.

This doesn’t necessarily mean that Constant Improvers are in the wrong careers for them – although they might wonder if they are. More than half of these personality types say they often think about switching careers, and they’re more likely than the other Strategies to say that they feel stuck in their current job.

This restlessness doesn’t have to be a bad thing. In fact, restlessness can be an incredible motivator to do great things. The trouble comes when Constant Improvers feel trapped: wanting to make a change, but suspecting they’re unable or helpless to do so. This feeling can have a number of roots, such as self-doubt or a general worry that other people don’t “get” them.

As in other areas of their lives, Constant Improvers who pursue personal growth often discover that their feeling of helplessness is exactly that – a *feeling*. This can be a powerful discovery. In its wake, these personality types are better able to harness their personal and professional strengths and deal with their feeling of “stuckness.” This may take the form of finding a new career, or it might involve advocating for themselves in their current workplaces so that they get more of their needs met. Either way, Constant Improvers often find that they have more agency in their professional lives than they’d realized.

The Strength of Sensitivity

In general, Constant Improvers care a great deal about what others think of them. This can trigger insecurity, to be sure, but when kept in balance, it can create some truly wonderful traits. These personalities are often curious about and sensitive to others' feelings. This can make them excellent listeners, friends, confidants, and partners.

Some types might think that sensitivity is synonymous with weakness, but Constant Improvers know that isn't the case. These personality types often exemplify how sensitivity and vulnerability can be hidden strengths. Their attunement to their own struggles and insecurities can help them to bond deeply with others. It can also motivate them to act with kindness and compassion.

Although they may not always realize it, Constant Improvers offer the world a wealth of gifts. Once they learn to trust themselves as much as they trust others' opinions, these personalities can shine.

Social Engagement – Extraverted (E) and Turbulent (-T)

Boldly Sensitive

Those with the Social Engagement Strategy are an interesting group. In some ways, Extraverted and Turbulent personality traits conflict with each other. Extraversion leads to risk-tolerance and boldness, and Turbulence leads to self-doubt and sensitivity.

This can mean that Social Engagers tend to do what comes naturally first and think about it later. In this way, they are almost an exaggeration of their underlying personality traits. This may sound like a bad thing, but it doesn't have to be.

Social Engagers venture into the world with enthusiasm. They enjoy being the center of attention and enjoy social status. At times, this may mean that they hide their true selves to impress other people, pretending to be someone else in order to be liked. Fortunately, Social Engagers' genuine interest in others often shines through, helping these personality types to create authentic connections with the people around them.

Social Engagers in Love

Romantic relationships aren't always the easiest – hence Shakespeare's observation that "the course of true love never did run smooth." You might think that Social Engagers' self-doubt would cause them to play it safe when it comes to the rough waters of love, but that isn't the case. These personality types tend to dive headlong into relationships – they're more likely than any other Strategy to say they fall in love easily. And they're also less likely to say they enjoy being single.

Social Engagers are far from passive about their romantic lives. These personalities care deeply about pleasing their partners – in fact, they're the Strategy most likely to believe they need to go out of their way to please the people they love. Social Engagers are deeply devoted, willing to pour all of their affection and care into their partner.

But not everyone is willing – or able – to do this in return. Social Engagers may feel it acutely if their partner doesn't seem equally affectionate or devoted. This can be especially challenging because these personality types care so deeply about receiving praise and admiration. As a result, they might feel hurt by a partner who is reserved in expressing their affection.

As they go through life, many Social Engagers discover that not everyone is as expressive as they are – and that’s okay. These types may need to use their social acumen to connect with the ways their partners *do* share love. For example, they may realize that their partner expresses affection through physical touch, spending time together, or even helping out around the house. Once they attune themselves to the ways other personalities demonstrate their love, Social Engagers can find incredible fulfillment and joy in their romantic relationships.

Working It

Social Engagers may find themselves drawn to lines of work that involve plenty of human interaction. The service industry can be a natural fit for these personality types, as can nearly any job that involves helping customers solve problems. Social Engagers are energized by the opportunity to talk with others, and they’re especially invigorated when they can tell that they’ve actually made someone’s day a little better.

This isn’t to say that Social Engagers are anything less than ambitious. In their own way, these personalities do care about being successful. Everyone has a unique definition of “success,” of course, but many Social Engagers feel especially successful when they receive recognition, such as awards, promotions, or positive feedback on their work. These types tend to be motivated by a desire to impress and please others – not only because they enjoy praise, but also because they genuinely value the good opinion of their bosses, coworkers, and customers. And of course a salary increase is always nice, too.

Social Engagers’ ambition and desire to please can make them wonderful employees and colleagues. At times, however, these personality types often discover a need to

pause and make sure they're being true to themselves as well. Their personal development path may lead them to consider their own values and needs – and make sure that their professional lives line up with these values and needs.

That said, these types know that their career is just one aspect of their lives. 74% of Social Engagers say they're always looking for new hobbies to get into – more than any other personality Strategy. Whether those hobbies include volleyball, viticulture, or volunteering, these types care about being well-rounded. Paradoxically, this well-roundedness can help them to find more enjoyment in their careers as well as in other aspects of their lives.

The Highs and the Lows

Social Engagers can experience highs and lows – sometimes within a matter of minutes. Their Extraversion can push their Turbulent need for success into overdrive. Meanwhile, their Turbulent personality trait can trigger almost instant self-doubt. Although these types are capable of taking quick action in a way that seems decisive, they may find themselves plagued by uncertainty afterward.

As they grow, many Social Engagers learn how to use this unusual combination of traits to their advantage. Their Extraversion can help them move past the self-doubt that comes with the Turbulent trait, enabling them to expand their comfort zones even when it isn't easy. Meanwhile, their Turbulent trait can help them to be more considerate in their boldness. The result is that these personality types can hold many contradictory traits in harmony, being both fun and responsible, active and reflective.

This push and pull can be stressful, but it's part of this Strategy's charm. These personality types chase their goals relentlessly, but they also indulge their desires

and seek out fun. Thanks to this balance, they can lead happy and fruitful lives – sharing adventures and accomplishments with others whenever possible. Whatever direction these personalities pull, they are sure to pull the crowd with them.

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